

A.A.'s Future—Our Responsibility

The Thirty-Sixth Annual Meeting of the General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous

1986

Final Report

**Roosevelt Hotel
New York City
April 20–26**

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Commitment to A.A.'s Future Is Renewed

Opening day

Members of the 36th General Service Conference met in New York City at the Roosevelt Hotel on April 20-26, 1986, to renew their commitment to the future of the Fellowship. The Conference theme, "A.A.'s Future—Our Responsibility," focused Conference members on their vital roles as trusted servants in considering the major concerns facing the Fellowship in its 51st year.

The General Service Conference is the active voice and effective conscience of the whole Fellowship. A total of 91 delegates from the Conference areas of the United States and Canada make up more than two-thirds of the Conference membership. These delegates bring the viewpoints of their areas to the Conference to examine and reaffirm A.A. policy. The Conference membership also includes nonalcoholic and alcoholic trustees of the General Service Board, A.A.W.S. and Grapevine directors, and G.S.O. and Grapevine staffs. (Administrative and stenographic personnel from G.S.O. also attend the Conference but do not vote.)

The first opportunity for Conference members to meet and get to know each other was on Sunday afternoon in the hotel's Oval Suite. Here members with different service capacities (delegates, trustees, etc.) gathered to share informally and learn about each other's service roles. This trusted servants' sharing session was a time of expectation and joy, as Conference members communicated their thoughts and feelings about Conference week. Newcomers, especially Panel 36 delegates, felt more at ease in their newness as fears and tensions were dispelled by the sharing.

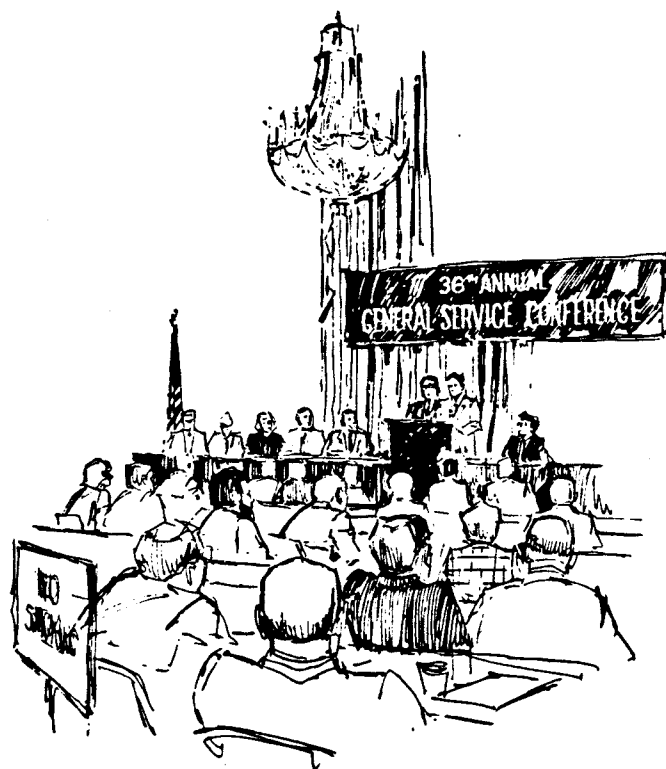
Susan Daly (G.S.O. staff) opened the sharing session with words of welcome for all and then introduced Mary Reynolds (Eastern Massachusetts), the delegate chairperson. Bill Wilson (Chicago), alternate delegate chairperson, moderated the session and introduced the following speakers: Ken Dunphy (Eastern Canada regional trustee), Lyla Bonney (G.S.O. staff), Desmond Towey (Grapevine director), Robert Morse (Class A trustee), Tom Hearn (Virginia), and Tom Beebe (San Diego/Imperial). In addition, the following names were drawn from the hat: David O'Leary (Nova Scotia/Newfoundland/Labrador), Noel Quesnelle (Northeast Ontario), and George Mudrich (Central and Southeastern Ohio).

As these trusted servants of A.A. shared their feelings about being members of the 36th Conference, expressing both apprehension and faith, all Conference members had the opportunity to renew their commitment to service and their trust in the Conference process. As the sharing session ended, Conference members knew that the process had begun. More comfortable with themselves and their Conference responsibilities, they knew that a Higher Power would guide them through the Conference, one day at a time. After the sharing session, regional trustees met with Panels 35 and 36 delegates for pre-Conference orientation sessions.

The Grand Ballroom of the Roosevelt "came alive" on Sunday evening when Conference members and guests enjoyed dinner and fellowship.

An oldtimer keeps it simple

"Early-bird" Conference delegates attended the 4-6-8 Meeting of A.A. at G.S.O. on Friday, April 18, along with G.S.O. staff, past delegates and trustees, and visiting A.A.s. All listened attentively to the reminiscences on A.A. history offered by Jack Meagher from Michigan (1956-57 Conference delegate and past trustee), who shared his A.A. service experience during the Fellowship's formative years. Perhaps Jack's commitment to growth and service in A.A. can be best expressed by his own words: "When you're green, you grow; when you're ripe, you spoil."



A highlight of the evening was the introduction of Lois Wilson (wife of A.A.'s co-founder). As Lois briefly expressed her love for all, the gathering was united in humble respect for her, deeply honored by her presence.

An exceptional A.A. meeting followed the dinner. Led by Patrick Walsh (Hawaii) and James Johnson (North Carolina/Bermuda), Lois Fisher (G.S.O. staff), David O'Leary (Nova Scotia/Newfoundland/Labrador), Evy Vyverberg (Iowa), Ames Sweet (Grapevine staff), and Helen Harmon (trustee-at-large/Canada) shared their experience, strength, and hope as well as their gratitude for finding the A.A. way of life. This A.A. meeting reminded Conference members of the primary purpose of the week of hard work ahead.

The first session of the 36th General Service Conference began on Monday morning in the Terrace Room. Gordon Patrick (chairperson of the General Service Board), in his welcoming remarks, emphasized the "awesome responsibility" facing members of the 36th Conference in considering A.A.'s future. The main purpose of this first session was to introduce Conference members to the agenda and mechanics of the Conference and to answer questions on Conference procedure. Following roll call, conducted by John Bragg (G.S.O. general manager), Mary Reynolds, delegate chairperson, gave an inspiring welcoming talk and Jim Estelle (Class A trustee) delivered a powerful keynote address. (Condensed versions of the welcome and keynote addresses are given on page 6.)

Filled with countless committee meetings, reports, presentation/discussions, and workshops, the Conference agenda required all the effort and steady application that Conference members could muster. Throughout the week, Conference members renewed their commitment to A.A.'s future through reaffirming the basics—the home group, anonymity, twelfth stepping, etc.—as the cornerstones for future growth.

Conference committee meetings were completed by Wednesday evening (several committees met until the wee hours of the morning). The Thursday and Friday Conference sessions were devoted to committee reports; each recommendation was discussed and voted on by the full Conference. Due to the exacting thoroughness of committee members, this year committee reports were unusually long and the number of recommendations exceptionally large. As a result, the Thursday and Friday sessions ran overtime. The Thursday-evening "What's on Your Mind?" sharing session was cut short; a report on Native North Americans and the closing talk (scheduled for Friday afternoon) were moved to the Saturday-morning closing brunch.

Late on Friday afternoon, after the last recommendation had been voted on, Conference members relaxed and enjoyed the final presentation/discussion session on "Back to Basics," a theme which had pervaded the week's deliberations and which seemed to be inseparable from considerations of A.A.'s future. Then, as they joined in reciting the Lord's Prayer (in French, Spanish, and English), members of the 36th General Service Conference were united in the understanding that once again a greater Power had guided the Conference process.

No quicker route

When Tom Beebe (Panel 36, San Diego/Imperial) jumped in a cab at the airport and told the driver to go to Manhattan, the cabbie asked him whether he should go over the Triboro bridge. "Is it quicker?" Tom asked, to which the cabbie shouted, "Yes." After a fast-paced jaunt over the bridge, the cabbie made an abrupt right turn, cutting off a police car, and the quicker route proved to be very slow indeed.

Welcome

An awesome responsibility

The Conference is a continuing process that began as an experiment in 1951 and became permanent at four o'clock on Sunday afternoon, July 3, 1955. On that afternoon, the General Service Conference became "the guardian of the Traditions of Alcoholics Anonymous, the perpetrators of the world services of our Society, the voice of the group conscience of our entire Fellowship, and the sole successor of its co-founders, Dr. Bob and Bill." (*The A.A. Service Manual*, 1985-86 ed., p. 28.) In the truest sense of the word, ours is an awesome responsibility.

We are here this week to accept that responsibility. We are here to listen and learn, and to participate in discussion. We are not here to disagree for the sake of disagreement or to "rubber stamp" for the sake of agreement. No doubt there will be differences of opinion; those are healthy. We will have ample time to present our views in committee meetings, at workshops, and on the Conference floor. Let us always be guided by our love for and desire to serve the Fellowship.

We are united this week in a spiritual experience. Let us, in all our sharing, recommendations, discussions, and actions, remember that we have one ultimate authority to guide us—a loving God as He may express Himself in our group conscience. May the God of your understanding and the God of my understanding guide us each day so that when Friday comes and the 36th General Service Conference adjourns, we can each of us say with total honesty: "I have acted to the best of my ability to ensure A.A.'s future."

Mary Reynolds (Eastern Massachusetts)

Keynote

Responsible stewardship

It has been often quoted: "Those who ignore history are bound to repeat it." Well, we in A.A. certainly have not ignored our history; instead, we have developed a pardonable and justifiable reverence for it. In spite of this seeming flaw, if we can only keep repeating that part of our history which is stated so eloquently in the simplicity of our Twelfth Step, our future is indeed assured.

The future of A.A. is indeed our responsibility, as it has been the responsibility of those Conference delegates before us. Our founders and delegate predecessors have vouchsafed the future of the Fellowship from any terminal damage we might unwittingly contemplate. The future has not always been assured to the degree it is today, and among our charges is to continue to vouchsafe the future of the Fellowship.

This does not mean we must always deny risk, change, and modification of our acceptance of the suffering alcoholic. We can take risks; we can make changes; and we can modify attitudes without compromising those immutable and timeless truths which have served as the very foundation of our future for now over 50 years. To assure our future for the next 50 years, some risks, changes, and modifications must occur.

Our future is defined, in part, by those who still suffer. It is also defined, in part, by our demonstrated responsibility of collective deliberations here and in our individual actions at home. We will be sensitive and responsive to the future of A.A. if we are constantly reminded that our so-called "future" is not a vague, ambiguous, inanimate, or bloodless word used only in titles for keynote talks—our future is the arrest of and rescue from the dread disease of alcoholism "that great legion" which have yet to experience your joy of sobriety. The disease itself, in part, defines our future; and it is our responsibility to accept and deal with the definition, whether or not we are comfortable.

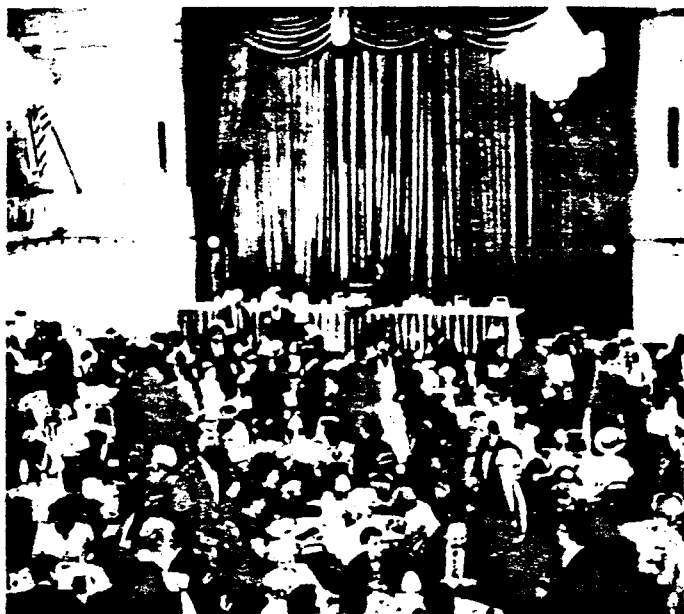
As part of our necessary trust, we need to be ever vigilant that we as trusted servants do not inadvertently falter. Don't ever let us take ourselves more seriously than our work. And our work (and responsibility) is carrying the message and providing the opportunity for recovery. We need also take care that our understandable love for and protection of tradition does not become ceremonial ritual; for this would ultimately result in pomp and show, which predicts the diminishment of humility, gratitude, and anonymity.

In recorded history, we have found too many epidemics of fear and cowardice. What we need to remember from history, more than those chapters of disaster, are the recorded instances of contagious courage. And you, gentle friends, display such courage in your continuing joy of sobriety, in your mission of service, in your caring love for the suffering alcoholic—you are the future, and I am a grateful witness to your responsible stewardship.

W. J. Estelle Jr. (Class A trustee)

I remember when

Struggling to fix a wobbly microphone at the opening dinner on Sunday evening, moderator James Johnson (Panel 35, North Carolina/Bermuda) mumbled in frustration, "I used to be an electronics engineer!"



Delegates' meeting

A dinner and meeting for Panels 35 and 36 delegates was held on Tuesday evening. Presentations and a panel were followed by discussion, elections of the 1987 delegate chairperson and alternate, and a sharing session. Bill Miller (New York: Hudson/Mohawk/Berkshire) was elected the new delegate chairperson; Marc Pineau (Southwest Quebec) was elected the alternate chairperson. The presentations excerpted here were chosen by the delegates to be distributed with other Conference presentations because of their exceptional quality.

Our golden assignment: the trust and responsibility placed in us—our solutions

Early in sobriety, I was introduced to the Third Legacy of Service. After being involved in all levels of service for about nine years, I was giving some thought about standing for delegate. After talking to past delegates, the decision became easier for me. They pointed out the trust and responsibility placed in us. Before going to the Conference, they strongly suggested reading and rereading *The A.A. Service Manual*, *A.A. Comes of Age*, and *Twelve Concepts for World Service*. They also suggested reading the *Final Conference Report* for the past two or three years. By being informed, we can help make worldwide decisions.

Since becoming delegate, I feel a strong responsibility to the needs and wishes of my area. While I desire to serve the area to the best of my ability, the growth of A.A. as a whole must come first. This must be ever present in my mind, especially at the Conference, with emphasis on a particular issue. I must listen to the views of other areas and share mine, which may not always be in agreement with my area's thinking. I must act, not just as a messenger who is instructed how to vote, but rather as a trusted servant, with the right and responsibility of deciding with the guidance of my own conscience. Besides what happens on the floor of the Conference or in committee meetings or workshops, many of our area's problems and questions can be answered.

David O'Leary (Nova Scotia/Newfoundland/Labrador)

A.A. in a densely populated area

For some time I have realized how fortunate I have been to be part of the Fellowship in such a densely populated area as Chicago. I can travel from one side of the delegate area to the other side in a little more than an hour; this is rare in delegate areas. I have stressed this point to D.C.M.s, committee members, and chairpersons when discussing the attendance at our bimonthly area meeting.

We have about 3,200 groups in the Chicago area and 4,000 weekly meetings. Because of the amount of meetings, there are very few problems in getting to a meeting or in bringing a new person to a meeting. We have 15 districts, and communication among the districts is no problem because of our central office, which mails all announcements for district, bimonthly committee, and area meetings.

In a densely populated area, a delegate can attend many more area functions and pass along all information that is important to A.A. and the area. I attend many workshops, district meetings, and social functions that I would be unable to attend if I lived in a wide geographic area. Members go to district functions other than their own because of this closeness.

When I return to Chicago after the Conference, I shall begin to share the Conference message with the districts. I feel that my service as delegate is much easier than it is for some who have to travel many miles to pass along the same message.

Bill Wilson (Chicago)

'What's on Your Mind?'

The brief "What's On Your Mind?" sharing session on Thursday evening provided an opportunity for Conference members to discuss a variety of topics, including the archives, the A.A. Grapevine, International Conventions, the Eleventh Tradition, and treatment centers.

A recommendation was approved that the formation of a Conference Archives Committee be brought to the attention of the Conference Policy/Admissions Committee at next year's Conference. One concern is that members of the new committee would be at the expense of existing committees.

In response to a question as to whether the Grapevine is losing or making money, it was shared that, according to the accounting system applied by most magazines, the Grapevine is doing better than many other magazines.

A question as to how many area assemblies permit past delegates to vote revealed that approximately 40 areas allow past delegates to vote and about 40 areas do not.

Various matters regarding International A.A. Conventions were discussed. The suggestion was made that at future conventions, individuals chair not more than one meeting, thus allowing for more participation by other members.

Regarding the photographs ordered, but never delivered, of the 1985 International A.A. Convention in Montreal, Conference members learned that both the convention consultant and photographic firm that had been retained proved to be somewhat evasive. G.S.O. has made many attempts to contact these individuals, with no success. A counsel in Montreal has been secured to contact them. The Convention



coordinator, Sarah Price, intends to fulfill all unfilled orders by making prints from a copy of the photograph in our possession. Our legal counsel has indicated no legal barriers in following such a course.

Another floor motion was that the Conference instruct the General Service Board to initiate the process of changing Tradition Eleven to include the words "TV and other means of public communication" by contacting the general service boards of other countries for their concurrence. It was noted that this would be a lengthy process and would probably take more than a year to complete. Other methods were also suggested. A sense of the meeting indicated that there was no need to pursue this matter at present.

A request was made to consider an additional theme for next year's Conference: "Keeping It Simple."

A question was asked regarding the disposition of a surplus of \$4,600 inventory value of 1984-1985 A.A. *Service Manuals*. The request was made that such outdated issues be distributed to central offices, intergroups, or other A.A. entities. It was shared that, in addition to various other changes, a Conference recommendation had required the reprinting of the Concepts as originally written by Bill W. in 1962, and the 1985-1986 A.A. *Service Manual* was the result. Because of this, the 1984-1985 A.A. *Service Manuals* were destroyed at the request of the A.A.W.S. board rather than distributing them.

In response to a question as to whether Al-Anon participates in the profit or loss of conventions attended by both Fellowships, a show of hands indicated that 13 areas follow this practice while many more than that do not.

A question was asked as to whether a treatment center could obtain permission to distribute trinkets, medallions, or other material with both "A.A." and the name of the treatment center displayed. The response was that the A.A.W.S. board would not give such permission.

Closing talk

At the closing brunch on Saturday morning, Bob Pearson (G.S.O. senior adviser), who is retiring early next year, gave a powerful and inspiring closing talk (excerpted below) to the 36th Conference. (This talk was rescheduled from Friday afternoon.)

Our greatest danger: rigidity

This is my 18th General Service Conference—the first two as a director of the Grapevine and A.A.W.S., followed by four as a general service trustee. In 1972, I rotated out completely, only to be called back two years later as general manager of G.S.O., the service job I held until late 1984. Since the 1985 International Convention, of course, I have been senior adviser. This is also my last Conference, so this is an emotionally charged experience.

I wish I had time to express my thanks to everyone to whom I am indebted for my sobriety and for the joyous life with which I have been blessed for the past nearly 25 years. But since this is obviously impossible, I will fall back on the Arab saying that Bill quoted in his last message, "I thank you for your lives." For without your lives, I most certainly would have no life at all, much less the incredibly rich life I have enjoyed.

Let me offer my thoughts about A.A.'s future. I have no truck with those bleeding deacons who decry every change and view the state of the Fellowship with pessimism and alarm. On the contrary, from my nearly quarter-century's perspective, I see A.A. as larger, healthier, more dynamic, faster growing, more global, more service-minded, more back-to-basics, and more spiritual—by far—than when I came through the doors of my first meeting in Greenwich, Connecticut, just one year after the famous Long Beach Convention. A.A. has flourished beyond the wildest dreams of founding members, though perhaps not of Bill himself, for he was truly visionary.

I echo those who feel that if this Fellowship ever falters or fails, it will not be because of any outside cause. No, it will not be because of treatment centers or professionals in the field, or non-Conference-approved literature, or young people, or the dually-addicted, or even the "druggies" trying to come to our closed meetings. If we stick close to our Traditions, Concepts, and Warranties, and if we keep an open mind and an open heart, we can deal with these *and any other* problems that we have or ever will have. If we ever falter and fail, it will be simply because of us. It will be because we can't control our own egos or get along well enough with each other. It will be because we have too much fear and rigidity and not enough trust and common sense.

If you were to ask me what is the greatest danger facing A.A. today, I would have to answer: the growing *rigidity*—the increasing demand for absolute answers to nit-picking questions; pressure for G.S.O. to "enforce" our Traditions; screening alcoholics at closed meetings; prohibiting non-Conference-approved literature, i.e., "banning books"; laying more and more rules on groups and members. And in this trend toward rigidity, we are drifting farther and farther away from our co-founders. Bill, in particular, must be spinning in his grave, for he was perhaps the most permissive person I ever met. One of his favorite sayings was "Every group has the right to be wrong." He was maddeningly tolerant of his critics, and he had absolute faith that faults in A.A. were self-correcting.

And I believe this, too, so in the final analysis we're not going to fall apart. We won't falter or fail. At the 1970 International Convention in Miami, I was in the audience on that Sunday morning when

Bill made his last brief public appearance. He was too ill to take his scheduled part in any other convention event, but now, unannounced, on Sunday morning, he was wheeled up from the back of the stage in a wheelchair, attached with tubes to an oxygen tank. Wearing a ridiculous bright-orange, host-committee blazer, he heaved his angular body to his feet and grasped the podium—and all pandemonium broke loose. I thought the thunderous applause and the cheering would never stop, tears streaming down every cheek. Finally, in a firm voice, like his old self, Bill spoke a few gracious sentences about the huge crowd, the outpouring of love, and the many overseas members there, ending (as I remember) with these words: "As I look out over this crowd, I know that Alcoholics Anonymous will live a thousand years—if it is God's will."

Bob Pearson (senior adviser)

Closing brunch

Our simple responsibility—to 'pass it on'

Conference members met in the Terrace Room for the last time on Saturday morning to share brunch and say goodbye to rotating trustees and Panel 35 delegates. After brunch, John Bragg informed members that Chuck Furtaw (Central Michigan), who was unable to attend the Conference due to illness, was out of the hospital. John thanked Roberto Campa from G.S.O. in Italy for observing the week's proceedings. He also thanked the G.S.O. personnel who had assisted at the Conference and Susan Daly (G.S.O. staff) for her diligent efforts as Conference secretary.

Betty Liddle (G.S.O. staff) gave a report on Native North Americans, which had been originally scheduled for Friday afternoon (see page 22). Bob Pearson's closing talk (also rescheduled from Friday afternoon) was a stirring reaffirmation of faith in A.A. (see page 6). Mary Reynolds, outgoing delegate chairperson, introduced Bill Miller (Panel 36, New York: Hudson/Mohawk/Berkshire), who read "How It Works." Gordon Patrick then introduced the rotating trustees. Their brief farewell talks are summarized here.

Ken Dunphy (Eastern Canada regional trustee) talked about "rotating" into A.A. from drunkenness because of A.A. service people at a time when there were few service structures. Ken was an unwilling participant at his first meeting, having been sent by his employer. Seeing rotation as "going through a door—letting go," Ken gave thanks for his service experience and for other rotating trustees. "I am what you people have made me," he said, pointing out that in the spirit of rotation he had replaced his trustee badge with a carnation.

Having served as Class A trustee for nine years, Jim Estelle described himself as a "grateful nonalcoholic." He admitted that although A.A. sharing and way of life had met his needs, he was still unwilling to "pay your initiation fees." Jim chaired the first trustees' Correctional Facilities Committee, and he thanked all who preceded him, especially the G.S.O. staff serving on the Correctional Facilities assignment. During his service to A.A., Jim regarded the General Service Board as his home group, describing the trustees who attend quarterly board meetings as "weekend warriors." Jim reminded Conference members to remain faithful to the basics, especially showing tolerance of differences, and urged them to sponsor well their nonalcoholic trustees.

Natalie Schwanke (Pacific U.S. regional trustee) extended special thanks to Gordon Patrick, describing him as one of the kindest people she had ever met. She also thanked Bob Pearson, John Bragg, and

the sponsors and service people who had supported her. Commenting on turning points in her service life, Natalie told of the importance of becoming area secretary in the early sixties, when a worldwide Fellowship opened up for her. Although part of her wished to hold on, Natalie accepted that a guiding Presence would help her move on in A.A. service. Expressing optimism about A.A.'s future, Natalie shared her vision of "life after being a trustee."

Gordon Patrick began his closing remarks with a tribute to Ken Williams (Class A trustee), who died suddenly several weeks before the Conference. The Conference theme, "A.A.'s Future—Our Responsibility," was viewed by Gordon as being eminently fitting, and he pointed out that the future confronting Conference members today is different than the future that faced the Conference ten years ago. Congratulating the delegates for their hard work, Gordon especially thanked those with English as a second language. Urging A.A.s to forever speak the "language of the heart," he thanked the G.S.O. staff and bid farewell to Panel 35 delegates.

Addressing Panel 36 delegates, Gordon pointed out the challenges for the future, especially conducting Conference business within the allotted time constraints and ensuring that agenda issues will be dealt with. From the "mountaintop experience" of the 36th Conference, Gordon suggested that the Conference responsibility to the future of A.A. is very simple—to "pass on" the Conference-week experience. With this reminder of their primary purpose, members of the 36th General Service Conference were united in the Lord's Prayer.

Conference sidelights

A committee of New York A.A.s and Al-Anons hosted the spouses of Conference members, providing a wide variety of activities for their enjoyment. The week's agenda included: Monday—Circle Line boat trip around Manhattan; visit to Al-Anon headquarters. Tuesday—tour of Lincoln Center; visit to G.S.O. Wednesday—tour of the Metropolitan Museum of Art; lunch at the museum cafeteria. Thursday—trip to the United Nations; lunch in delegates' dining room. Friday—visit to South Street Seaport; lunch at the Fulton Market Building; tour of Historic Old New York. . . . The following statistics (in years) give a composite sketch of the 1986 Conference delegate: Age: from 36 to 70, averaging 53.1; length of sobriety: from 6 to 34, averaging 12.9; length of A.A. service: from 5 to 23, averaging 10.4.



Presentations Lay Groundwork for Next 50 Years

Overview of copyrights of the book *Alcoholics Anonymous*

The first presentation/discussion of the 1986 Conference took place on Monday morning. The topic was of vital concern to Conference members in considering A.A.'s future. Shepherd Raimi, general service trustee, moderated the session.¹

Update on A.A.'s copyrights

The copyright on the first edition of the Big Book lapsed in 1967, and the copyright on the new material in the second edition lapsed in 1983—both because of a failure to renew them in a timely fashion. There was a mistaken belief that registering the copyright on the second edition in 1956 served to revive the copyright on the first edition; the misconception continued, with respect to the second edition, when the third edition was copyrighted in 1976.

The news of the copyright loss generated several immediate concerns: What would happen if every major publisher produced its own version of the Big Book in direct competition with A.A.W.S., Inc.? Also, what would happen to A.A.'s unique message of recovery and spiritual growth, as defined in the book *Alcoholics Anonymous*? How might we prevent distortion or even simple erosion of our message without copyright protection?

While still recovering from the first shocking news, the other shoe fell: Initial reports, quickly supported by hard evidence, confirmed that an outfit called C.T.M., Inc., intended to produce replicas of the first edition of *Alcoholics Anonymous* for \$25 a copy. The A.A. General Service Board, the A.A.W.S. board, and G.S.O. took a number of actions demanded by the situation.

First, an intelligent response to C.T.M. was defined. After consulting with our copyright attorneys in Washington, D.C., it became clear that, although the first and second editions of the Big Book were in the public domain, several viable courses of action against C.T.M. were possible involving infringement of our registered trademark, viz., the words "Alcoholics Anonymous," and federal fair-trade statutes, which preclude advertising and packaging a product so that the public confuses it with that of the complainant, in this case, A.A.W.S., Inc. It now appears that C.T.M. did not profit from the venture, that it distributed between 2,000 and 2,500 copies of its product, and that it does not intend to continue in business.

¹ All presentations in this section have been condensed. Copies of the original presentations may be obtained from A.A.W.S., Inc., Box 459, Grand Central Station, New York, N.Y. 10163.

But what was to be done about the royalties to Lois Wilson prescribed in a 1963 agreement between Bill and A.A.W.S., Inc.? We and Lois reaffirmed the intent of Bill and the 1963 A.A.W.S. board by negotiating an amendment providing for the continuation of the 1963 agreement as though the copyrights were still valid and guaranteeing that Lois and A.A.W.S., Inc., would each hold the other harmless for the loss of the copyright in 1967.

A.A.W.S., Inc., had to reconsider how to respond to future requests to reprint, translate, adapt, or otherwise use materials contained in the first and second editions of the Big Book. Our counsel strongly urged we continue to consider requests to use Big Book materials but suggested using alternative language when responding.

The interim plan and related actions are as much as could be accomplished in fulfilling our mandate under the "Right of Decision." The essential elements of an overall strategy respecting the loss of the Big Book copyrights will be defined by the 1986 Conference.

Tom Jasper (G.S.O. services director)

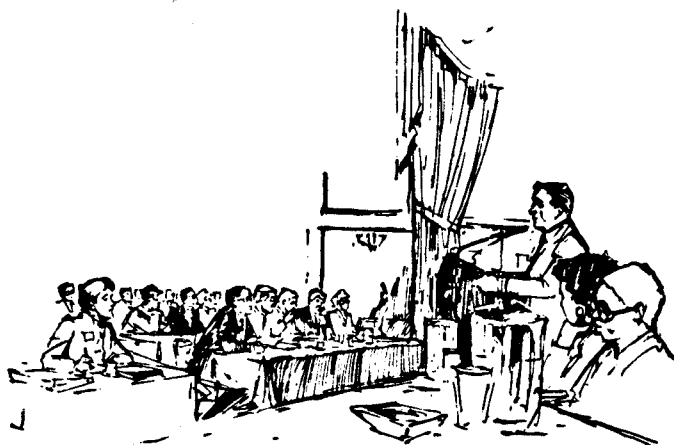
Trustees' Literature Committee's survey on Big Book derivatives

Although the impetus behind this consideration of alternate formats of the Big Book is the loss of our copyright, the question of derivatives has been with us for a long time. Conference after Conference has considered this question, but no actions were taken. We seemed to favor no change—having only one version of our Big Book. In many ways, the loss of the Big Book copyright has proved to be a boon: It has led to taking our inventory on our ways of functioning far beyond the intensive inventory we have taken on Conference-approved literature. And, in particular, we have considered the Big Book.

The trustees' Literature Committee spent the past year considering as many of the implications of the copyright loss as they could imagine and actions which might be taken in the event that any one of a number of scenarios occurred. Our major consideration came down to the possibility of alternate formats of the Big Book and the recommendation that we publish a fourth edition, containing enough new material to be copyrightable and clearly designated in a number of ways as the official text of A.A. We felt that one way to preserve the integrity of our message is to provide A.A. members with formats they might want and/or need instead of allowing others to meet these needs. Thus a survey of the delegates was undertaken and, after consultation with them, a survey of random groups. The results are as follows:

Big Book alternate formats	Delegates	Random groups
Pocket edition	25 (2)	44 (1)
Soft-cover edition	29 (1)	33 (2)
Soft-cover, first 11 chapters with Dr. Bob's story	19 (4)	18 (3)
Hard-cover, first 11 chapters with Dr. Bob's story	16 (5)	7 (6)
Deluxe, leather bound	21 (3)	15 (4)
Deluxe, boxed, gift edition	14 (7)	8 (5)
None of the above	15 (6)	18

Of the 91 delegates, 70 responded; of the approximately 290 random groups, 44 responded. Although there are still reservations about publishing anything but the Big Book in its present form, there was an impressive willingness to consider other derivatives, many of which could serve needs that the present single format does not serve, e.g., a soft-cover version for prisoners.



Many comments returned with the questionnaires dealt with the general issue rather than the specific issue of derivatives. Some members urged us to proceed vigorously with legal efforts to have the copyright reinstated. But, over all, members indicated that, reinstated copyright or not, it might be time to reevaluate our past position of publishing the Big Book in a single format, and that perhaps the membership could be better served and could better serve others with a wider variety of formats. Above all, members' comments revealed that they felt our actions in response to the loss of the Big Book copyright should be such that this chapter should "become another positive story in the history of Alcoholics Anonymous."

Joan K. Jackson, Ph.D. (Class A trustee)

International Convention

Following the coffee break on Monday afternoon, Conference members heard reports on the 1985 A.A. International Convention and the site selection procedure for the 1990 A.A. International Convention. Dan Byrne, West Central U.S. regional trustee, served as moderator.

Montreal wrap-up

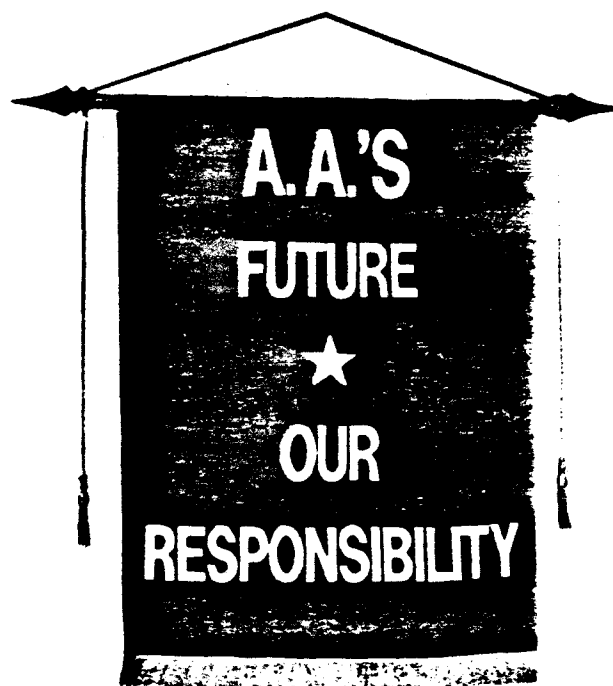
A.A.'s 50th year and our huge 1985 International Birthday Party in July are now history: 45,600 people traveled to Montreal; 34,428 were A.A.s, and 11,172 were Al-Anons and Alateens. Thirteen percent of Canadian A.A.s and 4 percent of U.S. A.A.s who are registered at G.S.O. attended. It seems we came determined to have a good time. More than 180 chairpersons and moderators introduced over 500 speakers and panelists in meeting rooms at four downtown hotels and the Convention Center. Also, there were 77 marathon chairpersons and probably hundreds of marathon speakers and Al-Anon and Alateen meetings.

The convention was a whopping financial success! A surplus of \$319,000 was reported to the February 3, 1986, board meeting, which will more than offset the loss incurred from the 1980 A.A. International Convention. To what do we owe the huge success of this convention? The nearly 63 percent increase in attendance over what was budgeted for can be attributed to perhaps three major situations: (1) additional excitement and gratitude resulting from publicity; (2) being centrally located in a high-density A.A. population area; and (3) the attraction to Americans of the 72 cent Canadian dollar.

As a Fellowship, we have to thank many people who worked to make this party a success and adjusted so well to all the extra attendance. We should say thank you to the G.S.O. planning committee; the 3,000 plus members of the Montreal Host Committee who did so much to assist visitors (wearing easily recognized hats, they had much to do with setting the "mood" of the convention); the people of Montreal, who allowed us to take over their city for a few days; the organizers of the marathons—chairpersons, moderators, and speakers; and the convention-goers themselves, without whom none of this would have happened. The attitude that brought so many of us to Montreal, I think, is that spiritual feeling that urges us to say "thank you" to God and our fellow A.A.s. The convention theme, "50 Years With Gratitude," was so appropriate.

In general

Dr. Jack Norris was overheard saying to someone, "When I get into generalizations, the only generalization that I am comfortable with is that any generalization will be wrong."



The A.A. Fellowship made a vivid and positive impression on many non-A.A.s last July. G.S.O. received many letters from residents of Montreal. To my knowledge, no A.A. event has ever received more positive media coverage than this convention. A.A.s and alcoholics who will come to us as a result of this huge P.I. boost can be grateful to Ed McDougall and Jacques Filteau for their super job in coordinating coverage by the English and French media.

Kenneth Dunphy (Eastern Canada regional trustee)

Site selection procedure

G.S.O. began planning for the 1990 International Convention in August 1985. Our general manager, John Bragg, sent a letter to all delegates asking those interested to request a bid questionnaire and outlining procedures to be followed by the Site Selection Committee.

Our best guess at attendance in 1990 is about 60,000. On this basis, the minimum requirements to hold the convention in any city are: at least 17,000 hotel rooms; a facility holding 60,000 (for the Big Meetings); at least 40 meeting rooms seating 600 each (or any equivalent combination); plus five rooms seating 1,000 or more, including smaller rooms holding 300 to 500. Also, Al-Anon has requested a facility that holds 6,000 to 8,000.

Twelve cities responded and requested the bid questionnaire. At the meeting of the General Service Board in February 1986, the trustees' International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums Committee reviewed these bids and recommended that Las Vegas, Minneapolis/St. Paul, New York, and Tampa not be considered as possible sites for the 1990 International Convention.

All delegate members of the Convention Site Selection Committee were sent the eight remaining completed bid questionnaires in March 1986 and asked to evaluate them. On Wednesday, April 23, 1986, at a dinner meeting of the Site Selection Committee each delegate (in



alphabetical order by city) will give a 10-minute presentation followed by a question-and-answer period. The order will be: Chicago, Dallas, Houston, New Orleans, San Diego, San Francisco, Seattle, and Vancouver. Each delegate will bring a convention bureau representative or other professional to answer questions on their bid presentations. The trustees' International Convention Committee recommended that the Site Selection Committee not determine its city preference in numerical order (i.e., first, second, or third choice) to give the top three cities equal consideration.

The chairperson of the Site Selection Committee will present its recommendations to the Conference on Thursday, April 24, 1986. The Conference recommendation will be presented to the General Service Board for action immediately following the 1986 Conference. The General Service Board will appoint a task force to inspect the recommended cities. Depending on the findings of the task force, a definite acceptance will be forwarded to the selected city by the chairperson of the General Service Board after the August 1986 board weekend. All other bidding cities will also be notified of the board's decision.

Curtis Monahan (G.S.O. staff)

Letting go of old ideas

On Monday evening, Conference members participated in a workshop on a topic relevant to A.A.'s future. Small groups met in separate rooms; Panel 35 delegates, trustees, and directors were moderators and reporters. The following is a summary of the reports from all rooms, giving both the general consensus and, in some cases, reactions from various groups.

New ways of carrying the A.A. message

1 "What efforts are being made in your area to carry the message to young and elderly people, hearing-impaired and deaf alcoholics, Blacks, Spanish-speaking, and other hard-to-reach populations?"

Ten workshops offered much discussion about various minority groups. The consensus was to work with minority populations who are alcoholic in any way you can, with the end goal of getting minority segments involved with mainstream A.A. One workshop suggested that if a minority service member becomes very active, the service structure grows in that population. Use the language of the heart rather than giving a feeling of being different. We need to carry the A.A.

message to these groups by active work through C.P.C., P.I., treatment, and correctional committees, as well. Use subcommittees, with the ultimate goal of all A.A. members being part of a regular A.A. group.

Young people: (a) Encourage the start of young people's groups and late-night meetings; (b) support young people's groups, including I.C.Y.P.A.A., and encourage them into service; (c) have young people on the program when giving P.I. talks in schools; (d) encourage young people to become G.S.R.s and active on area committees; (e) sponsor young people with Steps, Traditions, and Concepts; (f) communicate and understand age differences.

The elderly: (a) Pick up elderly people and take them to A.A. meetings; (b) hold A.A. meetings in senior citizens' homes; (c) take tapes, A.A. literature, and Grapevines to elderly people in rest homes; (d) through community-action programs, let elderly people know that A.A. is available; (e) explain wheelchair-type meetings listed in A.A. directories, and list "accessibility" for the physically disabled on meeting cards; (f) enlist volunteers at intergroups to make house calls to the elderly and take them to meetings; (g) inform housebound A.A.s about the *Loners-Internationalists Meeting by Mail*.

Blacks: (a) Encourage the start of A.A. groups for Black people; (b) use ideas from other minority groups already discussed (some areas expressed no real concern in regard to the Black population in A.A.—Blacks are involved in all aspects of service, especially in large cities; in other areas Blacks are engaged in minimal service activity).

Spanish-speaking alcoholics: (a) Start more Spanish-speaking groups and distribute more Spanish A.A. literature; (b) some areas have Spanish-speaking districts where G.S.R.s attend area assemblies; (c) encourage translating area newsletters into Spanish; (d) encourage forming more Spanish intergroups.

Indians: (a) Encourage the Indian population into mainstream A.A. (some wish to be left alone); (b) look into translation solutions in understanding Twelve Steps, Twelve Traditions, and Twelve Concepts for Indians; (c) encourage better communication from reservations to districts to areas; (d) implement ideas from the report on Native North Americans into area assembly work through subcommittees.

Hearing-impaired and deaf: (a) Form A.A. groups for deaf alcoholics and have them listed; (b) train A.A. members to use sign language; (c) use A.A. Guidelines on Carrying the A.A. Message to the Hearing-Impaired Alcoholic, and use contacts; (d) install more T.T.Y.s in central and intergroup offices.

Blind people: (a) Use information from G.S.O. on books available in Braille and where to write for pamphlets on tape; (b) form A.A. groups for blind people, and use speakers and tapes; (c) encourage attendance at A.A. meetings by accompanying blind A.A.s to and from meetings.

2 "What is the experience of your area with computerized meetings, videotaping or taping A.A. talks, or other new ways of carrying the A.A. message?"

Computerized meetings: Most areas have had no experience with computerized meetings. There is a computer group in San Mateo, Calif., where A.A.s communicate across the country with one another. Most A.A.s expressed concern about computerized meetings and gave little input.

Videotaping: Videotaping has become a reality. One workshop felt concern about anonymity on videotapes and thought it could become a serious problem if not monitored closely. Most workshops felt videotaping could be hazardous, and several workshops took a sense of the meeting against videotaping.

Taping: There are thousands of tapes of A.A. meetings available, including Big Book study groups, "Twelve by Twelve" groups, and tape libraries for Loners. There are catalogs available from tapers for use within the Fellowship. There is so much taping being done within the Fellowship that one workshop expressed concern about control and is waiting for some guideline on taping. Some good uses of taping have been for blind alcoholics, inmates, Loners, and in automobiles. Most felt that a tape does not take the place of a regular A.A. meeting.

It was the sense of most workshops that A.A. is growing so rapidly that these new methods being used probably do more good than harm. Most A.A.s are opposed to videotaping A.A. talks.

Are we becoming too rigid?

1 "Share the experience of groups in your area being *inclusive* rather than *exclusive* of new members with problems in addition to alcoholism."

The consensus of most workshops was that our responsibility is to help the new person be comfortable in A.A. Newcomers with problems other than alcohol are made familiar with other self-help fellowships. Some groups insist you talk only about alcohol and read statements at the beginning of meetings. These "exclusive" statements generally reaffirm our singleness of purpose.

It was suggested that A.A. members continue to be patient as newcomers gravitate to where they are comfortable. Frustration should not cloud the fact that progress is being made. We could have more greeters at the door to reach out and get acquainted with the new person. We need to respect our Traditions, emphasizing that there is a solution—recovery from alcoholism.

The bottom line is that good sponsorship results in good home group participation. The great majority of workshops felt that the dual addiction situation is improving. There is a lot of one-on-one sharing with new members having problems other than alcohol. The result is that the message continues to be carried, and that A.A. sticks to its singleness of purpose: "to stay sober and help other alcoholics achieve sobriety."

2 "How well do groups in your area differentiate between rigidity and the spirit of our Traditions?"

Many workshops said, "Be less rigid!" Other workshops mentioned that rigidity lacks the tolerance to reach the suffering alcoholic in the usual A.A. spirit. There is a difference between rigidity and group structure. The group structure gives life to the newcomer who is in desperate need for some routine in the A.A. group.

It was clear from the sharing that we need to broaden our knowledge of the Traditions. Some workshops mentioned that some groups took Traditions very seriously, holding Traditions meetings, and from these groups the spirit of the Traditions is intact; other groups do not discuss the Traditions at all or understand them very much and conduct group affairs in a very rigid fashion. If we follow the Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions, then we are not being too rigid; we are

simply following what our founders left us. Our obligation to the new person is to lead him or her through the Steps and explain the Twelve Traditions. If we stay within the spirit of our Traditions, the future of A.A. is secure.

In regard to dual addiction, be less rigid! People with dual problems will help others. For those without an alcohol problem, provide them with alternatives and inform them of other self-help fellowships. After the meeting, let the Third Tradition govern. An A.A. member defines his or her own sobriety. We carry the spirit of love and recovery from alcoholism. One workshop shared that it is not always the newcomer that causes problems but the oldtimer, as well, in practicing rigidity. Give the newcomer time to identify and get used to us and the principles of A.A. Our Traditions are not rules to be obeyed but principles to be honored.

3 "Discuss whether A.A. is in danger of becoming ritualized."

One workshop mentioned that some ritualization seems necessary for stability. Group autonomy is important. Home groups need to guard against becoming ritualized by keeping flexible and spontaneous. Another workshop mentioned that ritualization is not necessarily bad but can be overdone. We need to maintain moderation.

The general sharing indicated that A.A. is not in danger of becoming ritualized. The custom of holding hands, saying the Lord's Prayer, and reading the Traditions and "How It Works" is not ritualization but spiritualization.

4 "In a climate of change, how may we learn to face the future fearlessly? How are we doing in the basics—guided by the Steps, the spirit of our Traditions, and the Concepts?"

We can face the future fearlessly by reading and studying our past history: *A.A. Comes of Age*. We need to keep our *basics*: the Steps, Traditions, Concepts, and *sponsorship*. Love replaces fear! We can practice these principles more consistently and effectively.

Understanding, love, and tolerance is suggested. Oldtimers have to change; newcomers and oldtimers learn by listening to each other, *not* by taking each other's inventory. Steps and Traditions meetings help. The new way is the old way. Keep an open mind!

It appeared from the sharing that the basics need repetition—Steps, Traditions, and Concepts. The general message was that, regardless of the climate of change in our society, of which A.A. is a part, the basics, being principles that have come down through the ages, can guide us toward doing the only thing that we need to do—carry the message to the suffering alcoholic.





John Hartley Smith, M.D., newly elected nonalcoholic trustee, has vast experience in the occupational and public health fields.

'Pass it on'

On Tuesday morning, the 36th Conference began with an address by "Dr. Jack" Norris, trustee emeritus, who shared an enlightening overview of A.A.'s heritage.

What are we passing on? A way of life that has brought happiness to untold thousands of people all over the world without regard to country, creed, or culture. How does this happen? We share our experience, strength, and hope with each other and carry the message of recovery to other alcoholics without thought of reward other than the strengthening of our own recovery.

What is the message? That recovery is possible for anyone who really wants to recover if they are willing to "go to any lengths" to achieve it; that there is a way, open to anyone, anywhere, spelled out in the Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions.

For the future, as for our past, the Traditions answer many questions and help us over many rough spots. All of them are important. Each one has stopped many arguments as we have sought the group conscience described in Tradition Two.

We pass on our literature—books, pamphlets, and guidelines that are the record of shared experience. We pass on our history—stories of people (members and nonmembers alike) who were there at the right time with the right ideas and who lived the program and have passed it on to us. We pass on the structure. Each group is autonomous, remaining the most important unit in the structure. Without the group and its members carrying the message, all else is irrelevant.

The General Service Conference is a week of sharing our concerns about the Fellowship, of learning about problems in other parts of the U.S. and Canada, and working out solutions. It is also a week of reviewing the year at G.S.O. and the work and decisions of the trustees' committees, criticizing or approving those actions. The groups, through the Conference, have the final say.

We pass on a world structure with service boards in many countries patterned more or less after our own General Service Board. Several of them have nonalcoholic trustees; each one is autonomous. Every two years, delegates from all the boards meet to share experience and learn from each other.

This is my 36th Conference. They have all been the same but all different as we have adjusted to changes in the world around us. All have been exciting for me because the major concern of every one has been what is good for A.A. So long as this has remained in focus, all else falls into place. Always, so far, the Conference has resisted the "my way is the only way" approach and has postponed making a decision until "substantial unanimity" has been achieved—until the group conscience has been found. So long as we continue in this way, A.A. will continue to be the "island of sanity in a world gone mad."

John L. Norris, M.D. (trustee emeritus)

The committee system

On Tuesday morning, three presentations on the committee system stimulated thoughtful discussion by Conference members. Jack Whitehouse, East Central U.S. regional trustee, moderated the session.

Do we trust it?

I believe our committee system grew out of a need to get the job done in a reasonable and efficient manner. A few people were asked to review, investigate, and make proposals to a larger body—alcoholics finally accepted responsibility and were trusted. Were they responsible because they were trusted? Or were they trusted because they were finally responsible?

I was introduced to committees at the group level. Responsibilities were assigned to a committee to accomplish some of the group's activities. We usually accepted their suggestions. Was this trust or the idea of "letting someone else do it"? The second time committees played a role in my service activities was at the district level—the tasks were divided and assigned to committees. Usually the committees' actions were accepted as the district's. Was this trust, or were the committees' actions accepted out of necessity or laziness?

At the area level, committees were formal entities of the area, or "standing committees," and they were fairly constant year after year. When our area structure changed, the committees' assignments changed. Committees' recommendations were not automatically accepted. Occasionally they were challenged—many times with

On April 25, 1986, the 36th General Service Conference sent the following telegram to Milton Maxwell, Ph.D., at his home in Olympia, Washington. Dr. Maxwell is a trustee emeritus and former chairperson of the General Service Board. He was unable to attend the Conference due to illness.

Resolution

In recognition of trustee emeritus Dr. Milton Maxwell's many contributions to Alcoholics Anonymous, the 36th General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous hereby extends its heartfelt appreciation for his past efforts and its grateful anticipation of his continuing guidance and support.

lively debate. At the area committee meeting, a solution was arrived at or the subject was tabled. Either you accepted a committee's recommendation or you challenged and debated the issue. If you accepted, was that trust? If you challenged, does that mean you did not trust the committee?

Finally, the Conference committee system was introduced to my service life. All Conference members understand this system (or you will) because you see it in action and are a part of it. Is this why you trust it? Do you trust it? There is a feeling, an aura, about the Conference committee system. I can't believe that it is anything but trust that makes it work.

From our service beginnings, we became "trusted servants." Should I trust the committees? Or should I challenge everything until it is logically apparent without any doubt? Our service structure is built on trust, and consequently so are our committees. We trust the group conscience deliberations of the committees, but we may not agree or support their recommendations.

Robert Neerland (Eastern Pennsylvania)

Does it eliminate conflict?

The Alcoholic Foundation, established by Bill Wilson, was, in effect, a committee when it first began. When the General Service Board itself replaced the Foundation, our co-founder and trustees tried to operate as a single committee. When this proved impossible, the committee system evolved. We now have 12 Conference committees, which enable all A.A. business to be discussed thoroughly before recommendations are made before the entire Conference.

Like almost everything in A.A., the committee system grew out of our service experience, necessitated by A.A.'s rapid growth and success. Does it eliminate conflict? We know it would be too unwieldy without the committee system. The Twelve Concepts provide for all elements of A.A. to make their individual contributions to the decision making, and thus each of the 12 Conference committees has its place in the overall process.

The Conference committees are drawn by lot, but the nontrustee members of the trustees' committees are chosen for their experience, both in A.A. and in business or occupation. How could we function without the help of these dedicated non-A.A. trustees? The Conference members receive quarterly reports from the board of trustees' meetings. Their expertise certainly helps eliminate conflict when the delegates meet for the Conference.

Is our committee system eliminating conflict? I think so. Probably we all find fault from time to time, mostly when we don't get our own way. I must remember there is a Master Planner who set up our service structure and the committee system through His divine guidance, just as He has guided A.A. from its very beginning.

Eléanor Boyle (District of Columbia)

How can it be improved?

The A.A. Service Manual points out that Conference committees are made up by lot because it would be impractical for delegates to choose the committees on which they would like to serve. I do not concur with this. I think committee selection should be determined by what area committee the delegate has served in the past. For example, if a delegate has served well as corrections chairperson in an area, he or she certainly should be on the Correctional Facilities Committee. Also, if a delegate is employed by the media, wouldn't he or she naturally be on the P.I. Committee? The balance could be filled by lot.

The 1965 Conference recommended that delegates be able to refuse their assignments; however, in 1971, this choice was removed, and delegates were committed without having any voice in the matter. Since this is the case, why aren't more explicit guidelines available for each committee? The guidelines could be sent to delegates when notifying them of their committee selection so they could become informed of their committees' concerns.

One of the duties of the Conference Policy/Admissions Committee is to approve or disapprove requests for additional delegate areas. What criteria should be met before making such a request? It was suggested that areas get more districts—more committee members—rather than more delegates. With A.A.'s rapid growth, I feel this should be more clearly defined. How much can one delegate do and still do justice to each district?

We encourage more workshops and committees. Delegates are expected to go to these workshops and committee meetings. Alternate delegates do help, but many districts insist that the delegate attend. How does one cope with this? I foresee more delegates in the not too distant future if we are to maintain the proper, adequate duties to each district and still fulfill our many social engagements.



Amos E. Reed, recently elected nonalcoholic trustee, has an extensive background in corrections, education, and public welfare.

A message from HB?

Conference members who delivered talks at the front of the Terrace Room were startled when they looked up and saw two heart-shaped balloons stuck to the ceiling, each carrying the inscription "I love you." Some confided that they felt reassured by this message from "HB" (higher balloons).

In summary, I leave you with these questions: (1) Have we gained enough expertise since the 1971 Conference action to warrant selecting delegates for committees by appointment rather than by lot? (2) Is there a need for new guidelines to be issued to new committee members? (3) Should the question of additional areas and, therefore, more delegates be redefined?

Millie Baeseman (Southern Wisconsin)

Archives—past lights the future

After lunch on Tuesday, three presentations on the archives offered new perspectives on our responsibilities for preserving A.A.'s history. Garrett Taylor, Northeast U.S. regional trustee, was the moderator.

How does it further our primary purpose?

A.A. owes a great debt of gratitude to the Oxford Group. Our spirituality, style, and tone are the direct results of this group's influence on Bill Wilson and Dr. Bob Smith. The Oxford Group ideas prevail in the original Six Steps, which were "six chunks of truth" that were broken into smaller pieces—the Twelve Steps as we know them today.

Why, then, are we not called "Oxford Anonymous"? Many reasons account for the alcoholics' departure from the Oxford Group: Evangelism, personal publicity, and placing the word "absolute" before their principles were among the top ten. But the most pronounced reason was the Oxford Group's appeal to people with all types of problems. Bill Wilson was convinced that alcoholics needed to work with their own kind.

The Washingtonian Society of the 1800s also influenced the principles of A.A. Composed entirely of alcoholics, it flourished as long as it remained faithful to helping other alcoholics achieve sobriety. But it permitted politicians and reformers to use the society for their own purposes, and the original strong, simple group purpose was dissipated in fruitless controversy and divergent aims.



Dorothy McGinity (nonalcoholic), coordinator of the Conference Manual.

What does all this have to do with our past furthering our primary purpose? Our past experience with the Oxford Group and Washingtonian Society emphasizes why we cannot afford to let outside interests prevent us from helping the alcoholics who still suffer.

Recently an A.A. group opened its doors to people with all kinds of addictions, deciding that everyone with a compulsion could get well in one society. The excitement was high—they felt they were the first to start the "new wave" of what eventually would become commonplace in A.A. Thus, A.A.s, N.A.s, O.A.s, G.A.s, E.A.s, C.A.s, A.C.A.s, and X.Y.Z.A.s met together faithfully, with each addiction having five minutes to share at each meeting. But discontent soon set in. People with one kind of addiction found their own problems to be far more serious than the problems of other kinds of addictions. Consequently, two-thirds of the proposed participants left.

Lois Fischer (Northeast Ohio)

Reaching earlytimers for local archives

A number of our members have been in A.A. for some time. In fact, not a few are "earlytimers"—those who were members in the formative years in a given area. They can be from the '40s or early '50s in some areas, or from the 60s or even 70s in other areas. We're looking for more oral histories and historical material from the early times of A.A.

Sadly, many A.A. pioneers have left us, and more soon will. Too often, with them passes an untold tale of ourselves and tangible evidence of our A.A. history in the form of one-of-a-kind documents, pamphlets, books, etc. To arrest this loss, the trustees' Archives Committee offers a plan to focus the service structure on gathering these valuable documents for local archives before they are lost. The issue seems simple: asking earlytimers to donate these items. But experience shows that there are problems identifying and locating earlytimers since many no longer attend meetings. Also, they are reluctant to part with material. Reaching these earlytimers and inviting them to participate are the goals of this plan.

The Archives Committee has available an Archives Handbook, which covers many important considerations in encouraging donations of valued collectibles. It is best to begin with a rotating committee that includes some earlytimers because they are invaluable in fostering fresh, detailed, and lengthy oral histories. The committee has more stamina when connected to the area structure, facilitating budget preparation and accountability as well as a strong connection to the Fellowship.

The local committee has many other responsibilities: gathering, sorting, repairing, protecting, inventorying, organizing, developing finding aids to help researchers, and establishing policies of access and confidentiality. A nonrotating archivist will provide continuity for custodial care, developing finding aids, and management.

The concerted operation of approaching prospective donors can begin with a phone call or letter from the committee, scheduling a visit. During the visit, an oral history might be taken and historical material identified and discussed as being suitable for the local archives.

The trustees' Archives Committee urges all service structure members to broadcast news of this undertaking, including announcements at area assemblies, Forums, and conferences.

Frank Mauser (archivist)

What about a Conference Archives Committee?

What are the A.A. archives? The validation of our history. The clearinghouse of our shared experience. The documentation of our most precious heritage. The Archives Department is one of the most important functions of G.S.O., and it should be just as important at the Conference.

The archives' message—"Don't throw me away; I belong to A.A."—needs to be carried to the grassroots of the Fellowship, and what better way than through the general service structure. At this time, there is only a trustees' Archives Committee, and the archives sometimes get lost or put on the back burner. It seems the Fellowship hasn't yet addressed the reality that the archives' message must be carried *loud and clear* to all groups and members. Aren't the archives as important as literature or treatment facilities?

A Conference Archives Committee would effectively carry the message and focus on the issues of that message by making the archives visible throughout the Fellowship as a whole. Whenever delegates are personally involved in an issue, the message has a better chance of being carried to the groups. The emphasis of an issue falls to the delegates, and they seem to "pick up the ball and run with it."

Marian Hutchison (Utah)

Literature helps carry the message

On Tuesday afternoon, four presentations dealing with A.A. literature generated much discussion. Stanley Silverman, Grapevine director, moderated the session.

Using A.A. Conference-approved literature to carry the message

The first piece of literature given to me by my sponsor was "Is A.A. for You?" This pamphlet gave me 12 symptoms of alcoholism summed up in 12 questions. By honestly answering those 12 questions, I was able to identify myself as an alcoholic.

All Conference-approved publications go through a lengthy and painstaking process of review by trustees' and Conference committees, and the final product represents the informed group conscience of A.A. as a whole. A.A. Conference-approved literature assists alcoholics in many ways. It reaches out to all alcoholics, regardless of race, age, or gender. Whether given by a sponsor or sent by a loving concerned friend or mate, whether read in a hotel room, bathroom, or jail cell, it has helped many who suffer from the disease of alcoholism to recognize their problem.

A.A. Conference-approved literature serves a broad range of persons today who otherwise would be without the proper knowledge of A.A. Braille Big Books and *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* are available for the blind and visually handicapped. Special literature is written for the deaf. A.A. literature is also printed in many languages. Audiovisual material is available. A.A. literature helps the medical profession understand the purpose, function, and types of A.A. meetings.

A.A. Conference-approved literature is the second best means of carrying the A.A. message and plays a very important part in the recovery process.

Emily Rayford (Southeast New York)



Using the A.A. Grapevine to carry the message

The GvR in my group has carried the Grapevine in her purse for years. She says that at first she was concerned about her anonymity, but discovered that the Grapevine comes in a plain brown envelope with the return address: P.O. Box 1980, New York, N.Y. When her children were small, while waiting at doctors' offices, swimming lessons, piano lessons, etc., she would have mini-meetings with fellow alcoholics from all over the world.

The Grapevine can be given to new members and as birthday and Christmas presents; it can be left in professional offices and on buses. Some groups give a year's subscription to first-year birthday people. Some treatment centers give a year's subscription to patients when they leave. The Grapevine calendar lists local area events for travelers.

If you have a Grapevine and one or more alcoholics, with or without coffee (preferably with), you can have a meeting on the Preamble, the Twelve Steps, the Twelve Traditions, and a wide choice of subject matter. Also, the "gray pages" give information on alcoholism, including research and treatment, with notes, quotes, and reviews.

There is a need for special Grapevine meetings and weekends, such as the Grape-a-Thon held in Denver, Colorado, early this year. How about increasing the use of Grapevine displays at conventions, conferences, roundups, etc.? Grapevine tapes are especially helpful to drivers. The Grapevine should work with other service committees to carry the message to the still-suffering alcoholic.

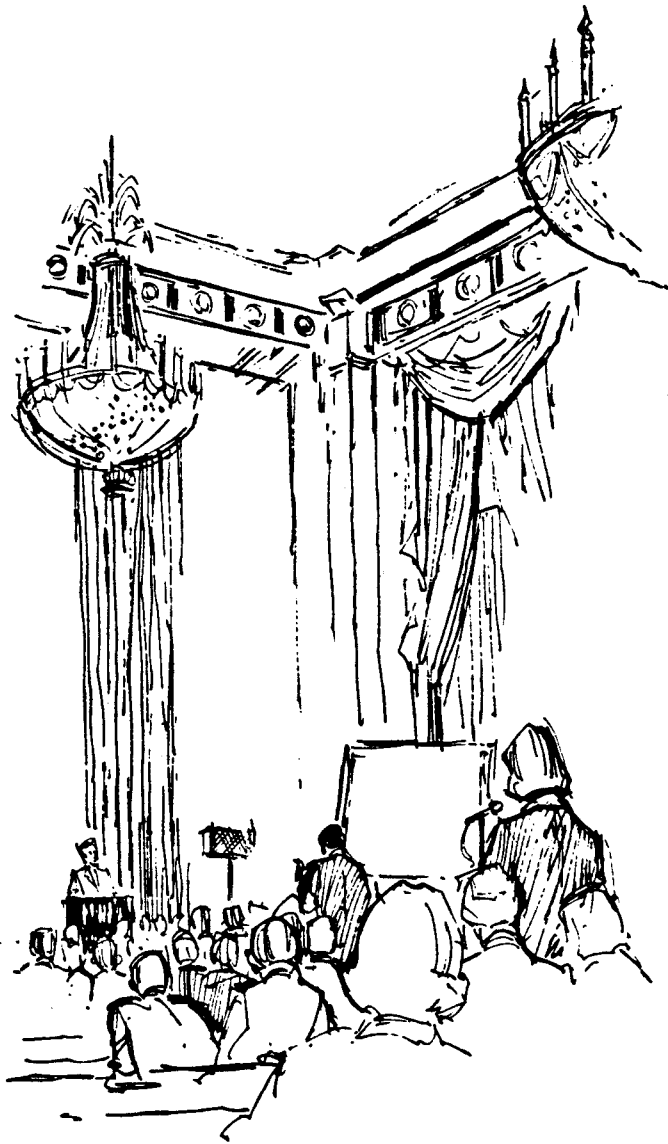
Josh Hill (South Florida)

Dealing with non-A.A. literature

What does a newcomer think when he or she comes to an A.A. meeting for the first time and someone opens and chairs the meeting out of a meditation book, perhaps even referring to his or her own Higher Power by name? Even some A.A. members with years of sobriety don't know what is and isn't Conference-approved literature.

The C.P.C. committee suggests you sponsor your doctor, hopefully inviting him or her to attend an open A.A. meeting. He comes to the meeting, and they are showing a film of a priest talking about alcoholism. No one mentions that this is *not* an A.A. film. Then he picks up some literature. Everything he picks up is non-Conference-approved literature. To him or anyone else coming for information, this is A.A.: "I got it at an A.A. meeting, so this must be what it's all about."

One way of dealing with non-A.A. literature is through the G.S.R.; one of the duties of the G.S.R. is to inform the group about Conference-



approved literature. Another way is to inform the group yourself (it's usually not too well received). A third way is when the hat is passed, don't put any money in; if they ask, tell them why. This usually gets their attention and remarks. Or just don't go to that group any more.

Who can speak for A.A. as a whole? Not me, that's for sure—I'm too opinionated. No one person can. Our A.A. message comes from our literature. It's a message that means life to an alcoholic like me, written by alcoholics for alcoholics.

Dennis Moore (Eastern Missouri)

P.A. system powerlessness

It took a while for Conference members to adjust to the "sometimes spooky" behavior of the hotel's P.A. system (some members never did get used to it). Occasionally during Conference week, police broadcasts, emergency calls, etc., flooded the P.A. system sporadically. (The hotel claimed complete powerlessness over this peculiar P.A. system.)

How do we best prevent the A.A. message from being diluted or distorted?

What is this A.A. message that we're worried about diluting or distorting? As far as I'm concerned, it's nothing more than meeting a sufferer who's suffering and simply telling him or her that there's hope—there's help—there's a way out. If that's the message, dilution and distortion simply don't apply because we are sharing our experience. But is it really that simple?

Do we carry the message in other ways? Sure we do, through all kinds of vehicles and pamphlets. Committee systems constantly strive to improve the tools we all use to carry the message, producing the literature, films, and radio and TV spots that find their way to every corner of this country and the world.

A.A.'s literature is another way of keeping our message from becoming diluted or distorted. A lot of loving care goes into our literature, and its potential to extend and multiply our individual efforts is really awesome. The bottom line, as it's always been, is honest one-on-one sharing of our experience, strength, and hope.

Dilution? Distortion? Should we really be concerned about *what* we say or about *how* we say it? I think not. If each of us strives as honestly to tell another human being what we have experienced, then the light from those single candles will have enormous impact in reducing the suffering of our still-suffering alcoholic brothers and sisters.

William Croke (A.A.W.S. director)

Anonymity

Just before lunch on Wednesday, Conference members heard the following presentations, which shared new insights on A.A.'s anonymity Traditions. Don Pritts, trustee-at-large/U.S., was the moderator.

Should "TV" be added to the Eleventh Tradition?

Television has been in existence for over 40 years and is now reaching more people than press, radio, and films combined. It may be time to take another look at the importance of keeping our personal anonymity at the level of TV also.

The conscience of all A.A. groups throughout the world will be a guideline to follow and take action upon. This being quite a project, we should start by putting the wheels in motion as soon as possible. A committee should be selected to establish proper procedures to make this project a success.

I would like to see the word "TV" inserted in our Eleventh Tradition simply because if it is, all forms of communication will be covered: visual, audio, and print. When I was writing this presentation, my mind kept going back to the problem we had with the Big Book copyright, and it sold me on the idea of inserting "TV" into the Eleventh Tradition. The more we safeguard our Steps and Traditions, the more secure we will all be in the A.A. Fellowship.

Noel Quesnelle (Northeast Ontario)

At the public level—what's at issue?

At issue is anonymity as the spiritual foundation of all our Traditions. It protects the individual member from notoriety, disciplines A.A. to place principles before personalities, retards the growth of self-appointed oracles, and ensures a safe haven for newcomers.

How can we make sure that the media do not break the anonymity Traditions? We must understand and help other A.A.s to understand that it is we, not the media, who are responsible for anonymity at the public level. Yes, we inform the media, but we must be assertive enough to remain anonymous at the public level.

Our *personal* anonymity in public ensures each A.A. member the freedom to journey along his or her own sober path, to bring an individual perspective to the same truth, and to experience the precious gift of sobriety firsthand. By remaining anonymous at the public level, we are protected from the egocentric individual who would not hesitate to interpret the Fellowship for all of us and straighten out all of us.

We need to stay aware of the considerable stigma that surrounds our disease in the minds of many, including the potential A.A. member. Anonymity shields the newcomer—and all of us—from prejudice and ensures still-suffering alcoholics that they are safe with us.

Why, then, do we need public information? Why not just keep quiet about our Fellowship? We need to publicize A.A. but not A.A. members. The principle of anonymity reveals to us its "immense spiritual significance" and teaches us to "practice a genuine humility."

Eileen Gatz (G.S.O. staff)

Anonymity within the Fellowship

For an A.A. member to remain strictly anonymous is his or her business, but most of us find that anonymity, to this degree, is not necessary or even practical. After some time in A.A., a member may enter into a service job in the group, district, or area. In this work, you lose your anonymity within the Fellowship because last names are essential to service work. What was your reaction when you realized that someone out there would read your last name on A.A. material?

Within the Fellowship, members use full names when they wish. We guard the anonymity of everyone else in the Fellowship. Of course, anonymity goes beyond the use of last names. It is important that members feel secure, that nothing or no one seen or heard at a meeting is revealed. Common sense in the use of anonymity provides a sense of freedom and security.

In twelfth-step work, anonymity may vary, but we must remember that the new person's anonymity is a must. Should our last names be given to the telephone answering service, treatment center, local hospital, police department, or welfare agency? In some areas, last names are used; and in other areas, it's a definite "no-no." The choice should be up to the individual.

John Denham (West Virginia)

What did he say?

Bill Wilson (Panel 35, Chicago) startled Conference members by introducing himself at the mike as "I'm Bill Wilson, Channel 35, Chicago."

Spiritual substance of anonymity

In looking for words powerful enough to describe the spiritual substance of anonymity, I concluded that they are words used in our daily A.A. lives—love, sacrifice, honesty, service, and humility. It followed that anonymity, as we perceive it in A.A., *always* has spiritual substance. It begins with protecting the trusting disclosure of a fellow member's identity. It has to do with the reverent, mutual confidentiality given to our moments and hours of sharing our experience, strength, and hope as well as our weaknesses. It concerns the willingness of the A.A. member to be as *nonanonymous* as necessary to effectively carry the message within the Eleventh Tradition.

Spiritual substance is found in the anonymity abounding at every tier of the A.A. structure. From the individual member through the group, district, area, and at the corporate level, this spiritual substance flows, uniting our society, pulling us together to serve a common cause—helping the still-suffering alcoholic.

To paraphrase Bill Wilson in *As Bill Sees It*, the spiritual substance of anonymity is found in our unselfish use of the media. It is in asking nothing for ourselves but understanding when carrying the message to public or semipublic gatherings. In the *Twelve and Twelve*, he says that anonymity begets humility, and humility begets spirituality, so that in our way of life, the three are synonymous and inseparable.

"I salute you, and I thank you for your lives." This ancient Arabian salutation was part of Bill's last message to A.A. in a letter read by Lois at the N.Y. Intergroup Association dinner honoring Bill's 36th anniversary in November 1970. (Bill was unable to attend due to illness; he died on January 24, 1971.) This last message from A.A.'s co-founder also addressed anonymity: "... I deeply believe that the principle of anonymity must remain our primary and enduring safeguard. As long as we accept our sobriety in our traditional spirit of anonymity we will continue to receive God's Grace."

Chuck Furtaw (Central Michigan)¹

¹ Chuck Furtaw was unable to attend the Conference due to illness; his presentation was read by Lorraine Burks, alternate delegate from Central Michigan.



Key Roosevelt and G.S.O. personnel, responsible for a smooth-running 36th Conference (from left to right): Richard Glick, the Roosevelt's banquet manager; Freddie Frankenberg, captain; Tony Osnato, G.S.O.'s events coordinator; and Sal Paredes, head waiter.

Communication in service

The Wednesday-afternoon Conference session concluded with the following presentations on a topic of great concern for A.A.'s service network. Joe Phelan, Southeast U.S. regional trustee, served as moderator.

Communicating responsibility in service

Early in my sobriety, my group chose me to be their G.S.R.; it was then that my education began. As G.S.R., I was my group's link with A.A. as a whole, the means of conveying my group's views and needs to the Conference. Through me, if I acted in a responsible manner, my group, in turn, learned how other groups solved common problems, not only in my area, but all over the U.S. and Canada. Just as we all learn about recovery from A.A.s who have experienced sobriety, so I have also learned about the problems of communication and service from my fellow G.S.R.s and other service workers.

In the Colorado Area we use all our service literature for workshops, for G.S.R.s and D.C.M.s, at our assembly, and around our area. Box 4-5-9 and monthly newsletters from central offices and area committees are also great tools for carrying the communication from G.S.O. through the G.S.R. to the group.

Communicating responsibility in service is also done through committees, such as P.I., C.P.C., and prison and institutions, working with the media and communicating our A.A. message of recovery to schools, doctors, attorneys, courts, treatment centers, and prisons.

Ed Price (Colorado)

Why be a trusted servant?

When I first came to A.A., I noticed that some members seemed more serene and happy than others. I asked them for their recipe, their secret for this. All had the same answer: service. I wanted so much to be like they were, to have this serenity, this peace of mind, that I accepted very early to serve after coming to A.A.

I am a trusted servant because to be one demands love, tolerance, and respect for others. And as I am a very selfish person, I want so much to be loved—to have people tolerate and respect me. And I fully realize that the only way I can achieve this is by first giving to others around me, to be a trusted servant. One other aspect of why I am a trusted servant is that, as a shareholder in this great fraternity, I am very much interested in knowing what's going on, in having something to do about the choice of our representatives, our servants at all levels.

Why be a trusted servant? Maybe because I often have to consult and peruse our literature, and, by doing so, I keep seeing words and phrases such as "action," "humility," and "principles before personalities." I was certainly a man of action while drinking, but always in the wrong directions and places. As for humility, I never suffered from an overdose of it; and I had to do a lot of work on myself to acquire some degree of humility so that I was able to help others instead of wanting to be glorified because of it. I had to come to understand fully the meaning of placing "principles before personalities."

Maurice Rondeau (Southeast Quebec)

Encouraging young people in service

Young people have come to A.A. in such large numbers. Many young people formed their own groups; the first was formed in 1945. Young people's groups are numerous and apply the same structure as any other group. They have been called "special interest groups," but I do not agree with this philosophy. Young people are men, women, heterosexual, gay, white, minority, etc., and do grow up to become oldtimers.

Young people are very involved in our service structure; however, I believe we have made this beginning only in recent years. The following points can be extremely helpful in carrying this very significant service message: (1) make service appealing; (2) attend a young people's conference; (3) offer them sponsorship and service sponsorship; (4) become acquainted with their leadership in your community and invite them to participate; (5) gain their confidence and listen with an open mind; and (6) look at where we are more alike than where we are different.

I can't think of any concern that requires more commitment to our future than carrying the service message to our young members. The path of service will help each of us along the greater journey of awakening and where we are the most fulfilled. Isn't that always the way it has been since the beginning? The theme of this Conference is "A.A.'s Future—Our Responsibility." The young A.A. members are our future. Our commitment to them needs to be unconditional. We move out in love, fully knowing the glory of the Fellowship in A.A. is through service to one and all.

Natalie Schwanke (Pacific U.S. regional trustee)

Communicating with each other

Eleven years of my sobriety have been dedicated to our Third Legacy, Service. My sponsor guided me into service work very early, for which I am truly grateful.

Today, I visit our central office almost every day to keep abreast of what is going on in our six Baton Rouge districts. How many of you do the same in your area? I also attend the monthly meetings of G.S.R.s and D.C.M.s and try to keep them informed of communications from G.S.O. and the area assembly. I suggest that each D.C.M. work with all G.S.R.s or groups in their districts that are not involved in district meetings or assemblies. Do you do the same in your area?

We have quarterly area assemblies at a city located in the central part of the state. On Saturday afternoons, there are service workshops (rotated by districts). Between assemblies, I try to keep in touch (by phone or letter) with the other officers. Are your areas similar to ours?

In my opinion, the G.S.O. staff are the most dedicated and hard-working people I have ever had the honor and pleasure of coming to know and love!

D. T. Waller Jr. (Louisiana)

Then and now

Thirty years ago, Bill Schmidt (Panel 36, Mid-Southern California) was kicked out of the Roosevelt Hotel in a drunken stupor. Bill was both amazed and grateful to have returned sober and as a 1986 Conference delegate.



A.A.'s impact on the world

Following a dinner on Wednesday evening, Conference members participated in a workshop to evaluate A.A.'s role on contemporary society. Small groups met in separate rooms; Panel 35 delegates, trustees, and directors were moderators and reporters. The following is a summary of the reports from all rooms, giving both the general consensus and, in some cases, reactions from various groups.

Are we being friendly with our friends (how A.A. cooperates)?

1 "What is being done in your community to carry the message to physicians, members of the clergy, educators, and other professionals?"

A long list of activities being done by A.A. members was presented. P.I. and C.P.C. committees are the primary vehicle by which the A.A. message is being carried to professionals. Groups can sponsor "bring-a-friend" meetings, where members accompany professionals to an open A.A. meeting. They are given intergroup or individual A.A. members' phone numbers. Service meetings and workshops help A.A. members learn about their responsibility in helping professionals.

Using literature to inform professionals about the A.A. program was also stressed. A.A. and Grapevine literature can be distributed to schools, hospitals, senior citizens' homes, doctors' offices, correctional and treatment facilities, churches, E.A.P.s, and libraries. Some success has been reported in leaving an A.A. contact phone number with A.A. literature. Working with medical students, nurses, and medical schools has been well received in many areas. Intergroups can have lists of A.A. members who are willing to speak to professionals. Some caution was expressed that A.A. speakers deal only with A.A.'s message and primary purpose and not become involved in direct alcohol education.

The establishment and maintenance of C.P.C. and P.I. committees working within the guidelines presented above and in their respective workbooks should provide community professionals with adequate A.A. exposure.

2 "How are non-A.A. friends made welcome at open meetings in your area?"

Welcome and greet non-A.A. friends with handshakes by having greeters at the door. Inform visitors about the meeting and what will transpire and that as "observers" they need not participate. Groups may offer literature and the opportunity to answer non-A.A. friends' questions after the meeting. Medical, nursing, social service, and public health students are required to go to A.A. meetings in many areas. Special open A.A. meetings could be held for non-A.A. friends, with adequate community announcement.

In general, it was agreed that improvement can be made. Some groups reported the feeling of being "invaded" when large numbers of observers attend. In one region a plan has spread whereby roundups and other A.A. activities begin with an open P.I. luncheon, with the roundup key speakers giving a brief talk suitable to non-A.A.s who have been sponsored and invited by groups and members.

3 "How do you cooperate positively with local court drunk-driving programs? Are large numbers of persons being referred to small A.A. groups by the courts? If so, what are the problems?"

There was mixed response to this question. Some areas have good communication with local authorities and some measure of control over the number of referrals. But when smaller groups (fewer than 20 members) are inundated with court referrals, the members felt there was a problem. A common solution to the overcrowding problem was to work with the courts and probation officers by taking meetings to the D.W.I. "schools."

Most courts mandated their clients to have attendance slips signed at A.A. meetings. Some groups sign slips only at the end of meetings to help control those leaving early. Having a rubber stamp with the group's name prevents an A.A. member signing his or her full name. One group presents "desire chips" for an additional 24 hours of sobriety to "referrals" and considers the court card as a "gift certificate" to A.A. rather than being "sentenced to A.A."

Carrying the A.A. message

1 "How do groups in your area share A.A. experience with other self-help fellowships?"

Generally, local A.A. groups are not asked to share A.A. experience with other self-help fellowships, except Al-Anon and Alateen. P.I. and C.P.C. committees usually help other self-help fellowships when questions arise. Many local intergroups provide the phone numbers of other twelve step programs in their meeting lists, and referrals to G.S.O. are often made.

The main concern was that there be no appearance of affiliation but that all visitors be welcome at A.A. open meetings.

2 "What responsibility should we, as A.A. members, have toward Alcoholics Anonymous in other countries?"

As North American A.A. members, our responsibility is to our own G.S.O. We support our local A.A. group, which, in turn, supports the local A.A. structure, which then helps G.S.O. with contributions. G.S.O. (A.A.W.S., Inc.) then can help another country with information and financial aid for publishing until that country's G.S.O. becomes self-supporting.

Groups may adopt Loners and correspond with them. U.S./Canadian groups adopt groups in foreign countries and send them tapes, A.A.



Ed Gordon (nonalcoholic), G.S.O.'s director of finance and business administrator.

literature, Grapevines, and letters. It was suggested that when A.A. members travel to foreign countries they attend meetings and lead by example. Carrying the A.A. message is our primary responsibility wherever we go.

3 "Discuss the following statement from *As Bill Sees It* (page 304):

Single Purpose

"There are those who predict that A.A. may well become a new spearhead for a spiritual awakening throughout the world. When our friends say these things, they are both generous and sincere. But we of A.A. must reflect that such a tribute and such a prophecy could well prove to be a heady drink for most of us—that is, if really came to believe this to be the real purpose of A.A., and if we commenced to behave accordingly.

"Our Society, therefore, will prudently cleave to its single purpose: the carrying of the message to the alcoholic who still suffers. Let us resist the proud assumption that since God has enabled us to do well in one area we are destined to be a channel of saving grace for everybody."

The response to this statement by Bill W. was 100 percent agreement and that the "singleness of purpose" of A.A. be maintained. Our responsibility to our primary purpose in carrying the A.A. message to alcoholics who still suffer in their active or recovering periods of alcoholism remains unchanged. Historical examples were cited of groups that failed when they outgrew their primary purpose.

Our cooperation with other mutual help organizations, i.e., permission to use the Steps, Traditions, Preamble, etc., helps A.A. maintain its single purpose by letting others do their own thing. It was suggested that this statement be read at meetings on occasion; this is already being done at groups in various parts of North America.

The home group—A.A.'s future

Late on Thursday afternoon, Conference members turned their attention to "the heartbeat of A.A." as three presentations explored the importance of the home group. Harold Greene, A.A.W.S. director, moderated the session.

Why have a home group?

In a recent letter to an A.A. member, a G.S.O. staff member referred to the home group as the "heartbeat of A.A." It all began in the home group, didn't it? Not all of us readily identified that mysterious group of people who were trying to help us get sober as our home group. In fact, I am painfully aware that the commitment needed to become a part of anything escapes many in early stages of recovery.

When we took those first faltering steps to recovery, many of us would have stumbled and fallen once again if we had to make what was to be a miraculous change by ourselves. In my case, the first rays of hope came from those sometimes loving, sometimes cantankerous old geezers that sat around the table in my hometown.

It seems to me that, in the beginning, the home group is all most of us can possibly handle. It's where we first find a sponsor, where someone sees that we get a Big Book, where we first see the Steps, where we learn again to pray, and where we begin to recover. But most of all, because of the trust that develops in home group meetings, it is where we begin to care about someone else so that we might eventually begin to love again.

In the home group, we learn to take responsibility so that we might eventually take responsibility for our lives. (In my case, that began with the simple chore of cleaning out ashtrays. How wise that they knew I could do no more!) We learn to do twelfth-step work so that we may pass on to others what was so freely given to us. We learn about the rest of the Fellowship and all the mysteries of what makes it all work.

With this week at the Conference, this phase of my service to the Fellowship, of paying back a small measure of my gratitude, begins to wind down. What will I do now? If I am very, very lucky, those who are doing such a marvelous job of serving the Fellowship in my home group just might allow me to make coffee and maybe even talk to a drunk.

Richard Bush (Western Missouri)

Can a member join several A.A. groups?

Our Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions contain not a single "can't." When we come into A.A., we find a greater personal freedom than any other society knows. We cannot be compelled to do or not do anything. Therefore, I must assume members can join all the groups they choose.

Perhaps the question should be discussed as an "ought" or "should a member join several A.A. groups?" After graduation from a treatment center, I attended my first meeting in my home town. No one asked me to join—just keep coming back! I got a sponsor who took me to meetings, introduced me to many good A.A.s, volunteered me to sweep the floor, clean ashtrays, make coffee, speak at meetings, and eventually chair meetings. He was good for my sobriety, but something was lacking. We were never involved in general service work as I know it today. Our group didn't seem to get any mail or be

involved with anything except our closed meetings. It was then I told the group there must be more to A.A. than this. I think I was prepared to resign from the group I had never officially joined.

Then the miracle happened: I asked who the G.S.R. was; I was told that if I thought the group needed a G.S.R., I could be it. This started the long slow process of education in A.A. that has brought me here today. My group is currently active in and financially supports our local intergroup, district, area, and G.S.O. I'm sure the group would have survived if I had left, but I'm not so sure the quality of my life in sobriety would be as it is today if I had become a "roving A.A." I have never considered resigning since then. There is no substitute for the support I get from the members of my home group.

I feel the active, informed group is the backbone of A.A. A member has the right to participate in A.A. as he feels the need. We have the duty to offer each new member the opportunity to share in the love and service we enjoy. Are we spending too much time, money, and the personal effort of many of our most active members on things like P.I. and forgetting the basic needs of new members and new groups? Do we need an I.I. (internal information) committee as well as a P.I. committee?

Jim Hill (Southern Illinois)

The home group's financial responsibility to all A.A. services

It is a fact of life that whether it's a phone call or a Big Book, a cup of coffee or gas in the car to get to a meeting—it still costs money. If the service is not performed, we die—it is just that simple. It costs money to keep the hand of A.A. stretched toward the still-suffering alcoholics.

The home group has a financial responsibility to all A.A. services. The basic service is regularly scheduled meetings; the group must pay for its rent, utilities, refreshments, etc. A.A. groups ought to be fully supported by the voluntary contributions of their members.

The home group is where the voice of the group conscience is heard first; if it isn't heard there, it isn't heard at all. The home group chooses a G.S.R. to carry the group conscience to the district. The group has the privilege and responsibility of paying its own way. The home group is also responsible for the financial support of its D.C.M. It is imperative that a D.C.M. have the financial support of the groups in his or her district to make sure that the conscience of each group is heard.

The choices we make in our home groups about how the group spends its money after paying its bills and setting aside a prudent reserve are the direct link to the legacy we will leave to those generations of alcoholics who follow us. What legacy is your home group financially supporting for those still-suffering alcoholics? The home group is financially responsible for all of A.A.'s services.

Pai Rosenstiel (Northeast Texas)

The responsibility of the home group to its members and A.A. as a whole

The primary responsibility of a home group to its members is to be there. The home group is where it all begins. In the home group

people really get to know each other. They feel safe; they feel comfortable; they feel a sense of belonging. They share in each other's problems and willingly help each other.

As an A.A. member grows in sobriety, the home group becomes family. The other members are no longer just faces or friends; they are family—people who care, people you can count on, and people who understand. The newcomer is an integral part of the group. As the member grows, so does the group. They both suffer growing pains. The home group becomes a safety net in times of turmoil. The group members watch out for new members and help them over the bumps. If the home group experiences growing pains, members will experience Traditions One and Two in a real sense.

The home group helps develop its members to a level where they are ready and able to reach beyond themselves and the group. Through the home group members hear about activities and events that take place in the district and area and are encouraged to get involved. A new world opens up. The home group enforces the fact that A.A. is not just stopping drinking and attending meetings. It fosters sharing and identifies the needed Steps and Traditions. The home group introduces its members to service and the service structure. The home group is a link in the chain, and its members work together for the benefit of everyone.

Do you feel that your home group is meeting its responsibilities to its members? Is it providing a haven for the recovering alcoholic?

Richard Koseski (Connecticut)

Back to basics

The final presentation/discussion session of the 36th Conference focused on fundamental issues. Jack Ford, Western Canada regional trustee, was the moderator.

What is the A.A. message?

I would like to break down A.A.'s message into three important categories: (1) our message to the general public; (2) our message to newcomers; and (3) our message to members of our Fellowship.

The P.I. message should convey that A.A. understands by relating our experiences with alcohol and its problems. Sharing personal feelings in P.I. work breaks down public misconceptions and lets everyone know where A.A.s found help. Our message to confused, sick newcomers should be to make them feel welcome and that their problem is not unique.

The message to members of our Fellowship is to be on guard for two killers—complacency and stagnation! A.A.'s recovery program is an ongoing, continuing process in which we strive for some little bit of improvement each 24 hours. If we ever think we're recovered or cured, we are just one small step or arm's length from that next drunk (not drink), and we may or may not have the opportunity to return to the A.A. Fellowship!

A.A.'s overriding message in all these three areas is our open, helping hand of hope for those who have given up on themselves. From our very beginnings, the attraction of our program has been the hope for a sober life that we saw in A.A. members when we first arrived at A.A.'s door.

Hubert Malone (Northern Indiana)

What about sponsorship in the Three Legacies?

Somewhere in the third year of my sobriety, I was sponsored into our Legacy of Unity by a man named Lloyd, who at that time had been sober over 30 years. He told me that as a member of A.A. I was responsible for seeing that our Fellowship would be here for those alcoholics who might not even be born yet. How could I be instrumental in the future of A.A.? There were many others smarter than I with much more sobriety who could do this. Nevertheless, I was curious.

About this time, I attended my first area convention, where I had a glimpse of a much larger A.A. world. I saw people working together on a committee to put together a convention. When I heard they were looking for help for the next convention, I decided to volunteer. Some of the members I met at convention meetings "sponsored" me into service and encouraged me to come to area committee meetings. The more I went to area meetings, the more I realized that my message as an A.A. member was not confined to Recovery, but was to include Unity and Service as well.

Our delegate had heard the term "service sponsor" at the Conference. He told us that a service sponsor is similar to a conventional sponsor but concentrated on helping someone in his or her service life. He was so convincing about the importance of having this type of sponsor that I asked him to be my service sponsor.

As a delegate, I have had many opportunities to sponsor people into service. Anytime I speak to G.S.R.s, I stress their roles as messengers of the Legacies of Unity and Service. But I truly believe that the real strength of our Fellowship lies, not at the Conference, nor at our area committees and assemblies, but within each of our groups—within our membership, who may not know the importance of service and may never have heard of the Traditions.

People like Lloyd, speaking to new members about the importance of our Traditions, are messengers of Unity and Service, equally, if not more so, than you or I as delegates.

John Quinn (Northern New Jersey)

Are we fulfilling our primary purpose?

One of my earliest feelings in sobriety was relief in the discovery that at last I had a primary purpose—that there could be more to my life than not drinking. I was given opportunities to share my experience, and I did so willingly, perhaps more willingly than I do today. Today I get involved in serving the Fellowship in different ways—committee meetings, conferences, workshops—but are these ways "primary"? They assuredly benefit me, but do they benefit the suffering alcoholic? Have I let these ways replace direct encounter with the one who needs me most?

Fulfillment of our primary purpose is an individual and a collective responsibility. Although we become impatient with our progress, there is progress. More than once I've been distracted with counting—counting members, groups, and contributions. I've also been distracted with judging—judging the commitment of G.S.R.s and committee members and what I perceive to be a general lack of interest in some groups in being part of A.A. as a whole. These distractions are relieved only by the arrival of the newcomer, who gives me the opportunity to fulfill our primary purpose.

Each newcomer is of monumental importance to us. Newcomers aren't distracted by what distracts me. They know, with deep certainty, that



they are fulfilling their primary purpose—to stay sober and then, later, to stay sober and help other alcoholics to achieve sobriety. As long as the newcomer fulfills his or her primary purpose, I am sharing in that fulfillment. As long as I am sharing, my group, my area, and A.A. as a whole are sharing in fulfilling our primary purpose.

So long as we are responsible "when anyone, anywhere reaches out for help," we are fulfilling our primary purpose. So long as I do and you do what we have been taught to do, then A.A. as a whole is fulfilling its primary purpose. We will continue, so long as it is God's will, to pass it on.

Helen McClure (Southwest Texas)

Carrying the message to the Native North American population

On Saturday morning, during the closing brunch, Conference members heard a comprehensive report by a G.S.O. staff member on a 1985 Conference recommendation to report on the Native North American population.

Initial survey results

The 1985 Conference recommended that: "The general manager designate a staff person to coordinate and pull together (at the General Service Office) all available information about spreading the A.A. message to the Native North American population, including, but not limited to (1) translation of their languages and dialects, (2) experiences of various A.A. groups in their contact with these populations, and to explore with a view toward consolidating and expanding A.A.'s experience in these areas; report back to the 1986 Conference through whatever committee the general manager feels is appropriate."

This project was initiated as part of the C.P.C. assignment. Two surveys were made: One went to area delegates and alternates; the other was sent to 600 professionals working with Native Americans and addressing the problem of alcoholism.

The survey findings show that, with regard to the translation of A.A. literature into native languages and dialects, there are hundreds of native languages and dialects; also, literate Native Americans can read English. Therefore, our study has arrived at two questions which are still under study: (1) Should we develop simplified English-language material particularly focused on the needs of this population? (2) Should we encourage local groups that carry the message to Native Americans to facilitate translations of a few short pieces of A.A. material into the Indian dialect of their community when the need for this material is evident?

It is very clear that the real work on this project must be done by local A.A.s across the U.S. and Canada. G.S.O. and the Conference will stimulate local interest in this project and facilitate its work.

Both groups of respondents reported the following problems in carrying the message to Native Americans: cultural differences; language problems; low motivation on the part of Native Americans; transportation problems; illiteracy; and lack of understanding about alcoholism and A.A. among Indian leaders.

The A.A. respondents also reported difficulty in getting A.A.s to travel to reservations and weak service structures in areas with large Indian populations. The professional respondents also reported that the A.A. model is too religious and conflicts with Indian spiritual beliefs, and that some Indians freely blend their religious practices with the A.A. program and present them as pure A.A.

As a continuation of this Conference initiative, during the next year, we propose to define more clearly the need for literature and/or audiovisual materials aimed toward Native Americans in quantitative as well as qualitative terms and report these findings to the 1987 Conference.

Betty Liddle (G.S.O. staff)

It's all in the attitude

At the closing brunch, Jim Estelle (Class A trustee) described his attitude toward rotation by telling the old story about a fellow who is ridden out of town on a rail: "If it weren't for the honor of it, I'd just as soon walk."

Estimates of Groups and Members— January 1, 1986

	Groups	Members
United States	33,840	676,234
Canada	4,445	74,277
Overseas	27,054	644,051 ¹
Correctional facilities	1,680	50,400 ²
Internationalists		540
Lone members		497
	67,019	1,445,999

1 At the end of 1985, we had reported members from 66 of the 107 overseas countries with A.A. groups. These totaled 23,402 groups and 554,025 members. To establish an estimate for the 41 countries not yet responding, we excluded the eight largest responding and obtained an average of the balance. This average was applied to the 41, and the overall estimate emerged.

2 U.S. and Canada only.

The estimated group counts in the U.S. and Canada include only those that ask to be listed at G.S.O.; thousands do not.

Among listed groups in the U.S. and Canada, many do not report membership figures. For each nonreporting group, an estimate of membership is arrived at by taking an average among reporting groups within the Conference area concerned. Even among reporting groups, membership figures include only those now active and attending meetings; there is no way to count sober members who no longer have a home group.

Reports on Area Service Highlights

Alaska: Our area is vast geographically and small in population. We have about 150 groups and 12 districts (one is inactive). Districts and intergroups have meetings in all correctional facilities and most hospitals. We receive many court referrals, which cause little or no ill effects. Our area meets quarterly in different cities. Because it is difficult for all D.C.M.s to attend all area meetings due to transportation costs, our great concern is communication. Now D.C.M.s who cannot attend will send written reports and receive copies of all reports. Many districts have the same problem: Outlying groups may be 500 miles or more from the monthly district meeting.—*Brad Bratager*

Alberta/Northwest Territories: Our area includes districts in the northeast and southeast corners of British Columbia. During the past year, we participated in the 34th International Congress on Alcoholism and Drug Dependency, held in Calgary, primarily to show other countries how we cooperate with outside agencies. Our original intent—to carry the message to the rest of the world—was achieved. Although this was the first time that A.A. was invited to participate, we understand they would like us to continue. We do not have full participation from our D.C.M.s and G.S.R.s, but we are improving.—*Walter Kronkvist*

Arizona: The panel or committee structure of our assembly and sharing session has created interest beyond expectations, leading to better communications and resolution of problems. Our C.P.C., P.I., and H.&I. chairpersons are now elected instead of appointed, and

they have made great strides in providing information about A.A. To improve our service structure, we inaugurated a redistricting plan, increasing the number of districts and creating a need for more D.C.M.s.—*Ed Cavin*

California (Mid-Southern): In the last two years we have been working in the area of C.P.C. A committee was formed to educate hospital and treatment facilities staffs, informing them of our availability and how they can apprise patients of our locations. Courts have been supplied with packets of A.A. literature to be given to defendants who are sent to A.A. for the first time. We now have a "blanket district" that covers the Hispanic population, which is now translating the area newsletter and other pamphlets into Spanish.—*Bill Schmidt*

California (Northern Interior): This past year has been one of increasing interest in general service. Two districts have come to life. Our D.C.M.s hold regular district meetings and attend monthly committee meetings. The five Sacramento districts hold monthly cluster workshops; other districts have teamed up for workshops. Area business is conducted at our committee meetings to give our quarterly assemblies more time for service workshops and discussions. We reinstituted a two-day assembly in May, which will be held alternatively in the north and south. We are discovering and nourishing the sense of commitment in our active and potential service people.—*Will Noble*



Adeline Wilmot (nonalcoholic), assistant to the Conference coordinator.

California (San Diego/Imperial): In January we submitted our bid to host the 1990 International Convention. The past two years have been a time of excitement, dreams, and unification. Our assembly voted to create a second Spanish-speaking district to better carry the message to the Imperial Valley. In January we resolved to declare 1986 "The Year of the Traditions." Also in January, a new D.C.M. and alternate were elected for the Imperial County groups. Our pre-Conference assembly will follow the format of the Conference, with renewed concentration on the voting items. We hope to have a committee structure in place this fall.—*Tom Beebe*

Delaware: We have 100 registered groups, 3 intergroups, and 12 districts. We hold four assemblies a year and have bimonthly area committee dinners. Last year was the silver anniversary of our annual convention. We have good statewide participation and representation, with newly elected officers split evenly (two each) from northern, central, and southern Delaware. During the past six years, workshops have been held at assemblies, and group participation has improved to about 60 percent. The three intergroups do local twelfth-stepping for institutions, answering service, P.I., and C.P.C.—*Wes Jones*

Georgia: Our D.C.M.s met in November 1985. The 1986 Conference theme was adopted as our area theme. Cluster workshops will be continued in 1986. We feel that these have done more to get the service message to the "grass roots" than anything attempted thus far. At our January assembly, 532 groups registered, representing about 10,500 members. Our state prepaid convention, held in Columbus in October, was a tremendous success. Groups contributions underwrite this convention, making it unnecessary to charge a registration fee. Our goal for 1986 is to continue to try to improve our efforts toward spiritual progress.—*Jerome Waller*

Idaho: Our area has 10 districts, with about 160 groups. Each district has a D.C.M., and the area committee holds monthly meetings. We hold two quarterly meetings and two assembly business meetings annually. At our fall assembly, the H.&I. Committee was divided, giving us an H.&I. chairperson. H.&I. is extremely active in jails, treatment centers, the prison, and community work-release centers. Our archivist is collecting material on the history of A.A. in our state, with plans to bring displays to local assemblies.—*Gwen Fields*

Illinois (Northern): Our area continues to grow, with two more district splits this past year. Attendance at quarterly committee meetings and quarterly assemblies has increased owing to sponsorship of A.A.s into service by committee members and the increased awareness created by our newsletter. We established an answering service and Archives Committee in 1985 and recently purchased a computer to assist us in recordkeeping. Past delegates will now have voting privileges so we may benefit from their experience. We have given our total support to Chicago in their bid for the 1990 International Convention.—*Hank Groat*

Indiana (Southern): We will host the East Central Regional Conference in Indianapolis in July. Our Archives Committee has secured a new depository in Terre Haute. Our Correctional Facilities Committee has reestablished A.A. meetings in two facilities where they were cancelled. Many P.I. releases and broadcasts on A.A.'s 50th anniversary led to an increase in membership in 1985. We continue to inform treatment facilities about A.A.'s primary purpose so that nonalcoholics are not referred to A.A. groups. Young people are being assimilated into our service structure.—*Art Cross*

Kansas: We have made great progress in P.I. and C.P.C. during the past two years. In September, the assembly voted to expand to four committees. A proposal will be made at the assembly to divide the state into geographic areas. We have 22 districts and more than 300 groups. Communication is better than ever. We hold four assemblies a year. Many districts hold monthly meetings; some hold bimonthly round robins, with good attendance. We have difficulties with court referrals and with people who have problems other than alcohol.

—*Mary Baker*

Kentucky: Since 1980, we have grown from 140 to 365 groups and have added five new districts. At the area level, representation and participation have increased greatly (probably the result of rotating the meeting place), but the percentage of contributing groups has not increased. Last year we adopted a structure which requires that we change what we didn't do properly at first. District support shows weakness, but with our new dedicated committee chairpersons, we hope districts will be motivated and better serve the groups. Our rapport with the courts and corrections is well established.—*Jack Jones*

Maine: Our area has over 270 groups in nine districts, with nine district chairpersons and 38 local D.C.M.s. Some districts have over 80 groups in a large geographical area. Redistricting is occurring slowly. We have two assemblies plus a delegate's report annually. Our committee meets two or three times before each assembly to develop the agenda. The committee and assembly have successfully dealt with previous area actions which violated the Traditions and Guidelines. Progress has been made with the Meeting List, Grapevine, and Boomerang Committees, and we are working on Archives, P.I./C.P.C., and H.&I. Committees.—*Bob Dodge*

Manitoba: Much enthusiasm was shared by new G.S.R.s, D.C.M.s, and table officers during our workshops on the role of the G.S.R. and D.C.M. at our assembly in January. A.A. is alive and thriving in our area. Two D.C.M.s attend each other's district meetings; a

A.A. dreams
Jan Whitney (Panel 36, Western Michigan) took a few music lessons prior to the Conference. She also read and reread *A.A. Comes of Age*. One Conference night, Jan dreamed that she had singlehandedly set the entire 1955 Conference to music and conducted the premier performance of this important work.

third D.C.M. is about to join them. Cooperation and closeness among the table officers is demonstrated by their meeting for an hour or so prior to each committee and assembly meeting. A discussion meeting on service, held the night before the January assembly, was a real icebreaker; it could become part of our future assemblies.

—Leon Morehouse

Maryland: We are redistricting to improve communications between D.C.M.s and the growing numbers of groups. Our districts have increased from 36 to 46 during the past months. This growth has required us to hold four full-day committee and assembly meetings a year. Recently we formed a full-time committee for the hearing-impaired and a Finance Committee. For the first time, we have workshops at our committee meetings. Last fall our archives were moved into a permanent location in Baltimore.—Gene Ray

Massachusetts (Western): Our area has 5 districts and about 140 groups. All committees and districts meet at least once a month. Our P.I. Committee has made presentations to 75 schools and conducts a radio program. Our Grapevine Committee has grown during the past 18 months after a period of reduced activity. The intergroup office, which schedules monthly group visits, is formulating a plan to have signing for the hearing-impaired available at selected meetings on a regular basis. One concern is our apparent failure to reach the needs of the Spanish-speaking community; we must give this matter priority.—Paul Davidson

Michigan (Western): Our area has a city-to-city intergroup which travels from the north to the south monthly. We recently welcomed a new district—the eastern portion of the upper peninsula—making 16 districts. Although we are experiencing “growing pains,” which have affected our unity, we hope to gain better understanding of each district’s needs. In October 1985 we hosted the 33rd Michigan State Convention; and in February 1986 we presented a panel based on the General Service Conference at the Fourth Annual Statewide Workshop. We are now planning the 1987 Eastern Central Regional Conference, to be held in Grand Rapids.—Jan Whitney

Minnesota (Northern): Our area has implemented a plan of action whereby we rotate our two yearly assemblies. We have sectioned the area into four zones, and the assembly rotates from one zone to another. This is generating great interest and hopefully will encourage more A.A.s to attend. In November 1985 we held our annual fall service workshop. Our aim of getting as many new people involved as possible was met with great success: 11 out of 12 presentations were given by D.C.M.s and G.S.R.s who were just finishing their terms in office.—Louie Hall

Mississippi: Last year, 55 percent of our 200 groups contributed to the area; service was reduced due to lack of funds. Groundwork was laid for new ways of promoting the Grapevine. A total of 6,200 pieces of literature and 2,000 newsletters were distributed to our institutions. We have three new A.A. groups in prisons, and a sponsorship program has been set up for the State Department of Corrections. Redistricting was completed in 1985: 5 districts were divided into 26 (with 25 D.C.M.s). Since then, our area contributions have increased.—Buddy Holder

Montana: A decade ago, nothing filled the gap between the groups and the assembly, and we were lucky if two A.A.s attended. A district committee was formed, and now A.A. meetings are brought to prisons, treatment centers, etc.—anywhere they are needed; now 10 or 12 attend the assembly. A major concern of those who have been involved in service for a long time is newer members’ reluctance to recognize the value of the A.A. Guidelines and other support data.



There is a continuous hassle about “why I can’t do it my way.” Also, we have an influx of people with a multitude of problems other than alcohol.—Walt Thompson

Nebraska: Our area has 24 districts and 12 committees. We hold four two-day meetings a year—two in the west and two in the east. The Saturday-afternoon workshop is followed by a committee meeting and an open A.A. meeting. On Sunday, the G.S.R.s’ meeting is followed by committee meetings and a business meeting. The P.I. Committee contacted all libraries to see what A.A. literature was needed, and the districts supplied those needs. We need to find more ways for past delegates to be involved.—Lynn Macomber

New Brunswick/Prince Edward Island: Our area has 219 groups divided into 13 districts, with 3,000 members. We hold district and area workshops. We have literature banks at different locations. Most districts have P.I. and C.P.C. at the group level. We hold two assemblies and two roundups each year. Joining our assemblies and roundups together has improved area unity.—Lawrence Adams

New Hampshire: Until this year, our Institutions Committee has combined correctional and treatment facilities. G.S.R.s from the county jails have increasingly shared their experience with other institutions’ G.S.R.s, and so our Institutions Committee meetings have grown. P.I. and C.P.C. are difficult to staff at the district level and difficult to organize at the area level. Archives has developed a chronology of A.A. in our state using taped interviews with oldtimers. We are dealing with the problems of dual addiction and treatment facilities.—Peter Robinson

New Jersey (Southern): To increase cooperation and service in the spirit of our Traditions, we formed a Budget Committee, Workshop Committee, and C.P.C. Committee. Workshops continue to be held throughout the area. A current important problem is our “double-trouble” meetings for people with drinking problems who also are mentally ill and take medication. These meetings are monitored by professionals (state employees) who want to establish a certain number of them and insist they be recognized as A.A. special interest groups. A new tendency to sponsor and encourage newer A.A.s into service is encouraging. In our assembly, growth toward unity is now seen in the cooperation of separate areas of service.—Harry Fischler

Beans, beans, beans!

Two years ago, while visiting Southern California, John Bragg (G.S.O. general manager) lunched with delegate Ann Garrity. John was served a dish of pinquito beans, which he raved about. To John’s delight, Ann arrived at the 1985 Conference with 2 pounds of beans, a present for John’s wife, Mary. Then Mary raved about the beans! This year, to everyone’s amazement, Ann arrived at G.S.O. before the Conference with 20 pounds of beans—a gift for the staff. (By the way, the staff thought it was regrettable that Ann would not be returning as a third-term delegate.)

New Mexico: Growth is most exciting in our area. One district has six new groups, with six more being registered. Intergroup activity has also expanded. The unity and spirituality of our area has grown over the past few years, along with practicing principles before personalities. Rotation has been the biggest reason for area unity. Our Treatment Facilities Committee started a "bridging-the-gap" program to more effectively facilitate the transition of alcoholics from treatment into the A.A. community. Our plans also include area workshops on treatment and correctional facilities, P.I., and C.P.C.—*Jack Dolan*

New York (Hudson/Mohawk/Berkshire): Our area has about 535 groups in 12 districts; some districts meet monthly, and others meet bimonthly. Two assemblies are held—in the spring and in the fall. Our P.I. Committee plans to place the Big Book in every library by 1990 and to promote more TV and radio spots. We are trying to establish good communication between C.P.C., P.I., and our new Treatment Facilities Committee. Our Correctional Facilities Committee has had difficulty getting volunteers, but some progress is now being made. In January 1986, our Ninth Annual Day of Sharing broke all previous attendance records.—*Bill Miller*

New York (Western): Our assembly meets four times a year, and the committee meetings are held the other months. This past year we hosted the state workshop on P.I., C.P.C., and institutions. Our area has one central office and two intergroups. We have made tremendous strides in P.I., C.P.C., and especially correctional work.—*Bill Hay*

North Dakota: Workshops on everyday service problems are now more popular. Communication between the assembly and the groups has always been a problem—only about half of our groups attend the assembly. District roundups have become more popular, adding to area unity. Our focus is mostly on treatment centers, schools, and hospitals, with good communications established. We have many workshops on the Traditions, and more groups hold Traditions meetings.—*Ole Borgen*

Ohio (Northwestern)/Michigan (Southern): Our area is redistricting, with help from past and present D.C.M.s. Our New Groups Committee was started two years ago, with the sole purpose of assisting A.A.s in starting meetings. It has helped immensely, keeping newer A.A.s active instead of having groups fall by the wayside. More G.S.R.s now attend our assemblies. Along with other service-minded A.A.s, they help with our mini-Conference in March and with our 30th Ohio State Conference in August 1986. Use of the Treatment Facilities Workbook will help relieve a lot of problems.—*Jack Reighard*

Ohio (Southwestern)/Kentucky (Northern): Our area has two metropolitan centers and a large span of rural territory, with two intergroups and an active district section. We have experienced rapid growth, which has caused us to consider redistricting by geographic areas (we have 24 districts and will probably add two more). Our committee meetings are held on the odd months of the year; assemblies are held on the even months. We are encouraging the rotation of G.S.R.s and D.C.M.s every two years. We have been actively working on better communication with and through our D.C.M.s.—*Bob Morse*

Ontario (Western): Our area structure is almost 30 years old. Complacency can hinder vitality and growth, and so we decided to take an area inventory. We have semiannual two-day assemblies, with workshops, sharing sessions, panels, and ask-it baskets. Because our membership are not as informed as they should be, we are going to the people from the area level: All committee officers will make brief presentations at conventions, roundups, districts, groups, etc. We are also concerned about declining financial support for G.S.O. from our groups, usually due to a lack of knowledge rather than indifference. Thus the grass roots approach becomes doubly necessary.—*Tom Simpson*

Oregon: Our area is growing rapidly. We have 29 districts, with 529 groups. Many informative workshops have been held during the past two years; a workshop for G.S.R.s is now being planned. Our D.C.M.s travel around our rural areas visiting meetings every quarter and holding monthly district meetings for G.S.R.s. We have quarterly mini-assemblies throughout the state; our assembly is held on Labor Day weekend. Our February 1986 assembly was very impressive. This particular district had not had a mini-assembly for years. The weather was terrible, and the highways were solid ice; but it was the largest turnout we ever had.—*Kathy Jarchow*

Puerto Rico: Our area has 6 districts and 110 groups. District committee meetings are held monthly; the area committee meets bimonthly; and assemblies are held twice a year. Our annual convention is in February. P.I. and C.P.C. Committees are elected in every district, and we cooperate with government agencies in charge of alcoholism treatment centers. Our main goals are to bring A.A. meetings into prisons and accelerate the translation of A.A. literature into Spanish.—*Eugenio Cotto Jr.*

Quebec (Northwestern): Our area has 10 districts, 275 French-speaking groups, and over 5,000 members. The majority of districts hold monthly G.S.R. meetings, with strong and increasing attendance. Each year, we hold six area meetings and two assemblies, with G.S.R.s sharing in the workshops (spring and fall). The Executive Committee meets twice a month: One meeting is for the Executive Committee itself, and the other is for the five area coordinators for P.I., La Vigne, sharing sessions, the regional bulletin, and correctional facilities. Our membership is becoming more service-oriented and self-supporting.—*Real Bourgeois*

Quebec (Southwestern): Our area hosted the 1985 International Convention, which created increased interest in A.A.: Twelfth-step calls increased by 2,500 in 1985; and P.I. requests increased by about 10 percent. We now have 523 groups (32 groups were formed this year): 125 English-speaking, 392 French-speaking, and 6 Spanish-speaking. We have added a C.P.C. Committee. We also have information sessions for D.C.M.s, consisting of four days of sharing on the Concepts and A.A. structure. Our main concern is helping hospital patients and outgoing inmates, as well as those who come to our groups from detoxification centers.—*Marc Pineau*

Rhode Island: Our area has excellent attendance and participation by G.S.R.s at district and assembly meetings. Service schools and workshops have provided better-informed service workers, resulting in responsible and active committees. Our P.I. Committee carries the message into schools through speaking commitments and A.A. Grapevine subscriptions. The Correctional and Treatment Facilities Committee coordinates 20 meetings a week. Our structure is strong because we follow tradition, adhere closely to *The A.A. Service Manual*, and depend on a loving God as He expresses Himself in our "informed group conscience."—*Cliff Carlson*

Spigot power

East Central regional delegates were unusually active at the Conference. Perhaps it was because at the delegates/past delegates conference in Racine, Wisconsin, each delegate was given a spigot and instructed to "turn it on at will" at the 36th Conference.



Saskatchewan: We have two assemblies a year (spring and fall). Our January committee meeting includes workshops and presentations; all 16 D.C.M.s attend, representing over 300 groups. We recently appointed our aggressive alternate delegate as area GvR, so our number of group GvRs should soon increase. We continue to utilize rotated trusted servants at all area functions and many district workshops and special events; they are affectionately called "twisted servants."—*Peter Buckler*

South Carolina: We have nine districts; one is split, and one has a D.C.M. and three local committee members. We have two-day assemblies and one afternoon for workshops and committee reports. G.S.R. workshops are held at the first assembly. Our communications chairperson keeps us informed of changes in groups and G.S.R.s. The Archives Committee is a working committee with a permanent office. The C.P.C. Committee works with medical students and nurses who visit open A.A. meetings. Our concern this year is to be self-supporting.—*Cole Zobel*

South Dakota: Our area has 130 groups and 13 districts. We hold two conferences a year (spring and fall) as well as two workshops (January and July). Our D.C.M.s and G.S.R.s are more involved in service work, and our committee chairpersons are more involved with the groups. Also, more service workshops are held in the districts. Our D.C.M.s had perfect attendance at our last three conference and workshop business meetings.—*Elroy Mundhenke*

Tennessee: During the past ten years, our assemblies have greatly increased in attendance and participation. This growth may be attributed to changing the location of the quarterly assemblies from Nashville to cities across the state. The attendance of young people and number of registered young people's groups have doubled in the past five years. The number of registered groups has increased from 87 in 1977 to 313 at present. Recently our state structure was revised by condensing it into a smaller version in the form of a state service manual.—*Bill Speight*

Texas (Northwestern): Our area highlights are the result of creating our quarterly assemblies in 1980. With assistance and cooperation from G.S.O., past delegates, and other areas with existing structures, we developed our own structure. This year we can report regular quarterly meetings, workshops, and sharing sessions, resulting in more G.S.R.s and D.C.M.s getting active. We have a "live-wire" Grapevine Committee, and intergroups are being formed. Minority

groups are springing up and taking hold. We will host the 1990 State Convention—the first since A.A. was very young in our area.—*Bonnie Taylor*

Texas (Southwestern): Our area covers thousands of square miles, with 25 districts (we are redistricting), 289 groups, 6 intergroups (one is Spanish-speaking), 5 newsletters, and an area newsletter. Last year our C.P.C. and P.I. Committees had good results using professionals on panels in two workshops. Moving workshops around the area has increased participation by G.S.R.s and D.C.M.s. Our concerns include: (1) groups not stressing the Traditions; (2) apathy about service; (3) cooperation among intergroups, districts, and areas; (4) lack of financial support; and (5) influx of alcoholics from treatment facilities.—*Edell Estenson*

Vermont: Our eight districts (six are active) are doing well, with increased attendance. Each district holds an annual roundup and has workshops and discussion meetings. We are trying to structure the two inactive districts. Our area committee meets monthly. Prior to our quarterly assemblies, we hold 1½-hour sharing sessions and workshops with the G.S.R.s. For the past two or three years, G.S.R. workshops have been held throughout the districts. Last fall our first area G.S.R. workshop was successful; another is scheduled for April 1986. A new spirit is evident in our area.—*Dick Haas*

Wisconsin (Northern)/Michigan (Upper Peninsula): Our area is deeply committed to tradition and service. Our immediate past delegate will now become our area chairperson, which hopefully will bring more order to our assemblies. After 44 years of being held in Green Bay, we voted to hold our 45th Fall Conference in Appleton, a decision that was a long time in coming. We began 1986 with a prudent reserve of \$100; no doubt, finances and related topics will be thoroughly discussed this year.—*Dave Roberts*

Wyoming: Our area has 99 groups and 11 districts. We hold two assemblies and two conventions each year. Our Treatment and Correctional Facilities Committee has had good statewide participation in carrying the message inside the walls, especially at the men's penitentiary at Rawlins. Our area newsletter is published by the A.A. group inside the maximum security unit at the prison, resulting in a real bond of fellowship and trust between inmates and outside A.A.s. Recent assemblies have been bogged down with arguments over finances, and we are investigating setting up a budget and/or standing finance committee.—*John Sears*

Reports from the General Service Board, Trustees' Committees, and G.S.O.

These annual reports are submitted to each Conference—via its committees in cases where there are counterparts to the board entities; directly, where there are no counterparts. Unless the Conference as a whole takes some action to the contrary, acceptance of the reports indicates Conference approval of the activities and recommendations included.

General Service Board

Major challenges for A.A.'s future

Trustees' report: Another eventful year for the General Service Board has gone into history, bringing not only major challenges and developments, but also hints of surprises in the years ahead. This year we have carried our message to more suffering alcoholics than in 1984. The A.A. membership (U.S. and Canada) recorded at G.S.O. grew by 7 percent to about 750,500 during 1985; our international associates report a growth of almost 12 percent to 644,000. Thus the active membership is now 1,445,500. Literature sales from our G.S.O. alone rose 21 percent to \$6,953,000, including 696,300 copies of the Big Book.

We were shocked to discover, in July 1985, that our copyright of the first edition of the Big Book had lapsed in 1967. In spite of diligent scrutiny of our archives, the answers to why or how remain shrouded in a haze of alcoholics (if not a haze of alcohol). It is appropriate that the theme of this Conference is the future of A.A., for the future of our basic text is now one of the concerns. The board has become aware that some past decisions may have been influenced by the feeling that we had some kind of control over that book.

Contributions from groups and individuals were healthy in comparison to past years but not in comparison to the expenses incurred by G.S.O. on behalf of the groups. This situation has persisted for many years. However, this year, in constructing our budget, we arrived at the point we have known would be someday—where trends in the economy make our publishing income, based on prices fixed in 1978, no longer enough to cover the shortfall. We therefore faced two unpleasant facts—that it is time to raise prices, and that it is also time for a vigorous review of our entire financial structure, emphasizing self-support. So I have asked the General Service Board, the A.A.W.S. board, and G.S.O. to conduct a comprehensive review of our financial structure. The results of this effort will be applied during 1986 and reported to the 1987 Conference.

The Grapevine broke even last year and will report encouraging signs for future years. Nevertheless, in 1985 the board formed an oversight committee which engaged outside consultants on magazine publication to examine the Grapevine operation so that improvement can be continued.

Recovery must always be offered to suffering alcoholics in small, autonomous groups. Yet in order for us to offer \$5 instead of \$20 Big Books, we have to pool our publishing in G.S.O.; and in order to preserve our unity, we have to pool our experience in carrying the

Some are slower than others

Dr. Jack Norris (trustee emeritus) revealed that over the years he has asked many A.A.s the following question: "After you stopped drinking, how long did it take you to think the way you used to?" The replies ranged anywhere from 18 months to 7 years, according to Dr. Jack.

message. As A.A. becomes larger and as the world takes more notice of us, we will have to assume, more and more, the responsibilities that society places on its major activities. But while doing so, the character of the single A.A. group has to be preserved.

These problems are major challenges for the future, but perhaps they should be called growing pains. They are the kinds of operational problems that the General Service Board and its subsidiary corporations were created to deal with on behalf of the Conference. I believe they are well in hand; however, they will need continuing attention. The essential purpose of the *Fellowship* is to resolve, at the group and area levels, the problems that a changing society presents us as we attempt to fulfill our primary purpose. The essential business of the *General Service Board* is to provide pooled resources to the Conference for this effort.

Gordon Patrick, chairperson

A.A. World Services, Inc.

Big Book copyrights lapse

Directors' report: The board met 12 times during 1985. The following significant items are noted:

- We reviewed and recommended to the trustees' Finance Committee the 1985 budget.
- With board authorization, A.A.W.S., Inc., transferred \$785,700 to the General Service Board to cover 1984 operating deficits. Surplus cash in excess of basic operating requirements, amounting to \$300,000, was transferred to the Reserve Fund on April 5, 1985.
- We reviewed and approved budget additions in the amount of \$157,900 and recommended that this be forwarded to the trustees' Finance Committee.
- The following were recommended to the trustees' Nominating Committee and approved: Shepherd Raimi as candidate for general service trustee; Joe Rhoads as candidate for director; and John Bragg to replace Bob Pearson as president of A.A.W.S. Jack Ford was selected by the General Service Board Nominating Committee as trustee-director.
- Tom Jasper reported for work on November 12, 1985, and was appointed services director on January 1, 1986.
- We hired a new staff member, Maureen Costello, who joined us in January 1986.
- After 35 years of service, Dennis Manders (long-time controller) retired; and after 14 years as G.S.O. staff member, Phyllis Masback retired.
- Following a recommendation of the Ad Hoc Committee concerned with the Concepts, we published the 1962 version (Bill's original writing), together with the 1985–1986 *A.A. Service Manual*. Changes in factual material through the years have been footnoted after each chapter. We discarded a surplus of the 1984–1985 edition, amounting to \$4,600.
- We discovered that the copyright to the first edition of the Big Book lapsed in 1967, and that the material in that book has been in the public domain since that time. This event was precipitated by the

publishing of a replica of the first edition by C.T.M., Inc. As a result, we engaged in significant legal exchanges with that company, and we believe it has ceased to publish. Future responsibility for copyrights has been placed in the hands of attorneys.

- An Agreement between Lois Wilson and A.A.W.S., Inc., was executed by Lois and John Bragg (as president) on August 26, 1985, stipulating that: (1) Big Book royalty payments will continue to be made as though the copyrights were still in force; and (2) both A.A.W.S. and Lois (and her heirs) are released from claims against the other for failure, if any, by A.A.W.S., Inc., or Bill Wilson (respectively) to apply for Big Book copyright renewal.
- We approved a change in the retail price of the Big Book to \$5.30, with the following discount levels to outsiders: 200-999 copies will sell at \$4.77; 1,000+ copies will sell at \$4.50.
- We granted Costa Rica's request for \$11,300 for financial aid to Central American Publishing. This amount will be reimbursed from their accounts receivable, currently totaling \$9,500, with the balance to be paid from proceeds of future sales.
- We approved a request for \$20,100 in financial aid to Japan to assist them in printing the Big Book and the *Twelve and Twelve*; the inventory is to remain the property of A.A.W.S., Inc., until the total amount is repaid.
- We granted Australia permission to publish 2,000 copies of the Big Book and furnished negatives from which they can make their own plates.
- We approved a request from Poland that A.A.W.S. typeset and print 500 copies of *Living Sober* at a total cost of \$5,918, to be shipped there (pending verification that this shipment will reach its destination).
- We approved proposed changes in employees' benefits.
- We engaged a law firm to enter into litigation with the National Labor Relations Board as a result of the petition by our Mail and Shipping Departments that they be represented by a union.
- We granted 63 requests to reprint from A.A. literature and five requests to tape/videotape; two were tabled, and ten were withheld. With regard to reprint of the Steps and other excerpts from the Big Book, we will use the same criteria we have been observing but will amend our language as recommended by legal counsel to use words such as "A.A.W.S. has no objection to . . ." rather than "A.A.W.S. grants permission to . . ."
- We approved the following prices: "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell" (Spanish), 55¢; "Bill Discusses the Traditions" (Spanish)—long-term lease, \$300, weekly rental, \$35; *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* (Spanish), \$2.50; *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* Parchment (Spanish), \$1.75; P.I. Discount Packages #1 and #2 (English, Spanish), \$20 and \$70; Treatment Facilities and Correctional Facilities Guidelines (Spanish), 10¢; Spanish Discount Package, \$13; "A.A. Medications and Other Drugs" (Spanish), 15¢; Correctional Facilities Workbook (Spanish), \$7; *Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers* and "Pass It On" (gift package with slip case), \$12; Archives Scrapbook of newspaper clippings, \$50; "Young People's Announcements" (record, tape, cassette), \$5; "A.A. Comes of Age" (cassette, with brochure), \$25; Discount Packages #2 and #3, \$31 and \$39; *Souvenir Booklet* (reissued), \$4.50 (U.S.), \$6 (Canadian); and Treatment Facilities Workbook, \$7.



- We are studying the role of A.A.W.S., Inc., in the translation and production of Spanish literature, both for U.S./Canada and abroad. We received the first results of a questionnaire circulated to U.S./Canada Spanish-speaking districts and intergroups to determine their priorities for literature to be translated.
- We have both a short- and long-term need for additional space at G.S.O. For the short term, we converted the eighth-floor conference room and adjacent storage area into two offices. A plan for our long-term needs is being developed.

Wayne Parks, chairperson

Literature Distributed—1985

English

Books

Alcoholics Anonymous	696,300
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (reg. edition)	378,600
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (gift edition)	60,700
A.A. Comes of Age	24,500
As Bill Sees It	70,300
Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers	26,500
Pass It On	117,900
50 Years With Gratitude	6,900
Total	1,381,700

Booklets

Living Sober	186,700
Came to Believe	74,000
Total	260,700

Pamphlets

A.A. and Occupational Programs	32,000
A.A. and the Armed Services	23,800
A.A. as a Resource for the Medical Profession	62,700
A.A. for the Woman	235,400
The A.A. Group	134,000
A.A. in Your Community	135,500
A.A. in Prisons	35,800
A.A. in Treatment Centers	69,600
The A.A. Member	168,200
The A.A. Member—Medication and Other Drugs	263,300
The A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts for World Service	36,200
A.A. Tradition—How It Developed	78,100

A.A.'s Legacy of Service	29,600
A Brief Guide to Alcoholics Anonymous	298,500
A Clergyman Asks About A.A.	50,900
The Co-Founders of Alcoholics Anonymous	46,300
Do You Think You're Different?	269,200
44 Questions	501,100
G.S.R.	70,800
How A.A. Members Cooperate	36,200
How It Works	133,200
If You Are a Professional	96,000
Inside A.A.	110,200
Is A.A. For You?	614,800
Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?	220,000
It Happened to Alice	84,500
It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell	78,300
The Jack Alexander Article	77,500
Let's Be Friendly With Our Friends	31,600
Letter to a Woman Alcoholic	162,400
A Member's-Eye View of A.A.	162,300
Memo to an Inmate Who May Be Alcoholic	59,300
A Newcomer Asks	366,600
Problems Other Than Alcohol	178,400
Questions and Answers on Sponsorship	326,000
Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings	33,600
This Is A.A.	569,000
Three Talks to Medical Societies by Bill W.	43,600
Time to Start Living	121,000
Time to Start Living (large print)	17,200
Too Young?	203,200
The Twelve Traditions Illustrated	84,200
Understanding Anonymity	132,900
What Happened to Joe	98,400
Young People and A.A.	279,400

Total 6,860,800

Miscellaneous

Wallet cards—two-fold	871,000
Wallet cards—I Am Responsible	123,400
Wallet cards—Anonymity	75,300
Parchment—scrolls	7,300
Placards	1,000
C.P.C. Workbook	900
Correctional Facilities Workbook	1,100
P.I. Workbook	1,100
Treatment Facilities Workbook	500
A.A. Guidelines	148,000
Group Handbook	5,700
Wire Racks	2,600
Cassettes	3,500
Alcoholics Anonymous book (cassette album)	3,200
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions book (cassette album)	1,800
Public Service Announcements (cassettes, tapes, records)	600
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions Shade Displays	3,000
Fact Files	5,100

Total 1,255,100

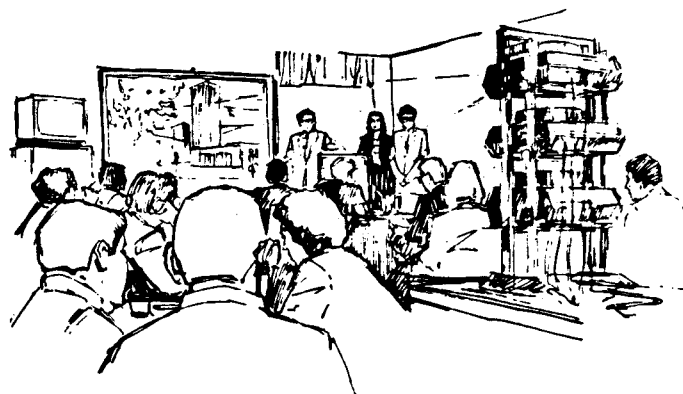
Spanish

Books

Alcohólicos Anónimos	10,900
El Sendero de Vida	2,500
A.A. Llegas a su Mayor Edad	1,100
Total	14,500

Booklets

Vivir en Sobriedad	4,800
El Manual de Servicios de A.A.	1,300
Doce Pasos y Doce Tradiciones	3,100
Total	9,200



Pamphlets

A.A. en Su Comunidad	4,600
44 Preguntas	20,400
Esto es A.A.	20,200
¿Es A.A. para Usted?	34,100
Carta a una Mujer Alcohólica	5,900
Las Doce Tradiciones (discontinued)	5,600
Carta a un Preso que Puede Ser un Alcohólico	2,800
El Punto de Vista de un Miembro de A.A.	3,200
Los Doce Pasos (discontinued)	7,200
Alcohólicos Anónimos por Jack Alexander	3,000
Tres Charlas a Sociedades Médicas por Bill W.	3,700
A.A. y el Empleado Alcohólico	2,200
Como Trabaja el Programa	10,600
El Marido Alcohólico	5,300
Lo que le Sucedió a Jose y su Problema con la Bebida	3,800
Comprendiendo el Anonimato	4,000
El Grupo de A.A.	5,000
Preguntas y Respuestas sobre Apadrinamiento	5,900
El Miembro de A.A. y el Abuso de las Drogas	8,600
Las Doce Tradiciones Ilustradas	3,900
Los Jóvenes y A.A.	7,500
Las Tradiciones de A.A.—Cómo se Desarrollaron	2,300
Una Breve Guia a A.A.	4,600
A.A. en Prisiones	2,400
Problemas Diferentes del Alcohol	5,300
Cómo Cooperan los Miembros de A.A.	1,100
Dentro de A.A.	1,300
A.A. como Recurso para la Profesión Médica	3,500
Un Ministro Religioso Pregunta Acerca de A.A.	1,500
R.S.G.	2,900

Total 192,400

Guidelines

Oficinas Centrales o de Intergrupo	700
Cooperación con las Cortes y los Programas de Seguridad Pública con Respecto al Alcohol	900
Comités de Centros de Tratamiento y de Instituciones Carcelarias	3,000
Información Pública	1,100
La Relación Entre A.A. y Al-Anon	600
Para Miembros de A.A. Empleados en el Campo del Alcohólicismo	1,400
Formado Comites Locales de Cooperación con la Comunicacion Profesional	600
Conferencias y Convenciones	1,100
Los Clubes	0
Como Usar los Directorios A.A. (E.E.U.U. y Canada)	300
Comités de Centros de Tratamiento	1,100
Total	10,800

Wallet Cards

Tarjeta Tamaño Billetera	10,500
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French

Books

Gros Livre Alcoolistes anonymes	11,358
Le Mouvement des A.A. devient adulte	1,534
Réflexions de Bill	3,294
Total	16,186

Booklets

Nous en sommes venus à croire	2,196
Vivre . . . sans alcool!	2,038
Total	4,234

Pamphlets

Les Douze Etapes	12,155
Voici les A.A.	12,303
Les A.A.: 44 Questions et réponses	6,316
Les A.A. sont-ils pour vous?	26,256
Les A.A. pour la femme	2,014
Coopération des membres des A.A.	832
Les A.A. et le monde du travail	2,052
Le membre des A.A. et l'abus des drogues	3,359
Les A.A.—Article du <i>Saturday Evening Post</i>	640
Collaborons avec nos amis	898
Questions et réponses sur le parrainage	3,440
Les A.A.: Une ressource pour les médecins	1,053
Les A.A. et la profession médicale (disc)	738
Les A.A. dans les centres de traitement	1,115
La Tradition des A.A. et son développement	1,390
Les Douze Traditions des A.A.	2,067
Alice l'a trouvée	1,417
Jos levait le coude	1,523
Les A.A. dans votre milieu	1,908
Problèmes autres que l'alcoolisme	2,780
Point de vue d'un membre sur les A.A.	1,544
Les Douze Traditions illustrées	1,644
Notre méthode	15,826
Les A.A. dans les prisons	879
Ça vaut mieux que de poireauter en prison	2,893
Petit guide pratique des Alcoolistes anonymes	5,892
Les A.A. et la religion	1,600
Biographies des cofondateurs	828
Lettre à un détenu	3,320
Le groupe des A.A.	2,845
Le manuel de services/Douze Concepts	1,225
Douze Etapes/Douze Traditions (Carte)	5,296
Carte des Etapes et Traditions	629
Le sens de l'anonymat	2,309
3 causeries à des sociétés médicales	1,315
Y-a-t-il un alcoolique dans votre vie?	1,587
Si vous exercez des activités professionnelles	800
Le R.S.G.	1,577
Causeries à l'extérieur des A.A.	866
Trop jeune?	2,339
Les A.A.—leur structure	1,575
L'héritage des Services des A.A.	740
Cercles d'amour et de service	1,375
Vous croyez-vous différent?	1,825
Lettre à une femme alcoolique	2,131
Carte anonymat (Français/anglais)	1,431
Le membre des A.A.	2,900
Les jeunes et les A.A.	3,180
Votre B.S.G.	970
Il est encore temps de vivre	1,890
Un nouveau venu veut savoir	10,600
Total	168,087

Miscellaneous

Lignes de conduit A.A.	7,085
Réflexions sur les Douze Etapes	3,135
Les cinq articles de Bill	4,150
Prière Sérénité (Carte)	54,800
Prière Sérénité (5 × 7)	3,200
Prière Sérénité (12 × 16)	701
Prière Sérénité (23 × 34)	225
Slogans (série de 5)	350
Littérature . . . une aide essentielle	825
Suggestions pour réunions de débutants	550
La Vigne A.A.	715
Médailles rhodium français	1,451
Jetons aluminium "appelle avant"	6,975
Etiquettes Allô!	3,500
Enseigne Meeting A.A.	33
Jetons 3 mois aluminium	2,200
Jetons 6 mois aluminium	1,565
Jetons 9 mois aluminium	1,480
Jetons 12 mois aluminium	1,205
Pochette re: kit nouveau membre	1,530
Total	88,590

Kits nouveaux groupes	91
Nécessaires pour établ. pénitentiaires	77
Nécessaires Information publique	27
Cahier Information publique	22
Aperçu sur A.A.	7,710
Conférenciers dans les prisons	1,000
Message aux adolescents	8,300
Et maintenant, que vais-je faire?	6,500
Renseignements sur les A.A.	9,500
Diverses façons de soutenir financièrement A.A.	—
Problèmes autres que l'alcoolisme (citations)	4,700
Total	30,217

Where am I?

A Panel 36 delegate was watching—and marveling—as artist Al Herr was sketching the Conference in action. "It's a thrill to watch you," she told him, "because I'm so familiar with your illustrations in past *Conference Reports* and in *Box 4-5-9*. In fact, your drawings catch the feeling of the Conference so well that when I first came into the room on Monday morning, I felt that your sketches were the real thing and that what I was looking at was a drawing."

Archives

Request donations from 'earlytimers'

Trustees' committee: We met three times since the 1985 Conference. Since we were all very involved in preparing for our 1985 International Convention, many informal meetings were held also. The Archives Workshop in Montreal was quite an historical event. Ruth Hock, Nell Wing, Dr. Jack Norris, and Mike Rainbolt shared on our first 50 years, with much humor and love.

Our new archival exhibit first appeared in Montreal and was a big hit. Many areas have requested the exhibit, but because of its fragility, we are restricting its use to events attended by a member of this committee or archivists familiar with its assembly.

A comprehensive plan was formulated to reach as many earlytimers as possible with requests that they consider presenting their historical

documents, pamphlets, and books to local archival centers. A statement of strategy, sample items of a letter to this group, a folder outlining the need, a bookmark, and a self-adhering identification tag have been prepared. Trustees, staff, delegates, area officers, and other service workers will participate in this undertaking, which will involve all A.A. servants.

We established some policies for this committee: (1) researchers may not have photocopies of classified collection material or make copies of tapes; (2) copies of pertinent classified material will be shared with regional archives having a permanent and secure space that is accessible to A.A.s and approved researchers.

Garrett Taylor, chairperson

Staff report: At the dawn of our "second-50" our history goes on. We started over 4,000 new group histories here at G.S.O. during 1985. In our Files Department all group correspondence is now put directly onto microfiche, and then the material is sent to Archives for culling. Here all intrinsically historical documents are retained in physical form as well as on microfiche.

A number of important acquisitions were made last year: *History of A.A. in the Tucson Area*; five tapes of Ebby Thatcher interviews; *A History of the Birth and Growth of A.A. in Western England*; a complete set of bound Grapevines and *Journal of Alcohol Studies*; *History of A.A. in New Zealand*; *California Northern Coastal Area History* (revised); and Rock Bottom A.A. Group Study Guide, Oklahoma State Prison (circa 1964).

A reproduction of the 1939-42 Scrapbook of newspaper articles was made available in 1985 and has met with wide enthusiasm. Area archivists are its principal purchasers; its 76 large 19" x 19" pages capture the beginnings of A.A. history.

Frank Mauser, archivist

Conference

Improving communications with new delegates

Trustees' committee: Suggestions for the 1986 Conference theme were reviewed, and we recommended to the Conference Agenda Committee (which makes the final selection) that the theme be "A.A.'s Future—Our Responsibility."

We reviewed suggestions received through the Conference Evaluation Questionnaire and the post-Conference sharing session and suggested the following:

- Rotating delegates be encouraged to review Conference procedures and the committee system with new delegates

Elevator exchange

While riding in the hotel elevator, several delegates were asked by another guest what conference they were attending. Upon hearing the delegates' reply, the gentleman quipped, "I'll drink to that!" "We did," replied the delegates without a moment's hesitation.

- New delegates be informed about what to expect at the Conference at regional meetings of delegates and past delegates

- The Conference coordinator send regional trustees suggestions and comments on improving communications about the Conference at the beginning of the year, and trustees review appropriate items at the Conference delegates' orientation

- The feasibility of using small meeting rooms for delegates' regional orientations be considered since holding all eight regions' orientations in one room is ineffective due to overcrowding and noise

- Digests of trustees' committee reports be read in a conversational tone in lieu of having the complete reports read before the Conference

- Conference committee chairpersons be encouraged to include brief background information when presenting committee recommendations

With the recommendation of the Conference Agenda Committee, we accepted the following workshops: "Letting Go of Old Ideas" and "A.A.'s Impact on the World." Workshop questions were approved for distribution to Conference members in January.

Topics submitted for 1986 Conference consideration were reviewed, discussed, and referred to the appropriate Conference committee, presentation/discussion, workshop, or sharing session. A list of Conference members scheduled to participate was reviewed and accepted. We also reviewed and approved the Conference agenda.

Based on suggestions in the Conference Evaluation Questionnaire, it was recommended that the Ask-It Basket session be discontinued in order to have more time on the Conference agenda; however, questions can be asked orally during general sharing sessions.

Jack Ford, chairperson

Staff report: The Conference coordinator is a point of contact among all Conference members and all those serving on the 91 area committees in the U.S. and Canada.

All A.A.s are encouraged to submit suggestions for the Conference agenda, usually through the delegates. The suggestions are presented to the trustees' Conference Committee and the Conference Agenda Committee for approval. Then they are shared with the Fellowship via the *Quarterly Report*, Box 4-5-9, and the preliminary Conference agenda (mailed to delegates in January).

The Conference coordinator assumes responsibility for:

- 1 Collecting ideas for the Conference theme and agenda
- 2 Serving as secretary of the Conference Agenda Committee and the trustees' Conference Committee
- 3 Handling monthly letters and advance correspondence with all delegates in preparation for the Conference
- 4 Working with the general manager, office manager, and staff in planning and coordinating the Conference
- 5 Scheduling and routing all reports and other material for the Conference Manual, Early Bird Box 4-5-9, and the *Final Conference Report*

6 Coordinating G.S.O.'s Annual Open House

Growth of the Fellowship has led to an increase in districts; about 2,500 D.C.M.s are now listed at G.S.O. Districts are dividing into smaller units when necessary; many now have slates of officers similar to area committees.

Most areas and districts send us their minutes and newsletters, which are circulated among the G.S.O. and Grapevine staffs. In addition to current trusted servants, contact is maintained with over 900 past delegates.

On November 16, 1985, 761 A.A.s from many states and Canada toured the G.S.O. and Grapevine offices. Then, in a nearby auditorium, staff members described their assignments and answered questions. Simultaneously, the Spanish services coordinator held an orientation for more than 100 Hispanic A.A.s. Many visitors from Quebec were assisted by French-speaking tour guides. An interpreter for the hearing-impaired was also on hand. The Southeast New York Area Committee hosted a delicious buffet lunch. Our next Open House will be held on November 15, 1986.

Susan Daly

Cooperation With the Professional Community

Professional Exhibit guidelines are prepared

Trustees' committee: During 1985, we spent most of our time and effort on: (1) preparing guidelines for the use of the Professional Exhibit; and (2) revising the pamphlet "If You Are a Professional."

In November, we considered the following suggestions from the Rhode Island Area Assembly: (1) the board not authorize sending our Professional Exhibit to Northeastern Conference on Alcohol and Drug Dependencies (N.E.C.A.D.) at the Edgehill Newport Foundation; and (2) the board not authorize sending the Professional Exhibit to other such conferences and conventions unless first cleared by the appropriate delegate(s) and area committee(s).

After extensive discussion of these suggestions, we recommended that:

- 1 The Professional Exhibit not be sent to N.E.C.A.D. at the Edgehill Newport Foundation
- 2 A subcommittee review the history of the Professional Exhibit to prepare guidelines for its use, to be sent to the Conference C.P.C. Committee for its approval

In January, we heard the report of the subcommittee mentioned in (2) above and approved the following recommendations, to be considered by the Conference C.P.C. Committee:

- 1 That the C.P.C. staff person explore the possibility of seeking invitations to exhibit at conferences and conventions of professions outside the field of alcoholism where A.A. has not previously exhibited

Wherever we go . . .

A group of delegates dined at a restaurant in New York City's Greenwich Village before attending a nearby A.A. meeting. Noticing that one delegate was wearing a "50th Anniversary of A.A." pin, the maitre d' confided that he had been an A.A. member for six months; the restaurant owner and bartender were also A.A.s.



- 2 That this committee review the schedule for the Professional Exhibit annually to evaluate its effectiveness and make recommendations to the C.P.C. staff person, who will give a quarterly report to this committee

- 3 That a letter be sent to delegates, alternates, and C.P.C. chairpersons annually, telling them about the Professional Exhibit and extending the opportunity to be volunteers when the exhibit comes to their city

In January, we recommended that the pamphlet "If You Are a Professional" be rewritten, and that a subcommittee be appointed to redo it, with the goal of having it approved by the Conference C.P.C. Committee in April.

Kenneth H. Williams, M.D., chairperson

Staff report: We have six Professional Exhibits, which are sent to conferences of national professional organizations. In 1985 our exhibits were shown at 24 meetings and resulted in over 1,600 requests for additional information. These exhibits also help increase the *About A.A.* mailing list, which is now over 19,000.

The C.P.C. staff member attends annual meetings of national organizations dealing with alcoholism and represents A.A. in a liaison capacity on the Advisory Council to the National Institute on Alcohol Abuse and Alcoholism.

Other meetings that staff or board members have attended or participated in are: Ninth Southeastern Conference on Alcohol and Drug Abuse, Atlanta, Ga.; National Conference of the Alcohol and Drug Problems Assn., Washington, D.C.; Assn. of Labor-Management Administrators and Consultants on Alcoholism, Inc., Boston, Mass.; University of Utah School on Alcoholism and Other Drug Dependencies, Salt Lake City; Northeastern Conference on Alcoholism and Drug Dependence, Newport, R.I.; National Convention on Children of Alcoholics, Orlando, Fla.; National Council on Alcoholism Forum, Washington, D.C.; National Assn. of Alcoholism and Drug Abuse Counselors, Atlanta, Ga.; 25th Anniversary Meeting of the Alcoholism Professionals of North Carolina, Winston-Salem; American Orthopsychiatric Association Convention, New York, N.Y.; and a one-day C.P.C. seminar at the V.A. Medical Center in Waco, Texas.

The staff member also maintains communication with A.A.s involved

in C.P.C. service. C.P.C. committees have increased significantly over the past year, with almost 500 now listed at G.S.O. New committee chairpersons receive the C.P.C. Workbook free; additional copies cost \$7 each. A selection of complimentary C.P.C. literature and service material is sent to new C.P.C. committee members, and discount packages are also available. They also receive *About A.A.* and *Box 4-5-9* (which now has sections on P.I. and C.P.C. activities).

This year the C.P.C. staff member was assigned to coordinate all available information on spreading the A.A. message to the Native North American population with a view toward consolidating the expanding experience of A.A.s in these areas.

Betty Liddle

Correctional Facilities

New video for inmates

Trustees' committee: In the summer, work began on creating a filmstrip based on the pamphlet "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell"; in November we recommended that this be presented as a video cassette rather than a filmstrip, as recommended by the 1985 Conference. All members of the Conference Committee on Correctional Facilities were notified by mail. At the January board meeting, the committee recommended that this be produced originally as a 16mm documentary film but that major production be on video cassette (for correctional facilities without monitoring equipment).

Bids were requested from three production companies. After much deliberation, we selected Adam Merims of Saga Productions. A video presentation outlining plans for the complete video is scheduled to be reviewed and approved by the 1986 Conference. Early in 1986 Adam Merims withdrew, and Crommie & Crommie were engaged.

A subcommittee began work on rewriting the pamphlet "Memo to an Inmate," as recommended by the 1985 Conference. We recommended that a survey of correctional facilities committees and delegates be taken before the January meeting to gain input for the writer so that a draft could be presented for approval at the 1986 Conference.

We discussed a draft of a new flyer for the G.I.R. and decided that the word "institution" should be changed to "correctional facilities," in keeping with current thinking. We recommended that there be an in-depth assessment of needs through an article in *Box 4-5-9* to A.A.s involved in correctional facilities work; and if committee returns so suggested, that it be placed on the 1986 Conference agenda.

Jim Estelle Jr., chairperson

Unacceptable command

Conference members gradually become accustomed to the New York phenomenon of jamming into hotel elevator cars the same way riders jam into subway cars. Not so for an Argentine Airline hotel guest who was in the same elevator car with Jim Estelle, Cheryl Ann Burke, and Sarah Price at about 8:50 a.m. on Friday. At every floor, delegates who were anxious to make the Conference morning session on time tried to jam into the relatively empty car. And at every floor, the Argentinian held up his hand imperiously and said, "Sorry, no more room in this elevator."

Staff report: A.A. groups in correctional facilities have doubled since 1980. Today there are 1,552 groups with 46,560 members; they are served locally by over 400 institutions committees.

The staff member on this assignment coordinates all "inside" correspondence to A.A. members and correctional facility officials as well as correspondence from institutions committees and "outside" A.A. sponsors, writing about 500 letters a month (6,000 a year).

The staff member works with local institutions committees to obtain prerelease sponsorship and (when requested) arranges for an A.A. member to meet an inmate upon release. Also, she coordinates the Institutions Correspondence Service, through which 1,100 "outside" A.A.s share by mail their experience, strength, and hope with "inside" A.A.s.

Discount packages of A.A. literature (English and Spanish) are available to "inside" A.A. groups and institutions committees. Grapevines are donated to inmates (75 per month), as well as damaged special literature (donated periodically by The A.A. Grapevine, Inc.).

Correctional facilities chairpersons receive the Correctional Facilities Workbook and Guidelines, and appropriate literature is available for group correctional facilities representatives. The films "A.A.—An Inside View," "Bill's Own Story," and "Bill Discusses the Twelve Traditions" and the filmstrip "Markings on the Journey" are available on loan at no charge to A.A. groups in correctional facilities.

Lyla Bonney

Finance and Budgetary

Will literature prices increase in 1986?

Trustees' committee: During 1985, we reviewed reports on G.S.O. and Grapevine operations, reviewed and approved budgets, supervised the administration of the Reserve Fund, and continued to monitor group contributions as to their sufficiency in relation to the cost of services they are supposed to provide.

Our normal sources of income are contributions and literature sales: Contributions were up 12 percent over 1984; literature sales were up 21.1 percent. Two unusual sources of income in 1985 will not repeat in 1986: The International Convention had a surplus of about \$316,000, and the new book "Pass It On" had first-year sales of 117,000 copies (\$595,000), at least 50,000 more than what we expect in a normal future year.

Despite these impressive numbers, G.S.O.'s net income (exclusive of the two unusual incomes) was \$166,700 in 1985, compared to \$352,800 in 1984. This downward trend is expected to continue in 1986; A.A.W.S. had to reduce expenses, stretch out projects, and eliminate a 6 percent discount to A.A. purchasers of literature to arrive at a balanced budget for 1986.

The action on literature prices is perhaps a forerunner of future increases to all purchasers. Until 1985, there had been no price increase in 11 years and several decreases; inflation in the economy has been balanced by savings in G.S.O. achieved by taking advantage of our growth to create more efficient operations. G.S.O. has controlled costs admirably, but is subject to an inexorable and prudent equation: Literature income plus contributions must equal the cost of services provided to the Fellowship.

We have some serious decisions to consider this year: Increase literature prices, cut back on services, or hope that all the Fellowship will be self-supporting. The last item is vital. It would be better to rely on direct self-support through contributions than on income from literature sales inside or outside the Fellowship.

The Grapevine income was \$160,000 greater than 1984, but expenses were \$218,000 higher. A \$40,000 operational loss was experienced (as opposed to a planned gain of \$38,200). The Grapevine's 1986 budget is optimistic but tight, projecting a net income from operations of \$17,000.

Robert P. Morse, treasurer

General sharing session

Carrying the message

Trustees' report: Using the format established in February 1985, in-depth reports were given by the following board committees: International Convention, International, Correctional Facilities, Treatment Facilities, and Cooperation With the Professional Community. The reports encompassed the Scope of the committees and highlights from History, as well as detailed accounts of activities and projects in progress, areas of concern, and future plans.

Issues of specific interest to the board were also addressed. In July, John Bragg gave an update on the Big Book copyright situation, followed by an open discussion.

In November, attention was focused on carrying the A.A. message to young people. The chairperson of the International Conference of Young People in A.A. gave a very informative talk. Then an A.A. member with seven years of sobriety shared her story—coming to A.A. at thirteen and finally getting sober at fifteen. Both talks stimulated much discussion; pertinent issues about young people and A.A. were identified and clarified.

The discussion topic in January 1986 was "Carrying the A.A. Message to the Black Community." Outstanding presentations on alcoholism in the Black community, with specific suggestions on carrying the A.A. message, inspired much discussion and moved many to think of ways of carrying the A.A. message to Black alcoholics and other minority groups.

Natalie Schwanke, chairperson

Group services coordinator

Many services for a growing Fellowship

Staff report: The primary responsibility of the group services coordinator is to provide communication services to the Fellowship as a whole, supervise the production of all service material, update the 14 A.A. Guidelines, and produce new Group Handbooks (English, Spanish, French, Correctional Facilities, and Treatment Facilities).

New groups in the U.S. and Canada receive a Group Handbook, a G.S.R. Kit, and a complimentary supply of literature. They also receive Box 4-5-9 bimonthly and the appropriate regional A.A. directory when issued. It is G.S.O.'s intention to provide services to

all A.A. groups within the U.S./Canada service structure that are as nearly identical as possible. We list more than 1,000 French-speaking and 450 Spanish-speaking groups; the Group Handbook, G.S.R. Kit, and Box 4-5-9 are available in these languages.

G.S.O. keeps a storehouse of service material, available to A.A.s on request. Most service material is complimentary and is not listed on the order form. Service material does not have the Conference-approved seal because it does not go through the various committee procedures required. It is produced when G.S.O. correspondence indicates there is a need for readily available information on a specific subject. Service pieces are prepared from files containing A.A. group experience or from sharing specifically requested by a questionnaire. Service material is constantly revised according to Fellowship needs.

The group services coordinator also updates all order forms and literature kits and works with the other supporting departments in preparing the five A.A. directories. Periodically, the group service coordinator conducts a G.S.O. staff service meeting at which the service assignment of each staff member is discussed and suggestions for improvement and/or change are offered.

Curtis Monahan

Undaunted!

After visiting G.S.O. on Tuesday, Jack Dolan and his wife (New Mexico), Edell Estenson (Southwest Texas), and Bonnie Taylor (Northwest Texas) became lost in Grand Central Station. When they asked a New York City Transit Authority police officer how to find the exit leading into the Roosevelt Hotel, the officer looked at their badges and then snarled, "You people don't know anything, do you?" Instead of getting angry at his rudeness, the group imagined that probably countless numbers of Conference members had asked him the same question.

International / World Service Meeting

Guatemala hosts Ninth World Service Meeting

Trustees' committee:

International—We are responsible for suggesting to the trustees policies and actions for carrying the message to alcoholics overseas, especially in countries without established service structures. We share information on our General Service Board structure and G.S.O., and we cooperate and exchange information with countries without structures or G.S.O.s. We assist A.A.s from the U.S. and Canada who travel abroad, helping them contact isolated A.A.s and groups. (I am sure many new overseas groups have started this way.)

At the February 1985 board meeting, plans were formalized for the overseas booth at the 1985 International Convention in Montreal. We decided to distribute a questionnaire on how we are carrying the A.A. message in literature, P.I., etc. The booth was a great success, and we plan many improvements for 1990. Questionnaire results were shared with the World Service Meeting delegates.

Owing to the continuing requests to G.S.O. for foreign-language literature, a subcommittee was formed to explore the possibility of having three to five basic pamphlets in 10 or 12 languages to help immigrants in our own country and indirectly the overseas countries.

It was recommended that we translate the three pamphlets "Is A.A.

for You?", "44 Questions," and "A Newcomer Asks," and that the first two languages be Russian and Chinese. The translating and typesetting costs will be about \$9,000; printing costs have not yet been established. We will use professional translating services rather than bilingual A.A.s, a deviation from our usual translations procedure. We felt that professional services can be used for pamphlets, but A.A.s should translate Bill's writings.

Helen Harmon, chairperson

Staff reports:

Overseas—The staff member on this assignment corresponds with 34 G.S.O.s and literature distribution centers outside the U.S. and Canada, in Argentina, Australia, Belgium (French-speaking), Belgium (Flemish-speaking), Brazil, Colombia, Costa Rica, El Salvador, Finland, France, Great Britain, Guatemala, Honduras, Iceland, Ireland, Italy, Japan, Mexico, Netherlands, New Zealand, Nicaragua, Norway, Paraguay, Poland, South Africa, Spain, Sweden, Switzerland, Uruguay, Venezuela, and West Germany.

When letters are received from groups and individuals in those countries, they are encouraged to correspond with their own G.S.O.s. If an overseas G.S.O. then needs a more detailed sharing of experience, it contacts G.S.O., U.S./Canada. For countries with their own G.S.O.s, we list only English-speaking groups and contacts, inter-groups/central offices, and Loners. Travelers are encouraged to contact those offices for up-to-date meeting information.

Correspondence from groups and individual A.A.s in countries without a service center or office is answered by the staff member on this assignment. We work closely with overseas countries to help them establish A.A. literature distribution centers, general service boards, and G.S.O.s. Guidelines for setting up those entities are available. When correspondence comes to us in a foreign language, it is translated, and a response is sent in the same language. We have translators (A.A.s) for over 30 different languages.

To protect A.A.'s copyrights, careful consideration is given to granting overseas boards and centers permission to print A.A. Conference-approved literature in the language of the country. A request to print should come from the board; and before any printing begins, G.S.O. first explores the way material will be financed and distributed. The request for permission to print or reprint is then presented to the A.A.W.S.

Here are some recent highlights about A.A. overseas:

- **Poland**—There are about 60 A.A. groups in this country; one group now meets in a prison. Literature is being translated.
- **Italy**—Bob Pearson (G.S.O. senior adviser) participated in the Italian National Convention in October 1985. Italy is busy translating literature and is growing.
- **Interim Zonal Meetings**—A G.S.O. staff member attended the Third European Service Meeting in March 1985; the Spanish services staff member attended the Fourth Ibero-American Service Meeting in Uruguay in November 1985. Zonal meetings are held in the year between World Service Meetings. Their primary purpose is the same as all A.A. activity—to carry the message to the alcoholic who still suffers. Also, they help countries without service structures by sponsoring them into service and contribute to the growth of A.A. worldwide.

World Service Meeting—The World Service Meeting meets biennially at locations alternating between the U.S. and overseas. The Ninth World Service Meeting will be held October 19–23, 1986, in Guatemala City. The theme is "Service Through Love and Humility." The Meeting will be attended by approximately 40 delegates from 25 countries. Japan and Poland, the most recent countries to form a national service structure, will be represented for the first time.

W.S.M. delegates serve for four years and attend two meetings. They should be legal residents and preferably citizens of the countries they serve. For maximum participation, delegates need a working knowledge of English, although simultaneous Spanish/English translation is provided for general sessions, committee meetings, and workshops. A *Final Report of the Eighth World Service Meeting* is available at G.S.O.

Helen Turnquest

International Convention /A.A. Regional Forums

1990 Convention plans; Forums still popular

Trustees' committees:

International Convention—This report was given as a presentation (see page 9).

Regional Forums—Since 1975, a total of 42 Forums have been held. Four regions hosted Forums in 1985. Our committee discussed each Forum and found they continue to be well received by service workers and to improve communication within our Fellowship. We discussed holding an extra Forum in Puerto Rico, as recommended by the 1984 Conference; this Forum will be held in May 1987.

In response to local interest in A.A. history, we agreed with the request from the trustees' Archives Committee that an archives exhibit be included in all regularly scheduled Forums and that an archival tabletop display be developed.

The Box 4-5-9 calendar keeps the Fellowship informed about Regional Forums. Here is the schedule of future Forums:

1986		
May 16–18	Western Canada	Regina, Saskatch.
July 11–13	Pacific	Los Angeles, Calif.
September 19–21	Eastern Canada	Halifax, Nova Scotia
December 5–7	Southeast	Montgomery, Ala.
1987		
May 15–17	Puerto Rico	San Juan
June 5–7	Northeast	Stamford, Conn.
October 2–4	East Central	Peoria, Ill.
December 4–6	Southwest	(tentative)
	West Central	(tentative)

Dan Byrne, chairperson

Lost and found

Thinking he had "lost" a meeting room scheduled for a workshop on Wednesday evening, Tony Osnato (G.S.O. office manager) persuaded the hotel's convention manager to set up another room at the last minute, only to find that the room he had "lost" was already set up and awaiting workshop participants.

Staff reports:

International Convention—We hired a convention manager to act as liaison between G.S.O. and the people with whom we are working in connection with the 1990 International Convention. This convention manager will be present at the G.S.O. Site Selection Committee meeting during the 1986 General Service Conference. (See also page 9 for a presentation on the 1990 International Convention.)

The International Convention assignment involves working on the convention with four committees: Trustees', Conference, Host, and G.S.O. Planning. The staff secretary coordinates and serves as secretary to these four committees; he is also the liaison to the Al-Anon Planning Committee.

Regional Forums—All regions have hosted Regional Forums. Forums are held on the invitation of the region; plans are made with the regional trustee, the region's delegates, and G.S.O. staff. Board personnel who have attended include trustees, G.S.O. and Grapevine staff, and A.A.W.S. and Grapevine directors. The board pays hotel, mail, and travel expenses for all its personnel; expenses for the region's service people are paid by the individuals or area committees.

The Regional Forum coordinator plans Forums with the regional trustee and delegates, service director, and G.S.O. general manager; makes arrangements with the host-city contact (the local liaison), hotel, and host city; arranges travel and hotels for board personnel; handles mailings to the regions' delegates (asking for agenda suggestions), G.S.R.s, D.C.M.s, area committee officers, past/present delegates, past/present trustees, and central offices; and arranges for display boards of sample literature and service material.

Reports on Forums are sent to all Forum participants, trustees, and current delegates. Any A.A. member who wishes to attend a Regional Forum may request a registration/reservation form.

Curtis Monahan

Expect the unexpected

At the Site Selection Committee dinner on Wednesday evening, one delegate remarked, "It never rains in San Diego in July." Garrett Taylor (Northeast U.S. regional trustee) retorted, "It never snows in New York City in late April, either!" (That day, Conference members were shocked to see snow falling outside as they looked through the massive windows of the Terrace Room.)

Internationalists, Loners, Homers

Growing worldwide contacts

Staff report: Seagoing A.A.s are known as Internationalists, and their numbers continue to grow. Today there are about 600 Internationalists and Port Contacts; 56 Internationalist groups meet aboard ships or in ports. Loners (unable to attend meetings because there are no groups nearby) stay sober reading A.A. literature and sharing with other A.A.s through letters and tapes; there are now over 500 Loners in 90 countries. Homers are A.A.s who are housebound due to long-term illness or physical disability; 107 Homers participate in the Loners-Internationalists Group. More A.A.s now serve as Loner-Sponsors.

A literature package is sent to each new Loner, Homer, or Internationalist. They also receive lists of Loners, Homers, and Internationalists and the bimonthly bulletins *Box 4-5-9* and *Loners-Inter-*

nationalists Meeting (L.I.M.), a discussion meeting in print, which shares excerpts from letters received at G.S.O.

About 2,800 A.A.s participate in this meeting-by-mail—it might be called the largest A.A. group in the world. We now have Loners in Fiji, Turkey, Africa, Australia, and even the jungles of the Amazon River. Also, many Loners live in remote parts of the U.S. and Canada. In the Northwest Territories one Loner has to fly over 300 miles in a small plane to attend meetings.

Cheryl Ann Burke

Literature

Focus on the Big Book

Trustees' committee:

Projects Completed—Since the 1985 Conference, the following items became available: the condensed Concepts (as service material); and *A.A. Comes of Age* (cassette tapes with picture brochure).

Projects Forwarded to the Conference Literature Committee—"A.A. for the Woman" (revised with briefer stories); "Too Young?" (updated, less flamboyant illustrations); "Young People and A.A." (suggestion to update); "A.A. and the Armed Services" (suggestion to update); *A.A. History Outline* (definitive history of A.A. from 1955-1985); "Twelve Concepts for World Service Illustrated" (similar to "The Twelve Traditions Illustrated"); the Big Book (recommendation to publish a fourth edition and to consider different formats).

Other—The committee considered including an explanation in the Big Book regarding certain practices which would be questionable today. We felt no further explanation is necessary since the preface contains information explaining the historical nature of the book and that the basic text remains unchanged.

Joan Jackson, Ph.D., chairperson

Staff report: The literature coordinator works closely with editors on updating and revising all recovery pamphlets, and with writers, artists, and editors on the preparation of new recovery pamphlets, books, displays, leaflets, service material, and audiovisuals. She also serves as editor of *Box 4-5-9*. (The production of this material was once part of the literature assignment but is now under the auspices of G.S.O.'s new Publishing Division, established in September 1985.)

We have discontinued publication of the *P.I.-C.P.C. Bulletin*, *Correctional Facilities Bulletin*, and *Treatment Facilities Bulletin* as separate entities. They are now included in our bimonthly newsletter, *Box 4-5-9*. We distribute *Box 4-5-9* (in English and Spanish) and three other bulletins, with a combined circulation of over 105,659 copies:

	Mailing list	Issues per year
<i>Box 4-5-9</i> (English)	61,639	6
<i>Box 4-5-9</i> (French)	12,022	6
<i>Box 4-5-9</i> (Spanish)	3,248	6
<i>Loners-Internationalist Meeting (L.I.M.)</i>	3,803	6
<i>Quarterly Report</i> ¹	5,385	3
<i>About A.A.</i>	19,562	3
	105,659	30

1 The *Final Conference Report* takes the place of the fourth issue.

All bulletins except *L.I.M.* are translated into French and printed by the French Literature Service in Montreal, Quebec, in cooperation with G.S.O.

Correspondence from A.A. groups and individuals requesting specific information about literature comes to the literature desk. A letter is sent semiannually to all central offices, intergroups, literature chairpersons, and literature distribution centers to inform them of new developments in A.A. literature and other service material.

Sarah Price

Nominating

Change in filling A.A.W.S. and GV vacancies

Trustees' committee: We recommended to the board that Amos Reed, John Hartley Smith, M.D., and John King serve as Class A trustees.

We recommended the nomination of William Croke to serve as general service trustee (Class B) on the A.A.W.S. board; and of Joe Phelan to serve on the A.A.W.S. board, replacing Wayne Parks.

In regard to the trustee elections, we approved the letter to delegates and area officers in the Eastern Canada and U.S. Pacific regions, as well as the written election procedures and résumé forms enclosed with the letter.

The committee recommended a change in the chart depicting areas of responsibility and authority in filling all volunteer and employee vacancies. Currently, immediate approval of a recommendation for the position of A.A.W.S. or GV staff rests with the Nominating Committee/General Service Board. We recommended that immediate approval for these positions should rest with the A.A.W.S. board or Grapevine Corporate Board.

We recommended that, in addition to the trustees, directors, and staff, the delegates be informed of the new position of services director available at G.S.O.

The committee reviewed and accepted, with minor modifications, the consolidated procedures for nominating general services trustees and A.A.W.S. and Grapevine directors. The committee also reviewed and accepted the proposed recommendation to the A.A.W.S. board and Grapevine Corporate Board on the establishment of their nominating committees.

We recommended that "date of birth" be included on all résumés received from Class A trustee candidates.

We received a letter recommending a study of the feasibility of having a Class B trustee serve as chairperson of the A.A. General Service Board. We felt there was not sufficient reason to pursue the matter, but it was forwarded to the Conference Committee on Trustees for their review.

It's all in the state of things!

It seemed Connecticut had a stranglehold on one Monday-night workshop: Joe Rhoads (A.A.W.S. director and Panel 33 delegate, Connecticut), Dick Koseski (Panel 35 delegate, Connecticut) and Bob Pearson (G.S.O. advisor and a Connecticut resident).

We reviewed and recommended the following slate of trustees for election at the annual meeting of the General Service Board in April, following presentation at the 1986 General Service Conference for their disapproval, if any:

Class A

William E. Flynn, M.D.
Joan K. Jackson, Ph.D.
John King
Robert P. Morse

Gordon M. Patrick
Amos E. Reed
John Hartley Smith, M.D.

Class B

Dan Byrne
William H. Croke
John R. Ford
Helen Harmon
Wayne Parks
Joe Phelan

Don I. Pritts
Shepherd Raimi
Ralph Rosenberg Jr.
James Shannon
Garrett Taylor
John R. Whitehouse

(To be selected 4/26/86)

One regional trustee—Pacific U.S.

One regional trustee—Eastern Canada

The committee recommended the following slate of officers of the General Service Board:

Chairperson
First vice-chairperson
Second vice-chairperson
Secretary
Treasurer
Assistant treasurer
Assistant secretary

Gordon M. Patrick
William E. Flynn, M.D.
Joan K. Jackson, Ph.D.
Helen Harmon
Robert P. Morse
Ed Gordon
Lois Fisher

The committee reviewed and recommended the following directors of A.A. World Services, Inc., to be presented to the 1986 General Service Conference:

John Bragg
William H. Croke
Lois Fisher
John R. Ford
Harold Greene

Joe Phelan
Shepherd Raimi
Joseph E. Rhoads
Jean Smith

The committee reviewed and recommended the following directors of The A.A. Grapevine, Inc., to be presented to the 1986 General Service Conference:

Norman Adams
Dan Byrne
Retha Gresham
Helen Harmon
Ralph Rosenberg Jr.

James Shannon
Stanley Silverman
Desmond Towey
Ann Warner
(One vacancy to be filled)

Wayne Parks, chairperson

Public Information

Spotlight on young people

Trustees' committee: During 1985, we accomplished the following:

- Prepared a complete press kit for use with our 50th anniversary
- Worked closely with the professional public relations firm which coordinated worldwide publicity for the 1985 International Convention in Montreal, Canada

- Released a press feature about young people
- Revised the ending statement on our radio P.S.A.s to include: "or check your local newspapers"
- Produced two new radio P.S.A.s targeting young people
- Wrote to both book and magazine publishers' journals explaining our anonymity Tradition
- Produced new 30-20-10-second TV P.S.A.s for approval by the 1986 Conference
- Prepared an audiovisual "Report of Ideas" for a full-length film (28 minutes) targeting young people, to be presented to the 1986 Conference.

Ralph Rosenberg Jr., chairperson

Staff report: The staff member and two other employees respond to over 11,000 written and telephoned inquiries annually from both the general public and the Fellowship. During 1985, we provided literature for about 275 health and community fairs; processed 14,902 newspaper, magazine, and TV feature stories (mostly about our 50th anniversary); and sent about 200 letters of thanks to local P.I. committees. Each month we wrote approximately 20 letters of gratitude to publications for good articles about A.A. and followed up on an average of 15 to 20 anonymity breaks.

New P.I. chairpersons received the P.I. Workbook, and all P.I. committee members and contacts received *Box 4-5-9* as well as new public service materials. (Additional P.I. Workbooks are available at \$7.) Discount packages are also available to P.I. committees at \$20 and \$70, respectively. (Local committees may also order half quantities of each package.)

The radio and TV media have increasingly aired our P.S.A.s, and video cassettes of "Alcoholics Anonymous—An Inside View" were sent to major networks, local TV stations, and TV production companies, along with information about A.A. We have received requests from CNN, NBC, ABC, CBS and many radio networks for help in planning programs referring to A.A.

We released a revised press feature on the publication of the five-millionth copy of the Big Book; mailed the annual "Anonymity Memo" to the media; and gave interviews to reporters from many U.S. magazines as well as from Radio Free Liberty (Soviet) and West German radio.

Eileen Gatz

Spanish services coordinator

Many services for Spanish A.A. groups

Staff report: This assignment was created to serve Spanish-speaking A.A. groups. The Spanish services coordinator does not rotate. He coordinates and revises Spanish translations of materials from the other ten staff assignments and assists other staff members in providing services to the Hispanic community that are as equal as possible to the services provided to English-speaking A.A. groups.

Routine correspondence in Spanish received at G.S.O. is no longer



translated into English before a response is prepared. It is now handled more efficiently without losing the "flavor" of A.A. terminology. Service material is translated into Spanish and kept up-to-date. The Spanish services coordinator is the editor of Spanish *Box 4-5-9* and is currently involved in the preparation of a third Spanish edition of the Big Book.

The staff member on this assignment represents G.S.O. at the Ibero-American Commission for Translation and Adaptation of A.A. Literature. In addition, he attends conventions, Hispanic intergroup meetings, and Regional Forums and assists at G.S.O.'s Annual Open House, the World Service Meeting, and the International Convention. The Spanish services coordinator also greets Spanish-speaking visitors to G.S.O.

Vicente Mejia

Staff coordinator

Correspondence increases in 1985

Staff report: Answering correspondence is one of the major responsibilities of the 11 G.S.O. staff members. A total of 152,000 pieces of mail were received in 1985, of which 22,600 required staff attention. Each staff member has a specific assignment and must also correspond with the A.A. groups in a specific region of the U.S., Canada, or the rest of the world. Several assignments involve the preparation of special service bulletins, and others include editorial responsibilities for *Box 4-5-9*. The work is divided as follows:

Conference	Secretary, trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference and Conference Agenda Committee; Early Bird <i>Box 4-5-9</i> ; Final Conference Report
Cooperation With the Professional Community	Secretary, trustees' and Conference Committees on Cooperation With the Professional Community; <i>About A.A.</i> ; <i>Box 4-5-9</i> (editorial consultant on C.P.C. page)
Correctional Facilities	Secretary, trustees' and Conference Committees on Correctional Facilities; <i>Box 4-5-9</i> (editorial consultant on Correctional Facilities page)
Group Services Coordinator, Regional Forums, International Convention	Supervision of service material, Guidelines, and A.A. directories; secretary, trustees' Committee on International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums; secretary, Conference Report and



Internationalists, Loners, Homers

Literature Coordinator

Overseas, World Service Meeting

Public Information

Spanish Services

Staff Coordinator

Treatment Facilities

Charter Committee; secretary, International Convention Site Selection Committee; coordinator, all activities concerning 1990 International Convention *Loners-Internationalists Meeting*; secretary, trustees' Nominating Committee and Conference Committee on Trustees

Secretary, trustees' and Conference Literature Committees; preparation of new recovery pamphlets, books, and audiovisual materials; updating of recovery pamphlets and books; editor, *Box 4-5-9*

Secretary, trustees' International Committee; secretary, World Service Meeting; *World Service Meeting Report* Secretary, trustees' and Conference P.I. Committees; *Box 4-5-9* (editorial consultant for P.I. page)

Consultant on any committee providing services to the Hispanic community; editor, *Spanish Box 4-5-9*

Assistant secretary, General Service Board; secretary, trustees' General Sharing Session; secretary, Committee on Conference Policy/Admissions; director, A.A.W.S.; *Quarterly Report* Secretary, trustees' and Conference Committees on Treatment Facilities; *Box 4-5-9* (editorial consultant for Treatment Facilities page)

Weekly staff meetings are scheduled to provide a forum for discussion of problems that require direction from the group conscience. Another aspect of our work is visiting areas for assemblies, conventions, and A.A. get-togethers. On these trips, we learn of local service activities and problems, which helps improve the services offered through G.S.O. Also, in 1985 staff members greeted almost 1,600 visitors from around the world who toured G.S.O., as well as almost 800 A.A.s who attended our Open House in November.

The staff coordinator coordinates all staff activities, chairs the weekly staff meeting, ensures that mail is answered without interruption during vacation, sickness, or absences, and also serves as a liaison between the staff and other departments.

Lois Fisher

Treatment Facilities

Workbook is published

Trustees' committee: We explored the feasibility of including the material in the *Treatment Facilities Bulletin* in *Box 4-5-9* per a suggestion from the Conference Committee on Trustees. We recommended that there be one more issue of the *Treatment Facilities Bulletin* (October 1985) containing a coupon explaining that non-A.A.s can receive similar material by returning the coupon to G.S.O.; they then would receive *About A.A.* We further recommended that any other material relevant to the non-A.A. treatment facility professional be given to the C.P.C. assignment for possible inclusion in *About A.A.*

We accepted the suggestion that a copy of the A.A. Grapevine be mailed with the October 1985 *Treatment Facilities Bulletin*. We also accepted the suggestion that material from the panel and two workshops on treatment facilities at the 1985 International Convention be included in the October 1985 *Treatment Facilities Bulletin*. Also, we recommended that the bulletin contain a request for shared experience on reaching women, adolescents, and the elderly.

In considering future projects, there was substantial discussion about treatment facilities personnel who are A.A.s working in the field of alcoholism. We recommended that the Treatment Facilities Section of the next edition of *Box 4-5-9* include an article on the dilemmas of these A.A.s. Also, we suggested that the Grapevine consider publishing an article by an A.A. who works in a treatment facility.

We discussed, in depth, the Guidelines for A.A. Members Employed in the Alcoholism Field, addressing the question: "What do A.A. professionals do, particularly those who live in small communities, when they and their patients attend the same meeting and the professionals need to share their professional conflicts and personal pain?" We recommended that this question be included in the Treatment Facilities Section of *Box 4-5-9*, with a request for sharing from the readership.

We recommended that the title of the A.A. pamphlet "A.A. in Treatment Centers" be changed to "A.A. in Treatment Facilities," and that the word "facilities" replace the word "center" in the pamphlet. We also recommended that minor changes in this pamphlet be reviewed by a subcommittee prior to the 1985 Conference.

The committee recommended that the secretary draft a revision of the letter in the Treatment Facilities Workbook on nonalcoholic drug addicts' attendance at closed A.A. meetings, suggesting a more sensitive approach.

William Flynn, M.D., chairperson

Staff report: The highlights of 1985 are publication of the Treatment Facilities Workbook, two workshops on Treatment Facilities at the 1985 International Convention, and a mailing to all hospital groups listed with G.S.O.

The Treatment Facilities Workbook was distributed in November to

trustees, delegates, and treatment facilities chairpersons; it is available to anyone for \$7. We receive frequent requests for this Workbook, primarily from treatment facilities chairpersons; 153 treatment facilities committees are now listed with G.S.O.

The staff member on this assignment coordinated the speaker selection for two workshops at the 1985 International Convention: "A.A. in Treatment Facilities" and "Post-Treatment Sponsorship."

Confusion about the distinction between a "regular A.A. group" and a "treatment facility meeting" continued in 1985. Form letters were sent to the Fellowship and to professionals and A.A.s employed in the alcoholism field clearly defining the distinction between these types of A.A. meetings. Letters were also sent to "hospital groups" registered at G.S.O., defining a "regular A.A. group" and a "treatment facility meeting" and requesting each "hospital group" to indicate its category by returning the appropriate form to the G.S.O. Hospital groups that did not reply were placed on our inactive list. Consequently, the "hospital group" category has been replaced by "regular A.A. group" or "treatment facility meeting."

The correspondence shows that the main issues of concern for the Fellowship continue to be: attendance of nonalcoholic addicts at regular A.A. groups and treatment facility meetings; influx of patients from treatment facilities to regular A.A. groups; and sponsorship of newly released patients.

Maureen Costello

Reports from the A.A. Grapevine

Revitalization trend continues

Directors' report: The year 1986 should be one of historical significance. The March 1986 Grapevine for the first time carried the traditional A.A. trademark—our plain circle and triangle logo—in response to some confusion in the Fellowship as to whether or not the Grapevine is really A.A. literature. An article by Bob Pearson for the April/May 1986 issue of *Box 4-5-9* and another article in the March 1986 Grapevine should dispel any further confusion.

A recommendation by the 1985 Conference Grapevine Committee that more data be included in *The A.A. Service Manual* about the Grapevine operation and its place in our service structure is a very positive step.¹ Though previously the Grapevine has been referred to in the manual, it has not accurately reflected the Grapevine's participation in A.A. as a whole.

Another recommendation by the 1985 Conference Grapevine Committee was that a workbook for area Grapevine committees (submitted to the 1986 Conference in draft form) would enable area Grapevine networks to do their jobs better because they will be better informed.

In 1985 we completed our conversion from an outside fulfillment service to a complete in-house operation. The difficulties of the last

three years are now over. It is evident (starting with reports from the update of the October 1985 issue) that our own operation is sound, accurate, and dependable! Grace Hedderman, our circulation manager, was employed in February 1985, a time critical to our conversion; she brought us through a complicated and frustrating time of adjustment. Her continued dedication and guidance toward a smooth operation of that department gives us the control we've lacked for a number of years.

The editorial team has been planning several special sections in the magazine. The October Grapevine will spotlight a story on the I.C.Y.P.A.A. International Conference. The I.C.Y.P.A.A. planning committee welcomes this involvement by A.A. Grapevine staff, and we are grateful for the opportunity to establish personal communication with what seems to be the fastest growing segment of the A.A. population.

New approaches and ideas are coming from our long-term personnel. At the suggestion of Dale Fuqua, editorial secretary, employee workshops have been launched to improve internal communications and keep departments better informed about activities of other departments.

The Grapevine operation is totally different today than it was ten years ago. For instance, the circulation in December 1976 was 86,000. Following the 1977 Conference Advisory Action, circulation figures

¹ New copy will go to the 1987 Conference.

rose swiftly and peaked in December 1980, with 128,000. The performance of the GvR program was very evident in 1977, 1978, and 1979. At the end of 1980 the number of new GvRs leveled off, and it seemed that a circulation plateau had been reached (a cause of concern to some). However, in ten years the circulation increased by 40 percent. In fact, both the January and February 1986 issues had circulation figures over 127,000—the closest we've come to that all-time-high figure. (We expect to go beyond that all-time high of 128,000 this year.)

Another difference in today's Grapevine operation is our successful exploration of other forms of production. Five tapes have been produced thus far, as well as our first book—*Best of the Grapevine*. The sales response has been so overwhelming that we are planning more tapes and are already working on volume 2 of *Best of the Grapevine* (to be released in October 1986).

In addition to area Grapevine committees, other area committees (institutions, P.I., treatment facilities, and C.P.C.) are carrying the Grapevine message. We experienced a "first" when the A.A. General Service Board gave approval to the trustees' Treatment Facilities Committee to include a copy of the Grapevine in one of its mailings. In some areas these committees are not only carrying the magazine into their areas of endeavor but are also distributing our first service pamphlet, "Twelfth Stepping with the Grapevine," at all levels. In addition, the spring issue of G.S.O.'s *About A.A.* bulletin was devoted to the Grapevine.

The year 1985 brought a needed increase in the cover price of the Grapevine (effective in January 1986). Prior to the November 1985 board approval of that price increase, an effort was made to increase circulation with the hope that it could be deferred; but by the end of October the results were not enough to postpone the increase. As it turned out, a postal increase in January 1986 raised the cost of mailing the magazine by \$16,800 (based on a monthly circulation of 127,000), and there may be another increase this year.

The Grapevine is going forward, not only in circulation, but also with a new revitalization of spirit and enthusiasm from the Fellowship itself. There is much activity at the area level, with workshops held in conjunction with state and/or regional conferences. In January 1986 the Colorado area Grapevine committee held what appears to be the first-ever Grape-A-Thon, which included 13 workshops based on Grapevine articles. An added highlight was a Grapevine drama entitled "Grapelet" by William Shakesbeer.

Ralph Rosenberg Jr., chairperson

Mirrors

A quilting convention was held at the Roosevelt Hotel during part of Conference week. After the Conference closed at noon on Saturday, the quilters were still holding forth on the second floor. One of the G.S.O. staff members asked a quilter, "Are you folks still here? I'm surprised there's that much to talk about in quilts." The quilter looked up at her quizzically and replied, "And we have all been wondering how there can be that much to talk about in alcoholism."

It's only toast!

Breakfasting in a local coffee shop near the hotel, Don Pritts (trustee-at-large/U.S.) ordered a toasted English from the waitress. At the word "English," the waitress made the sign of the cross. It seems she had recently moved to the U.S. from Ireland and was still experiencing "political withdrawal."

Celestial love!

Overheard at the General Service Board meeting: "The world has Halley's Comet, and we have Natalie (Schwanke)!"

Staff report: "Change" is the word that best describes the activities of the Grapevine editorial staff over the past year: realignment of job responsibilities, modifications in magazine design and content, three new cassette tapes, and an anthology. There was a note of sadness as well, with the death (in October 1985) of Janet Graves, who for 20 years was the Grapevine's part-time copy editor and proofreader. The void she left has been filled by Ames Sweet, who joined the staff in August as full-time associate editor.

When the art editor left last May, it became evident that the magazine's design functions could be fully accomplished by a skilled artist working part-time. We hired John Naydich—then a volunteer illustrator and member of the editorial board—as art director. John's special touch has added excitement and cohesiveness to the look of the magazine; his efforts to find new volunteer illustrators have resulted in artwork of greater variety.

The death of Joe Thomas, who, for a dozen years, edited the "Once Over Lightly" section, necessitated a change from his format to the new "Ham on Wry" humor section. The humor pages now incorporate, not only jokes, but occasional word games, a popular "Did I Really Hear That?" feature, and monthly trivia questions.

Two 1985 issues were especially significant. The June Grapevine celebrated A.A.'s 50th anniversary with a special issue on the A.A. Fellowship worldwide. The October issue contained a 16-page panorama of the Montreal Convention, with reflections and reminiscences by A.A.s illustrated with sketches of Convention sights. Other issues (especially at the end of 1985 and early 1986) contained special sections of several articles on selected topics: "A.A. and Other Addictions" (March); and "Youngbloods of A.A.—The Next Fifty Years" (May).

Several new special items have been produced since the 1985 Conference: a third tape cassette in the "Articles from Classic Issues" series; and another tape series, "Not for Newcomers Only," volumes 1 and 2. The editors are working on a package of two cassettes on meeting discussion topics, which will be available in May; they will deal with "Attitudes" and "Character Defects."

Work has also begun on a book of selected Grapevine writings of Bill W. At the February 1986 meeting of the Grapevine Corporate Board, a volunteer committee was authorized to explore the possibilities of such a book. Bill W. considered the Grapevine one of his primary vehicles of communication with the Fellowship, and back issues contain a wealth of writings in which Bill both made and recorded A.A. history and delineated the spiritual principles of the A.A. program. Bill Pittman and Ernest Kurtz (both students of A.A. history with impressive academic credentials) are members of the committee, as are Nell Wing, Bill W.'s long-time nonalcoholic secretary, and Frank Mauser, archivist. Nell has shared with the Grapevine her personal knowledge that before his death, Bill W. had hoped to publish a book based, in part, on his Grapevine writings. Work is already well under way on this book, which towers on the horizon as a future landmark for the Grapevine and for A.A. as a whole.

Ann Warner, editor

Grapevine circulation—geographic breakdown

U.S.	Circulation		Increase/ decrease
	4/85	4/86	
Alabama	1,049	1,114	+ 65
Alaska	473	543	+ 70
Arizona	1,323	1,440	+ 117
Arkansas	675	768	+ 93
California	11,061	11,569	+ 508
Colorado	1,528	1,637	+ 109
Connecticut	1,980	2,144	+ 164
Delaware	327	380	+ 53
District of Columbia	300	358	+ 58
Florida	5,188	5,430	+ 242
Georgia	2,249	2,428	+ 179
Hawaii	366	415	+ 49
Idaho	609	573	- 36
Illinois	5,092	5,307	+ 215
Indiana	1,867	1,844	- 23
Iowa	1,875	1,783	- 92
Kansas	1,771	1,738	- 33
Kentucky	1,014	960	- 54
Louisiana	1,465	1,461	- 4
Maine	754	739	- 15
Maryland	2,186	2,282	+ 96
Massachusetts	4,142	4,509	+ 367
Michigan	3,125	3,705	+ 580
Minnesota	4,785	4,479	- 306
Mississippi	822	884	+ 62
Missouri	2,182	2,200	+ 18
Montana	808	778	- 30
Nebraska	1,884	1,736	- 148
Nevada	475	512	+ 37
New Hampshire	812	735	- 77
New Jersey	3,249	3,404	+ 155
New Mexico	770	722	- 48
New York	7,303	7,735	+ 432

U.S.	Circulation		Increase/ decrease
	4/85	4/86	
North Carolina	3,052	3,339	+ 287
North Dakota	796	743	- 53
Ohio	3,614	3,858	+ 244
Oklahoma	1,946	1,845	- 101
Oregon	1,108	1,075	- 33
Pennsylvania	3,674	3,922	+ 248
Rhode Island	617	642	+ 25
South Carolina	1,573	1,701	+ 128
South Dakota	709	805	+ 96
Tennessee	1,244	1,232	- 12
Texas	5,095	5,440	+ 345
Utah	319	363	+ 44
Vermont	600	611	+ 11
Virginia	2,644	2,781	+ 137
Washington	2,967	2,924	- 43
West Virginia	568	547	- 21
Wisconsin	2,899	3,055	+ 156
Wyoming	373	386	+ 13
Puerto Rico	84	134	+ 50
U.S. Possessions	10	0	- 10
	<u>107,401</u>	<u>111,715</u>	<u>+ 4,314</u>

Canada	Circulation		Increase/ decrease
	4/85	4/86	
Alberta	1,502	1,536	+ 34
British Columbia / Yukon	1,720	1,566	- 154
Manitoba	882	713	- 169
New Brunswick /	567	569	+ 2
Prince Edward Island			
Nova Scotia /	929	988	+ 59
Newfoundland / Labrador			
Ontario	4,708	4,524	- 184
Quebec	375	364	- 11
Saskatchewan	1,196	1,157	- 39
	<u>11,879</u>	<u>11,417</u>	<u>- 462</u>

Foreign	Circulation		Increase/ decrease
	4/85	4/86	
	<u>1,421</u>	<u>1,345</u>	<u>- 76</u>

Total	Circulation		Increase/ decrease
	4/85	4/86	
	<u>120,701</u>	<u>124,477</u>	<u>+ 3,776</u>

A Conference clone?

As Susan Daly (G.S.O. staff) gave her opening remarks on the agenda one morning, David O'Leary (Panel 35, Nova Scotia/Newfoundland/Labrador) admitted that Susan reminded him of Carol Burnette, both in physical demeanor and style of humor.



From left to right: Charles Columbia, controller; Ed Gordon, director of finance and business administrator; John Kirwin Jr., assistant controller.

Recommendations Ensure A.A.'s Future

The group conscience of the Fellowship in the U.S. and Canada was expressed in the following Advisory Actions, which the General Service Board accepted in its legally required annual meeting just after the Conference. Most are based upon reports of the Conference committees, as indicated in the headings.

Floor Action

It was recommended that:

The 1987 Conference/Policy Admissions Committee consider the formation of a Conference Archives Committee.

Agenda

It was recommended that:

2 The format of the A.A. meeting following the opening dinner at the 37th General Service Conference consist of the alternate chairperson of the Conference Agenda Committee as leader to introduce five speakers—one Class B trustee, two delegates, two staff members (one G.S.O. and one GV).

There be a light system on the podium; the chairperson of the Conference Agenda Committee be designated chairperson of the A.A. meeting and his or her duties be limited to introducing the leader and monitoring the time of the meeting.

The microphone be checked before the A.A. meeting and the speakers be advised to speak clearly into the microphone and limit their talks to ten minutes each.

3 One of the following four suggestions be the theme of the 37th General Service Conference: (a) Our Primary Purpose—The Second Fifty Years; (b) The Promises: Our Today—Their Tomorrow; (c) The Seventh Tradition—A Turning Point; (d) A.A.—A Spiritualized Society.

4 The presentation/discussion topics for the 1987 Conference be: (a) Are We Carrying the Message to All? (b) Area Structure—General Service Representative; District Committee Member; Area Committee; Delegate. (c) Finance—Can G.S.O. Be Self-supporting Through Group Contributions Only? What About the Birthday Plan? Could Groups Pledge Contributions? Group Support to District, Area, and Intergroup. (d) Publishing—Too Much?—A.A. World Services; A.A. Grapevine. (e) Maintaining the Basics—A.A.'s Principles—Our Primary Purpose; The Twelve Steps; The Twelve Traditions; The Twelve Concepts—How Can We Live the Concepts in Service? (f) Right of Decision.

5 Two Workshops for the 1987 Conference be: (a) Unity—Let's Talk About It; (b) Living Sober—Growing Together or Growing Apart?

Past delegates from conferences long ago sometimes speak of the feeling of "them and us" that prevailed. An indication of how times have changed was the way D. T. Waller (Panel 35, Louisiana) spoke of the G.S.O. staff in his presentation. One staff member murmured, "D. T. will be loved a long time for those kind words."

Cooperation With the Professional Community

It was recommended that:

6 The guidelines for use of the Professional Exhibit be as follows:

That the C.P.C. staff person explore the possibility of seeking invitations to exhibit at conferences and conventions of professions outside the field of alcoholism where we've not exhibited before and we perceive a need for an awareness and knowledge of A.A.

That the trustees' C.P.C. Committee review the schedule for the Professional Exhibit annually at their July meeting in order to evaluate the ongoing effectiveness of the exhibit and make recommendations to the C.P.C. staff person for the following year; and that the C.P.C. staff person give a quarterly report to the committee about the Professional Exhibit.

That a letter be sent to delegates, alternates, and C.P.C. chairpersons annually to make them aware of the Professional Exhibit.

When an exhibit is scheduled, the staff person notify the area delegate for the city in which it is booked, asking for their assistance in providing volunteers to staff the booth. There will be ample opportunity for local committees to raise any problem issues in connection with the exhibit.

7 In the pamphlet "A Clergyman Asks About Alcoholics Anonymous" in the fifth paragraph on page 8, the sentence which reads "Newcomers are encouraged to attend one or more meetings a week" be changed to "Newcomers are encouraged to attend meetings as frequently as possible."

8 No change is required in the wording of item 3c on page 11 of the pamphlet "How A.A. Members Cooperate" since decisions about whether or not such information is provided are up to the group conscience of the A.A. entity involved in accordance with the Fourth Tradition.

9 The new "If You Are a Professional" pamphlet, with some design suggestions and editorial changes in the manuscript, be approved.

The committee also recommended that when requests for A.A. directories are received from outside A.A., the staff be authorized to send the directories and notify the appropriate area delegate, rescinding the 1973 Conference action. However, this motion was defeated.

Correctional Facilities

It was recommended that:

10 In the 4-minute videotape proposal for a 15-minute video/16mm film based on the pamphlet "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell," reference to "copping drugs and dealing drugs" on page 1 of the transcript be deleted, as well as the sentence "Anything but drink" on pages 6 and 7 of the transcript, to be replaced with "Just don't drink."

11 This 15-minute film be produced in full, to be presented to the 1987 Conference, and that the trustees' Correctional Facilities Committee monitor and report on the progression of the film during the year.

12 The outline of the rewrite of the pamphlet "Memo to an Inmate Who May Be an Alcoholic" be completed for approval at the 1987 Conference.

13 Relative to sponsoring inmates upon release, that area committees, district committees, central/intergroup office committees, and group correctional facility representatives discuss specific ways to coordinate efforts in sponsoring inmates upon release from prison.

14 The Institutions Correspondence Service be utilized by groups, as well as by individuals, as a means of effective sponsorship.

Finance

It was recommended that:

15 The finance cartoon flyer be changed in the third panel to list: group expenses, district expenses, intergroup or central office, area committee, and General Service Office, eliminating prudent reserve, numerals one to five, and the words "part of the remainder to" and "part to"; and that the second panel be changed to eliminate the numeral five and the words "part to."

16 The area delegates strongly consider implementation of the following suggestions to improve contributions to G.S.O., area assemblies, districts, and central or intergroup offices: (a) G.S.O. will make available to all delegates an itemized list of group service expenses and other expenses of the board, combined into one total, representing group services supported by group contributions; (b) area delegates contact groups quarterly, either directly or through the D.C.M., distributing self-support pamphlets and contribution statements; (c) the delegates encourage each group to have a folder which includes a list of addresses to whom monthly contributions can be sent (district, intergroup/central offices, area committees, and G.S.O.); (d) each area affix a list of addresses or stamp addresses on finance flyers and distribute to groups to provide them with the information on "where to send their money"; (e) areas could provide groups with preaddressed envelopes as to where they should contribute to the area treasury.

17 A film on finance is premature (until the Guidelines on Finance are introduced).

18 Because of the many facets, the proposal to have G.S.O. self-supporting through group contributions only not be considered at this time, especially in light of the continuing decrease in the percentage of groups contributing to G.S.O. This will be a presentation/discussion topic next year.

19 The limit contributed from individual A.A. members be increased from \$500 to \$1,000, and bequests from A.A. members should be subject to the same limit and be on a one-time-only basis and not in perpetuity.

20 The following changes be made to "Supporting the A.A. Support System" flyer: (a) the example which includes "district" be made the first illustration in the flyer, reflecting 50% to intergroup/central office, 30% to G.S.O., 10% to area, and 10% to district; (b) the present 60-30-10 Plan illustration will move to a secondary position.

Grapevine

It was recommended that:

21 The draft of the workbook for use by Grapevine committees be approved.

22 The Grapevine produce a trial tape in Spanish and a trial tape in

French at a price comparable to the Grapevine tapes in English. In making this recommendation the committee recognized the possibility of a financial loss but considers that in this instance the need to carry the message to French-speaking and Spanish-speaking A.A.s makes such a possible loss acceptable.

23 The 1985 Conference Advisory Action #17 be corrected to read: "Since each issue of the Grapevine cannot go through the Conference-approved process, the Conference recognizes the A.A. Grapevine as the international journal of Alcoholics Anonymous."

24 Because the twelve articles on the Traditions, by B.L. of Manhattan, New York, and the article "The Whisper of Humility" contain the opinions of individuals only, and because they are already reprinted in *Best of the Grapevine*, these articles not be published as a pamphlet.

25 If the Grapevine Corporate Board approves development of the proposed book of Bill W.'s Grapevine writings, a draft be brought to the 1987 Conference for consideration.

Literature

It was recommended that:

26 The manuscript and illustrations for the pamphlet "The Twelve Concepts for World Service Illustrated" be approved.

27 A definitive book on A.A. history from 1955-1985 be prepared and brought to the 1987 Conference for consideration.

28 In an effort to strengthen our network of "literature representatives" to ensure that A.A. literature is available at meetings, as well as catalog order forms for books and cassettes that individuals are likely to want, it is suggested that groups appoint literature coordinators.

29 The trustees' Committee on Literature complete the updating of the pamphlet "Too Young?" for presentation at the 1987 Conference for approval.

30 The following pamphlets be updated, if possible, in time for presentation at the 1987 Conference for approval: (a) "Young People and A.A."; (b) "A.A. and The Armed Forces."

31 As the preface to the Big Book clearly states that the text was written in 1939 and that it has not been changed, no further explanation regarding out-of-date phrases and/or gender-oriented pronouns or chapter titles is necessary.

32 The italicized footnotes regarding Al-Anon at the end of the chapter "To Wives" in the Big Book be retained, as they provide information rather than implying affiliation, but that they be printed in small type as appropriate to footnotes and placed at the bottom of the page.

33 A story of a gay alcoholic not be included in the Big Book.

34 There was no need to publish a separate and complete volume of all stories taken from the three editions of the Big Book.

35 The A.A.W.S. editorial staff continue to degenderize A.A. literature, with the exception of Bill W.'s writings, as the items are reprinted, e.g., "staffing the booth" rather than "manning the booth," etc.

36 In order to determine the need to put more literature in large print, Conference members seek the experience of A.A. members and agencies for the visually impaired and report the findings to the G.S.O. literature coordinator within the year.

37 A service item for use at A.A. meetings regarding A.A.'s primary purpose be developed by the appropriate trustees' committee and proposed to the appropriate Conference committee at the 1987 Conference.

38 In "The A.A. Group" pamphlet, in the section "What do treasurers do?" the text relating to the 60-30-10 Plan be reworded to reflect that this suggested plan for groups to divide contributions to A.A. service entities is only applicable in some areas, and reference be made to the finance pamphlet "Supporting the A.A. Support System."

39 The updated draft for "A.A. for the Woman" be accepted with the exception of the story "I hated Monday mornings . . .," and that production proceed under the direction of the trustees' Literature Committee.

40 In order to determine the need for a daily reflections book, the Conference members ask A.A. members in their areas and report the findings to the G.S.O. literature coordinator by January 1, 1987, for consideration by the 1987 Conference.

41 The spirit of the 1977 Conference action regarding group literature displays be reaffirmed, and recommended the suggestion that A.A. groups be encouraged to display or sell only literature published and distributed by the General Service Office, the A.A. Grapevine, and other A.A. entities.

42 Because the story section is still up-to-date, there is no need to develop a fourth edition of the Big Book at this time.

43 To establish the need for additional formats of the Big Book, an explicit questionnaire (describing the preferred Lexitone—soft-cover—samples of [1] the pocket size and [2] first eleven chapters, plus Dr. Bob's story) be developed for use by the delegates in surveying A.A. groups in their areas. It is further recommended that area delegates be responsible for distributing the questionnaire and returning them to G.S.O. by July 15, 1986, and that the results be reported to all Conference members by August 1, 1986. Should the survey results indicate, in the judgment of the General Service Board, substantial requests for additional format(s), A.A.W.S. may act as necessary.

Policy/Admissions

It was recommended that:

44 The revised Conference questionnaire be approved to evaluate the 1987 General Service Conference.

45 The 38th General Service Conference be scheduled for April 17-23, 1988.

46 With regard to proposing Floor Actions in the final hours of the Conference, the 1968 recommendation, which was as follows, be reaffirmed: "That when questions of importance for the Conference could not be sent to the areas in advance, consideration be given to an oral presentation early in the Conference sessions, with discussion and voting to be taken at a later date during the Conference."

In case any women Conference members were startled on Wednesday night when they went to powder their noses, here's the explanation: The delegates and their convention bureau helpers who were due to make presentations to the 1990 International Convention Site Committee on the second floor of the hotel found that their "holding room" had been preempted by mistake and was now labeled a workshop room. Tom Beebe (Panel 36, San Diego) thought he might solve the problem by moving the "Workshop" sign to the door of the Ladies' Room. It didn't work—the bidders ended up waiting in the corridor anyway.

When matters of great significance having a long term effect on the Fellowship or of substantial expense are presented to the floor in the waning hours of the Conference, such matters be referred to the appropriate committee at the next Conference in order for the group conscience to be as informed as possible.

47 Since some misunderstandings have occurred because of seeming breakdowns in communication, the 1963 recommendation, which was as follows, be reaffirmed: "Recommended that G.S.O. continue to refer local matters back to the area involved, with the suggestion that they contact the local delegate and that copies of all correspondence referring to such local matters be sent to the delegate."

Trustees' committees and General Service Office staff continue to inform the area delegates of any significant activities in their areas, whenever possible, in order that the area may offer assistance concerning these activities and that all might be better informed.

48 At this time there is no need to establish a procedure to include into the service structure, as part of an existing area assembly, new states or provinces, U.S./Canada territories, and islands. It was suggested that past experiences be considered. When the General Service Office receives an inquiry about joining the service structure, the staff should encourage local members to develop a district structure and contact an area assembly for inclusion as part of that service structure.

49 Delegates assume more responsibility in encouraging G.S.R.s and local A.A. members to take their suggestions and concerns to district meetings and area assemblies for consideration in order to accommodate the growing number of topics being submitted for consideration by Conference committees. The committee also suggested sending items for the Conference Agenda to the Conference coordinator as early as possible.

50 Regarding the suggestion to change the seal designating General Service Conference-approved literature to the Three Legacies seal, no action be taken since the Conference has reserved that seal for Conference-approved literature; however, the committee commends the idea of making the Fellowship more aware of our Three Legacies.

Public Information

It was recommended that:

51 The focus in public service announcements be on alcoholism identification, although mention of addictions as part of a "story" is acceptable.

52 The 1986 Membership Survey be taken in the same manner as the 1983 survey.

53 Question 14 of the Membership Survey questionnaire read as follows: "In addition to your alcoholism, were you addicted to drugs?"

54 Three new television public service announcements of 30, 20, and 10 seconds, respectively, be approved. In addition, the committee recommended that the 30-second spot and the 20-second spot be made available with different voice-over endings—either "Look us up in the phone book or check your local newspaper" or "Look us up in the phone book."

55 The 28-minute film targeting young people be made, with the provision that in any "reprise" sections in the final film, the focus be on alcoholism only. The committee further recommended that the film be brought to the 1987 General Service Conference for approval.

Report and Charter

It was recommended that:

56 Article 4 of the Conference Charter, on page 24, paragraph two, of the *Service Manual* (1985–86 edition) should read: "A quorum shall consist of two-thirds of all the Conference members registered."

"It will be understood, as a matter of tradition, that a two-thirds vote of Conference members voting shall be considered binding upon the General Service Board and its related corporate services, provided the total vote constitutes at least a Conference quorum."

57 The second paragraph, on page 25 of the *Service Manual* (1985–86 edition), be changed to read: "It will be further understood, regardless of the legal prerogatives of the General Service Board, as a matter of tradition, that a three-quarters vote of all Conference members voting, provided the total vote constitutes at least a Conference quorum, may bring about a reorganization of the General Service Board and the directors and staff members of its corporate services, if or when such reorganization is deemed essential."

58 For purposes of consistency, the second sentence of the first paragraph under "Meaning of the Conference Charter," on page 23 of the *Service Manual* (1985–86 edition), be changed to read: "It provides, for example, that a majority vote of the Conference shall be considered a suggestion to the board of trustees and G.S.O., but that a two-thirds vote of the Conference members voting, provided the total vote constitutes at least a Conference quorum, shall be absolutely binding upon the board, regardless of legal considerations."

59 The draft of the responsibilities of the World Service Meeting delegate be included in *The A.A. Service Manual*.

60 No change to the voting members at an area assembly be made in the *Service Manual* (page 83) at this time.

61 The copy defining the role of the Grapevine Representative at all levels and providing more information about the operation of The A.A. Grapevine, Inc., not be accepted at this time, and that new copy be submitted to this committee for review at the 1987 General Service Conference with the objective of creating an eleventh chapter of *The A.A. Service Manual* specifically devoted to the Grapevine.

62 All recommendations on which no Conference action is taken should become part of the History and Highlights of Actions of each Conference committee.

63 If a committee recommendation does not receive the two-thirds vote required to become a Conference Advisory Action, but has a majority of votes, it automatically becomes a suggestion and will be duly noted in the *Conference Report*.

64 Double-trouble groups not be listed in the A.A. directories.

65 The present inclusion of the Concepts in both their long and short form is sufficient in *The A.A. Service Manual*.

66 No changes be made at this time in the "Structure of the Fellowship" chart on page 21 of the 1985–86 edition of *The A.A. Service Manual*.

International Convention Site Selection Committee

It was recommended that:

67 Three cities be specified for the 1990 International Convention: (a) Houston Texas; (b) Seattle, Washington; (c) Vancouver, British Columbia.

Treatment Facilities

It was recommended that:

68 To more explicitly state the scope of the Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities, under Scope, the paragraph: "The purpose of the committee is to encourage A.A. members to assume responsibility to carry the message to alcoholics in treatment facilities" be changed to the following paragraph from the Treatment Facilities Guidelines, which reads: "The purpose of a treatment facilities committee is to coordinate the work of individual A.A. members and groups who are interested in carrying our message of recovery to alcoholics in treatment facilities, and to set up means of 'bridging the gap' from the facility to the larger A.A. community."

69 The letter in the Treatment Facilities Workbook which addresses the issue of nonalcoholics' attendance at closed A.A. meetings be revised to provide a more sensitive introduction to the subject as follows: The sentence "It has been brought to our attention that *nonalcoholic drug addicts* are attending A.A. meetings in your facility" be changed to "It has been brought to our attention that *nonalcoholic drug addicts* may be attending A.A. meetings in your facility."

70 Item 5 of the "Suggested Do's" for the treatment facilities chairperson (page 79 of the Treatment Facilities Workbook) be changed from "Play some Grapevine cassette tapes—always good listening and learning" to read: "Play some Grapevine cassette tapes—always good listening and learning, and leave some copies of the A.A. Grapevine."

71 Each area treatment facilities committee conduct workshops, as frequently as needed, to effectively utilize the Treatment Facilities Workbook.

72 Treatment facilities committees send liaisons to other service entities' meetings in their area and, in turn, invite them to send liaisons to the treatment facilities committee meetings.

73 The trustees' Committee on Treatment Facilities study ways to

develop contact sponsorship committees for prospective newcomers just leaving treatment facilities and report back to the 1987 Conference.

74 The pamphlet "A.A. in Treatment Centers" be revised as follows: (a) The A.A. Grapevine be added to the list of literature suggestions in paragraph 5 on page 13. The paragraph will read as follows: "Leaving a few pieces of A.A. literature and a copy of the A.A. Grapevine is a good idea, too. Maybe 'If You Are a Professional,' 'A.A. in Your Community,' 'A.A. At a Glance,' and 'Where Do I Go From Here?' Maybe even this pamphlet." (b) The words "'regular' A.A. groups" in paragraph 1 on page 12 and the words "treatment center meetings" in paragraph 5 on page 12 be highlighted by using italics. (c) Paragraphs 4 and 5 on page 7 of the pamphlet "A.A. in Treatment Centers" be revised to accommodate information on the Treatment Facilities Workbook. The revised paragraph will read as follows: "The Treatment Facilities Workbook (available from G.S.O.) contains Guidelines, sample letters, workshop presentations, and other information useful to local treatment facilities committees who are carrying the A.A. message into treatment centers. The pamphlet "How A.A. Members Cooperate With Other Community Efforts to Help Alcoholics" answers specific queries on working within A.A. Traditions, and the pamphlet "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship" gives suggestions for helping the newcomer who may have had exposure to A.A. in a treatment center."

75 The title of the pamphlet "A.A. in Treatment Centers" be changed to "A.A. in Treatment Facilities," as "facilities" is currently a more generally used term. It was also recommended that the word "facilities" replace the word "centers" throughout the body of the pamphlet.

Trustees

It was recommended that:

76 With one exception all candidates for regional trustee of Eastern Canada and Pacific U.S. be eligible for election. The reason for the exception was that the résumé was submitted by the candidate rather than following a Conference action that states the résumé be submitted by the delegate only. (Because of extenuating circumstances, the

Conference as a whole accepted his candidacy during the election process on Wednesday.)

77 The Regional Trustee-G.S.O. Résumé Sheet be updated to include the following information from the Conference Advisory Action from 1985: "Résumés for trustee candidates be sent to the General Service Office by the area delegate only"

78 The following slate of officers and trustees be elected at the annual meeting of the General Service Board in April 1986 [see page 38; the Conference and board approved the slate approved by the trustees' Nominating Committee]; that the following be elected as officers of the General Service Board at its annual meeting [see page 38; slate of officers approved]; that the following be elected as directors of A.A. World Services, Inc. [see page 38; slate of directors approved]; that the following be elected as directors of The A.A. Grapevine, Inc. [see page 38; slate of directors approved].

79 Due to the unforeseen circumstances, the chairperson of the board is authorized to appoint from the existing members of the General Service Board a director of The A.A. Grapevine, Inc., to fill the vacancy.

80 The practice of having a Class A trustee serve as chairperson of the board continue.

81 All résumés of potential Class A and general service trustees and directors be sent to members of the Conference Committee on Trustees for their perusal before the General Service Conference.

New regional trustees

On Wednesday afternoon, Conference members voted to recommend the election of the following to the General Service Board: as Eastern Canada regional trustee, Tom Hills; as Pacific U.S. regional trustee, Ruth Jagodzinski. The two were elected at the April 26, 1986 meeting of the board after the close of the Conference.



John King, recently elected nonalcoholic trustee, has a background in social work and has served both as a consultant and in a treatment capacity.

The General Service Office

INCOME STATEMENT

YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1985

	1985	1984
INCOME		
Sales of literature	\$7,251,232	\$5,992,317
Less: Discount to A.A. groups	(298,496)	(252,541)
<u>Net Sales</u>	6,952,736	5,739,776
Less: Cost of printing	(2,391,618)	(1,906,104)
Royalties	(836,773)	(746,816)
<u>Gross Profit From Literature</u>	3,724,345	3,086,856
Contributions — A.A. groups and members	2,378,828	2,115,790
50th Anniversary Convention	315,940	—
Interest income	32,276	28,216
<u>Total Income</u>	6,451,389	5,230,862
EXPENSES		
Salaries	2,358,720	2,003,947
Pension expense	223,339	240,677
Rent	330,878	300,647
Box 4-5-9	118,157	89,929
A.A. Directories	83,940	77,943
Other service materials	223,043	194,276
Shipping and mailing	755,114	610,367
Other office expenses	480,831	430,532
Insurance and payroll taxes	324,925	276,019
Professional services	67,528	44,168
Big Book — legal and other	33,689	—
Board, committee, and staff meetings	132,177	118,231
1984 World Service Meeting	—	69,351
Writers' fees	20,171	33,944
P.I.C., C.P.C.C., travel	110,895	88,756
General Service Conference	166,116	161,769
E.D.P. system development, equipment, and maintenance	90,775	46,400
Regional Forums and other expenses	61,390	76,780
Leasehold improvements	16,258	5,226
Filmstrip	—	15,396
Foreign literature assistance (net)	28,303	(9,748)
<u>Total Expense</u>	5,626,249	4,874,610
NET INCOME (EXPENSE) FOR YEAR (Exhibit C)	<u>825,140</u>	<u>356,252</u>
NET INCOME (EXPENSE) BY FUNCTION		
Publishing — A.A. World Services, Inc.	\$1,335,755	\$1,141,934
General Fund — General Service Board	(510,615)	(785,682)
CHANGES IN RESERVE FUND		
Balance, January 1	\$3,848,285	\$3,147,931
Transfers: from A.A.W.S.	300,000	260,000
Investment income	492,740	440,354
<u>Balance, December 31</u>	<u>4,641,025</u>	<u>3,848,285</u>

() denotes red figures

The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc. — Notes to Financial Statements, December 31, 1985

Note A — Purposes and Restrictions of Different Funds

The RESERVE FUND was established in 1954 for the purpose of accumulating a prudent operating reserve, which, during 1977, was re-defined as one year's combined operating expenses of A.A. World Services, Inc., The A.A. Grapevine, Inc., and the General Fund of the A.A. General Service Board. The 1977 General Service Conference also recommended that all investment activities of the operating entities be consolidated into the Reserve Fund. That advisory action was approved by the Board of Trustees and, since that time, all funds of the operating entities, in excess of those required for working capital, have been transferred to the Reserve Fund. Included in such transfers from The A.A. Grapevine, Inc., were amounts held as a deferred liability to subscribers and, therefore, reflected as a liability of the Reserve Fund.

The GENERAL FUND comprises assets not included in any of the other funds and which may be used for any purposes for which the corporation was formed.

(continued)

The Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.

INCOME STATEMENT

YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1985

	1985	1984
INCOME — from subscriptions and other sales	<u>\$1,352,960</u>	<u>\$1,192,978</u>
EDITORIAL AND PRINTING		
Salaries, including temporary help	\$184,182	\$156,639
Printing	184,627	181,592
Mailing — service	92,358	91,070
— postage	118,950	100,944
Other production costs	74,053	36,125
Calendar costs	28,564	25,299
Occupancy costs	34,911	31,334
Telephone	1,770	1,680
Office supplies and expenses	4,242	4,150
Other editorial expenses	<u>3,649</u>	<u>3,390</u>
Total	727,306	632,223
CIRCULATION AND BUSINESS		
Salaries, including temporary help	279,274	229,421
Data processing costs	42,189	57,251
Stationery and supplies	11,368	7,643
Occupancy costs	34,765	31,334
Telephone	1,745	1,679
Office expense, including agency fees	14,050	13,690
Selling expense — regular	31,100	28,446
— GvR program	24,257	13,971
Postage	<u>44,403</u>	<u>43,449</u>
Total	483,151	426,884
GENERAL AND ADMINISTRATIVE		
Consultant fees	5,496	5,496
Insurance	28,741	24,015
Professional fees	13,135	11,320
Payroll taxes	33,504	29,622
Meetings and conferences	13,003	9,510
Computer system development, etc.	59,151	5,024
Furniture and equipment	6,906	138
Contribution to Retirement Plan	19,835	29,040
Canadian exchange	<u>2,766</u>	<u>1,470</u>
Total	182,537	115,635
TOTAL COSTS AND EXPENSES	<u>1,392,994</u>	<u>1,174,742</u>
INCOME (LOSS) FROM OPERATIONS	(40,034)	18,236
Interest earned	<u>40,034</u>	<u>8,451</u>
NET INCOME (LOSS) FOR YEAR (Exhibit C)	<u>—</u>	<u>26,687</u>

() denotes red figures

(continued)

Note B — After transfers of \$510,615 in 1985 and \$785,682 in 1984 from Publishing to General Fund.

Note C — Grapevine investment with Reserve Fund — \$514,138, represents the deferred subscription income of the Grapevine at December 31, 1979, plus subsequent net investments of \$33,418 as shown below:

	Investment (Withdrawal)
1981	\$ (100,000)
1983	13,418
1984	60,000
1985	60,000
	<u>33,418</u>

(continued)

The General Service Office and The A.A. Grapevine, Inc.

COMBINED BALANCE SHEET

DECEMBER 31, 1985

	December 31, 1985		December 31, 1984	
	Service Office	A.A. Grapevine	Service Office	A.A. Grapevine
OPERATING FUNDS				
ASSETS				
Cash — checking accounts	\$ 188,321	\$ 61,117	\$ 243,486	\$ 37,220
Short-term cash investments (includes \$402,100 in 1984 for 1985 convention)	1,130,928	115,994	800,821	143,764
Investment (Note C)	—	514,138	—	454,138
Accounts receivable	93,310	41,837	86,852	1,854
Due from Grapevine	23,028	—	6,760	—
Inventories	1,071,142	116,825	1,196,446	82,632
Prepaid expenses	77,158	106,400	61,188	90,358
<u>Total Assets</u>	<u>2,583,887</u>	<u>956,311</u>	<u>2,395,553</u>	<u>809,966</u>
DEDUCT LIABILITIES				
Accounts and accruals payable	521,410	81,428	540,193	71,400
Deferred income	62,732	854,199	380,755	824,882
<u>Total Liabilities</u>	<u>584,142</u>	<u>935,627</u>	<u>920,948</u>	<u>896,282</u>
NET WORTH				
Balance, January 1	1,474,605	(86,316)	1,378,353	(113,003)
Net income (loss) (Exhibits A and B)	825,140	—	356,252	26,687
Prior period adjustment — unfulfilled subscription liability not required	—	107,000	—	—
Transfer to Reserve Fund	(300,000)	—	(260,000)	—
<u>Total Net Worth</u>	<u>1,999,745</u>	<u>20,684</u>	<u>1,474,605</u>	<u>(86,316)</u>
NET WORTH BY FUNCTION OR FUND				
Publishing — A.A. World Services, Inc. (Note A)	\$1,942,732		\$1,417,592	
General Fund — G.S.B. (Note B)	57,013		57,013	
<u>Total Operating Funds — as above</u>	<u>1,999,745</u>		<u>1,474,605</u>	
Reserve Fund	4,641,025		3,848,285	
<u>Total Net Worth</u>	<u>6,640,770</u>		<u>5,322,890</u>	
RESERVE FUND				
Cash	\$ 33,281		\$ 16,425	
Money market and certificates of deposit	133,909		158,197	
Due from (to) A.A. Grapevine	(32,810)		—	
U.S. Treasury obligations	4,877,633		4,003,365	
Accrued interest	143,150		124,436	
Less: Liability for Grapevine subscribers	(514,138)		(454,138)	
<u>Balance, December 31</u>	<u>4,641,025</u>		<u>3,848,285</u>	

() denotes red figures

(continued)

The attached financial statements and above notes have been prepared from the reports on the three separate corporations submitted by our independent certified public accountant.

1986 G.S.O. Budget

A.A. WORLD SERVICES, INC. — PUBLISHING

Income: Sales income has been budgeted at \$6,978,000, \$162,900 (2.2%) below 1985. This projection includes the anticipated reduction of about 86,000 copies in second year sales of "Pass It On," as well as the elimination of the 6% A.A. discount, effective May 1, 1986. During 1986, it is anticipated that A.A.W.S., Inc., will distribute 780,000 copies of "Alcoholics Anonymous," 420,000 "Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions" — regular edition, 63,000 "Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions" — pocket edition, 22,000 "A.A. Comes of Age," 73,000 "As Bill Sees It," 22,000 "Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers," 31,000 of "Pass It On," and more than 8,000,000 booklets, pamphlets, and miscellaneous items. After deducting \$3,317,200 — the amount representing the cost of printing and producing items sold and royalties paid on book sales — the gross profit from sales is estimated to be \$3,660,800. Adding interest earned on daily cash flow, the total income from the publishing activity is expected to be \$3,677,100.

Expenses: Expenses charged against the publishing operation are budgeted at \$2,515,300, representing an increase of 5.2% over 1985. Considered in this increase are higher costs related to increased publishing activity, the additional cost of handling, and continuing growth. Net publishing income, after operating expenses, is expected to be \$1,161,800.

GENERAL FUND — GROUP SERVICES

Income: Contributions from groups and A.A. members have been budgeted at \$2,611,000, an increase of 9.8% over 1985 actual, and interest on cash flow has been budgeted at \$8,700.

Expenses: Total expenses, representing the cost of group services that are paid out of contributions, are expected to be \$3,159,300. Included in this portion of the General Service Office budget is the cost of the General Service Conference, totaling \$189,100. The cost of all service expenses is budgeted to be \$539,600 greater than contribution income. This short-fall will be funded from the net income of the publishing operation.

GENERAL FUND — OTHER EXPENSES

Other expenses of the General Service Board are budgeted at \$1,292,900. This is \$980,700 greater than 1985, and includes \$744,800 for construction and refurbishing which will be paid out of the General Service Board Reserve Fund. Also included in this category of expense are such items as the cost of quarterly trustee meetings, the expenses of the Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community, the cost of Regional Forums, legal and auditing fees, the expense of the archives, the costs of film developments, a Grapevine marketing and management study, and the World Service Meeting. These expenses will be offset by net income from the publishing operation.

A net deficit for the General Service Office has been budgeted at \$670,700. The net operating income is budgeted at \$74,100, after transfers of \$744,800 from the General Service Board Reserve Fund for construction costs.

1986 Grapevine Budget

Total income: Income from magazine and other sales is budgeted at \$1,534,400. This represents an increase of \$181,000 over 1985, on the basis of additional income resulting from subscription price increase.

Total expenses: Expenses are budgeted at \$1,517,400. A net operating income in the amount of \$17,000 has been budgeted for 1986.

Including \$5,000 in interest earned on cash flow, total net income is budgeted to be \$22,000.

1986 G.S.O. Budget

The budget for 1986 operations of G.S.O. activities is as follows:

BUDGET

A.A. WORLD SERVICES, INC. — PUBLISHING

INCOME

Net sales	\$6,978,000*
Less: Cost of products and royalties	3,317,200
Gross profit from sales	3,660,800
Plus: Interest income	16,300
Total income	3,677,100

TOTAL EXPENSES

Net income	1,161,800
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*Based on the sale of:

780,000 books	—	"Alcoholics Anonymous"
420,000 books	—	"Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions" (reg.)
63,000 books	—	"Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions" (pocket)
22,000 books	—	"A.A. Comes of Age"
73,000 books	—	"As Bill Sees It"
22,000 books	—	"Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers"
31,000 books	—	"Pass It On"
and		
Pamphlets, booklets, and miscellaneous items		

GENERAL FUND — GROUP SERVICES

INCOME

Contributions	\$2,611,000
Interest income	8,700
Total income	2,619,700

TOTAL EXPENSES

Net expense	(539,600)
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****Includes cost of General Service Conference—\$189,100**

GENERAL FUND — OTHER EXPENSES

TOTAL EXPENSES (NET)

\$(1,292,900)***

*****Board meetings, P.J.C. expense, C.P.C. expense, legal and auditing fees, Regional Forums, archives, film development, construction, World Service Meeting, etc.**

The publishing activity will contribute \$1,087,700 toward the budgeted deficits, \$744,800 will be transferred from the G.S.B. Reserve Fund for construction, leaving a net G.S.O. income from operations in the amount of \$74,100.

1986 Grapevine Budget

Estimated income from subscription and other sales	\$1,534,400
Total costs and expenses	1,517,400
Net income from operations	17,000
Interest	5,000
Total net income	22,000

1985 Contributions From Groups—by Delegate Area

(in U.S. dollars)

Contributions

Area #	General Service Conference Area	# Gps. Re-ported	# Gps. Contrib.	% of Gps. Contrib.	Total Group Contrib.	Member-ship	Contrib. per Capita	Area #	General Service Conference Area	# Gps. Re-ported	# Gps. Contrib.	% of Gps. Contrib.	Total Group Contrib.	Member-ship	Contrib. per Capita
1.	Ala./N.W. Fla.	308	166	53.8%	\$ 13,245.73	3,958	\$3.35	61.	R.I.	164	86	52.4	11,737.81	2,738	4.29
2.	Alsk.	156	72	46.1	6,331.00	1,900	3.33	62.	S.C.	198	146	73.7	13,174.53	3,021	4.36
3.	Ariz.	510	229	44.9	23,124.81	8,527	2.71	63.	S. Dak.	125	74	59.2	6,470.18	2,485	2.60
4.	Ark.	189	104	55.0	6,389.59	2,753	2.32	64.	Tenn.	311	173	55.6	16,954.30	4,717	3.59
5.	S. Calif.	1,270	571	44.9	72,494.71	40,399	1.79	65.	N.E. Tex.	315	168	53.3	25,717.99	9,390	2.74
6.	N. Coastal	1,417	942	66.4	125,401.73	34,475	3.64	66.	N.W.	189	88	46.5	10,423.32	4,038	2.58
7.	N. Int.	453	210	46.3	23,009.96	9,499	2.42	67.	S.E.	367	178	48.5	21,266.45	10,584	2.01
8.	San Diego	470	254	54.0	26,282.42	12,440	2.11	68.	S.W.	339	187	55.1	21,084.13	6,651	3.17
9.	Mid-S.	1,108	533	48.1	57,867.68	33,674	1.72	69.	Utah	161	83	51.5	7,045.02	2,589	2.72
10.	Colo.	522	274	52.4	30,743.24	10,466	2.94	70.	Vi.	145	75	51.7	6,785.69	2,286	2.97
11.	Conn.	868	424	48.8	47,273.05	17,915	2.64	71.	Va.	788	477	60.5	52,532.50	14,727	3.57
12.	Del.	102	78	76.4	10,407.65	1,643	6.33	72.	Wash.	855	480	56.1	53,170.48	15,543	3.42
13.	D.C.	301	199	66.1	36,569.80	9,448	3.87	73.	W. Va.	196	111	56.6	7,109.23	2,077	3.42
14.	N. Fla.	355	224	63.0	27,113.01	6,074	4.46	74.	N. Wis./Upper Pen. Mich.	501	226	45.1	16,970.56	7,344	2.31
15.	S.	943	543	57.5	73,263.31	15,286	4.79	75.	S.	594	257	43.2	22,093.86	10,163	2.17
16.	Ga.	542	312	57.5	33,773.32	10,254	3.29	76.	Wyo.	106	61	57.5	3,585.43	1,614	2.22
17.	Haw.	176	127	72.1	10,761.34	3,014	3.57	77.	P.R.	110	61	55.4	3,040.45	1,403	2.17
18.	Idaho	171	63	36.8	3,688.93	1,915	1.93	78.	Alta./N.W.T.	470	199	42.3	16,413.87	5,828	2.82
19.	Chicago Ill.	697	307	44.0	35,837.67	15,655	2.29	79.	B.C./Yukon	559	262	46.8	23,389.57	8,256	2.83
20.	N.	722	331	45.8	28,800.12	13,357	2.16	80.	Man.	148	68	45.9	5,685.98	3,301	1.72
21.	S.	314	130	41.4	11,134.67	5,322	2.09	81.	N.B./P.E.I.	222	109	49.0	7,962.13	3,081	2.58
22.	N. Ind.	433	215	49.6	17,962.41	6,499	2.76	82.	N.S./Nfld./Lab. Ont.	244	105	43.0	7,218.38	2,796	2.58
23.	S.	252	158	62.6	15,284.31	4,753	3.22	83.	E.	496	174	35.0	20,277.28	11,254	1.80
24.	Iowa	536	291	54.2	25,345.45	10,151	2.50	84.	N.E.	169	58	34.3	5,148.98	2,011	2.56
25.	Kans.	308	172	55.8	13,232.40	6,329	2.09	85.	N.W.	76	34	44.7	2,339.73	1,163	2.01
26.	Ky.	383	213	55.6	30,005.09	5,722	5.24	86.	W.	427	151	35.3	16,059.33	6,720	2.39
27.	La.	392	224	57.1	20,882.85	6,260	3.34	87.	Que. S.W.	523	306	58.5	13,791.10	13,503	1.02
28.	Me.	267	122	45.6	10,078.35	4,293	2.35	88.	S.E.	221	221	100.0	8,468.48	3,054	2.77
29.	Md.	607	340	56.0	40,044.53	8,376	4.78	89.	N.E.	327	327	100.0	8,842.93	5,840	1.51
30.	Mass.	840	443	52.7	63,063.65	24,082	2.62	90.	N.W.	279	279	100.0	30,894.70	5,267	5.87
31.	W. Mich.	144	82	56.9	10,340.84	2,820	3.67	91.	Sask.	320	166	51.8	10,254.92	3,772	2.72
32.	Cent.	353	191	54.1	25,415.86	7,144	3.56	Total U.S./Canada							
33.	S.E.	413	187	45.2	24,406.63	8,929	2.73			38,268	19,984 ^①	52.2% ^①	\$2,100,193.41 ^②	750,179	\$2.80 ^②
34.	W. Minn.	292	141	48.2	15,675.00	5,694	2.75	Bahamas							
35.	N.	477	215	45.0	12,717.05	7,632	1.67			7	1	14.2	30.00	120	.25
36.	S.	814	378	46.4	33,732.67	23,418	1.44	V.I. of U.S.							
37.	Miss.	214	105	49.0	6,263.25	2,420	2.59			10	4	40.0	197.90	212	.93
38.	E. Mo.	397	229	57.6	23,883.31	5,530	4.32	(U.S. dollars)							
39.	W.	191	105	54.9	11,238.29	3,823	2.94			38,285	19,989 ^①	52.2% ^①	\$2,100,421.31 ^②	750,511	\$2.80 ^②
40.	Mont.	259	112	43.2	8,884.48	3,348	2.65	Individual, in-memoriam, & special meetings							
41.	Nebr.	571	322	56.3	31,788.17	9,992	3.18						\$ 76,647.82		
42.	Nev.	225	103	45.7	8,805.59	3,132	2.81	Specials							
43.	N.H.	261	131	50.1	13,738.80	3,531	3.89						176,443.63		
44.	N. N.J.	898	436	48.5	50,176.43	18,992	2.64	Total for U.S. & Canada (U.S. dollars)							
45.	S.	227	132	58.1	16,205.01	3,359	4.82						\$2,353,512.76		
46.	N.M.	218	108	49.5	9,052.95	3,359	2.70	FOREIGN AND OTHER							
47.	Cent. N.Y.	443	224	50.5	28,972.01	5,922	4.89	Birds of a Feather							
48.	H./M./B.	399	196	49.1	14,396.16	4,827	2.98						\$ 230.00		
49.	S.E.	1,203	607	50.4	93,077.70	31,320	2.97	Correctional facility groups							
50.	W.	205	99	48.2	8,680.43	2,900	2.99						73.33		
51.	N.C./Ber.	559	368	65.8	38,127.79	8,637	4.41	Foreign							
52.	N. Dak.	143	76	53.1	5,094.42	2,403	2.12						11,740.00		
53.	Cent. & S.E. Ohio	377	147	38.9	14,608.39	5,900	2.48	International Advisory Council of Young People in A.A.							
54.	N.E.	812	207	25.4	17,024.19	20,161	.84						5,736.00		
55.	N.W. Ohio/ S.E. Mich.	226	93	41.1	9,795.99	3,132	3.13	International Lawyers in A.A.							
56.	S.W. Ohio/ N. Ky.	304	155	50.9	13,192.68	5,839	2.26						1,999.00		
57.	Okla.	317	236	74.4	23,292.92	4,197	5.55	Internationalists							
58.	Oreg.	507	262	51.6	22,429.92	6,667	3.36						115.00		
59.	E. Pa.	757	404	53.3	50,896.78	16,260	3.13	Loners							
60.	W.	505	272	53.8	21,899.61	7,236	3.03						1,417.40		
								Treatment facility meetings							
													3,939.33		
								World Hello							
													63.84		
								Grand Total							
													\$2,378,826.66		

CONTRIBUTION COMPARISON — 1985-1984 (in U.S. dollars)

	#Gps. Re-ported	# Gps. Contrib.	% of Gps. Contrib.	Amount of Contrib.	Member-ship	Contrib. per Capita
U.S. & Canada 1985	38,285	19,989 ^①	52.2% ^①	\$2,100,421.31 ^②	750,511	\$2.80 ^②
U.S. & Canada 1984	36,040	19,321 ^①	53.6 ^①	1,864,955.67 ^②	702,311	2.66 ^②
Increase (Decrease)	2,245	668	(1.4%)	\$ 235,465.64	48,200	\$.14

① Reflects not only those groups that contributed directly to G.S.O., but also those groups that contributed to G.S.O. through their Conference areas (per lists submitted by areas).

② Group contributions reported on this schedule do not include contributions received as specials, individual, in-memoriam, and special meetings.

U.S.	#Gps. Re- ported	#Gps. Contrib.	% of Gps. Contrib.	Amount of Contrib.	Member- ship	Contrib. per Capita
Alabama	242	126	52.0%	\$ 8,896.13	3,463	\$2.57
Alaska	156	72	46.1	7,079.90	1,900	3.73
Arizona	501	225	44.9	25,261.90	8,527	2.96
Arkansas	187	104	55.6	7,836.47	2,687	2.92
California	4,763	2,524	52.9	348,661.92	131,696	2.65
Colorado	522	274	52.4	43,882.52	10,476	4.19
Connecticut	876	431	49.2	57,156.53	18,071	3.16
Delaware	101	78	77.2	10,407.65	1,627	6.40
District of Columbia	135	77	57.0	13,730.69	4,476	3.07
Florida	1,363	807	59.2	126,222.87	22,230	5.68
Georgia	542	312	57.5	36,816.37	10,254	3.59
Hawaii	176	127	72.1	12,445.73	3,014	4.13
Idaho	200	80	40.0	6,334.82	2,228	2.84
Illinois	1,732	767	44.2	92,171.19	34,518	2.67
Indiana	714	388	54.3	36,658.77	11,681	3.14
Iowa	537	291	54.1	30,289.80	10,160	2.98
Kansas	308	172	55.8	19,738.75	6,329	3.12
Kentucky	357	200	56.0	30,108.34	5,369	5.61
Louisiana	391	223	57.0	22,366.35	6,252	3.58
Maine	261	117	44.8	12,622.35	4,254	2.97
Maryland	766	458	59.7	65,323.98	13,213	4.94
Massachusetts	1,001	525	52.4	77,841.96	27,187	2.86
Michigan	1,212	582	48.0	74,028.20	23,900	3.10
Minnesota	1,288	593	46.0	57,167.25	31,040	1.84
Mississippi	215	106	49.3	6,517.50	2,429	2.68
Missouri	587	334	56.8	36,571.56	9,321	3.92
Montana	259	112	43.2	9,104.73	3,348	2.72
Nebraska	570	322	56.4	42,643.37	9,980	4.27
Nevada	189	91	48.1	9,344.82	2,596	3.60
New Hampshire	264	136	51.5	15,067.80	3,579	4.21
New Jersey	1,122	568	50.6	68,715.46	22,260	3.09
New Mexico	218	109	50.0	10,836.85	3,241	3.34
New York	2,262	1,123	49.6	160,707.38	44,991	3.57
North Carolina	542	367	67.7	38,627.29	8,509	4.54
North Dakota	143	76	53.1	6,984.44	2,403	2.91
Ohio	1,684	593	35.2	63,618.32	34,319	1.85
Oklahoma	321	238	74.1	24,258.36	4,240	5.72
Oregon	511	264	51.6	24,539.02	6,724	3.65
Pennsylvania	1,281	684	53.3	79,341.75	23,775	3.34
Rhode Island	160	85	53.1	13,523.31	2,636	5.13
South Carolina	199	147	73.8	13,335.53	3,024	4.41
South Dakota	125	74	59.2	7,525.27	2,485	3.03
Tennessee	310	173	55.8	18,280.09	4,712	3.88
Texas	1,213	623	51.3	89,063.57	30,483	2.92
Utah	160	82	51.2	8,252.02	2,573	3.21
Vermont	142	72	50.7	7,346.19	2,245	3.27
Virginia	797	481	60.3	56,439.32	14,927	3.78
Washington	811	457	56.3	58,859.09	15,068	3.91
West Virginia	193	110	56.9	8,642.62	2,034	4.25
Wisconsin	980	428	43.6	37,670.70	16,287	2.31
Wyoming	106	61	57.5	3,652.10	1,614	2.26
Commonwealth of P.R.	110	61	55.4	3,184.70	1,403	2.27
Bahama Islands	7	1	14.3	30.00	120	.25
Virgin Islands of U.S.	10	4	40.0	197.90	212	.93
Bermuda	18	1	5.5	100.00	144	.69
TOTAL for U.S.	33,840	17,536	51.8%	\$2,146,031.50	676,234	\$3.17

① Reflects not only those groups that contributed directly to G.S.O., but also those groups that contributed to G.S.O. through their Conference areas (per lists submitted by areas).

CANADA (stated in Canadian dollars)	#Gps. Re- ported	#Gps. Contrib.	% of Gps. Contrib.	Amount of Contrib.	Member- ship	Contrib. per Capita
Alberta	416	189	45.4%	\$ 28,294.04	5,200	\$5.44
Atlantic Provinces						
New Brunswick	167	89	53.2	8,802.01	1,995	4.41
Newfoundland	100	34	34.0	4,474.65	924	4.84
Nova Scotia	143	71	49.6	9,244.72	1,843	5.02
Prince Edward Island	64	26	40.6	2,612.37	1,164	2.24
Labrador	2	0	0.0	—	37	—
British Columbia	597	272	45.5	39,599.63	8,686	4.56
Manitoba	148	68	45.9	9,944.92	3,301	3.01
N.W. Territories	20	2	10.0	173.22	207	.84
Ontario	1,126	402	35.7	70,171.55	20,707	3.39
Quebec	1,333	1,131	84.8	101,310.78	26,313	3.85
Saskatchewan	321	167	52.0	17,471.98	3,791	4.61
Yukon Territory	8	2	25.0	127.10	109	1.17
TOTAL for (Canadian dollars)	4,445	2,453①	55.2%①	292,226.97	74,277	3.93①
(converted to U.S. dollars)				207,481.26		2.79①
TOTAL for U.S. (U.S. and CANADA dollars)	38,285	19,989①	52.2%①	\$2,353,512.76	750,511	3.14①
FOREIGN AND OTHER						
Birds of a Feather				230.00		
Correctional facility groups				73.33		
Foreign				11,740.00		
International Advisory Council of Young People in A.A.				5,736.00		
International Lawyers in A.A.				1,999.00		
Internationalists				115.00		
Loners				1417.40		
Treatment facility meetings				3,939.33		
World Hello				63.84		
GRAND TOTAL				\$2,378,826.66		

CONTRIBUTION COMPARISON — 1984-1985 (in U.S. dollars)

	#Gps. Re- ported	#Gps. Contrib.	% of Gps. Contrib.	Amount of Contrib.	Member- ship	Contrib. per Capita
U.S. 1985	33,840	17,536	51.8%	\$2,146,031.50	676,234	\$3.17
U.S. 1984	31,754	17,106	53.9	1,916,913.17	630,679	3.04
Increase (Decrease)	2,086	430	(2.1%)	\$ 229,118.33	45,555	\$.13
Canada 1985	4,445	2,453①	55.2%①	\$ 207,481.26	74,277	\$2.79①
Canada 1984	4,286	2,215①	51.7 ①	176,714.57	71,632	2.47①
Increase (Decrease)	159	238	3.5%	\$ 30,766.69	2,645	\$.32
U.S. and Canada 1985	38,285	19,989①	52.2%①	\$2,353,512.76	750,511	\$3.14①
U.S. and Canada 1984	36,040	19,321①	53.6 ①	2,093,627.74	702,311	2.98①
Increase (Decrease)	2,245	668	(1.4%)	\$ 259,885.02	48,200	\$.16

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Correctional Facilities

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Grapevine
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Conference Report and Charter
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Eileen Gatza, *secretary*

Treatment Facilities

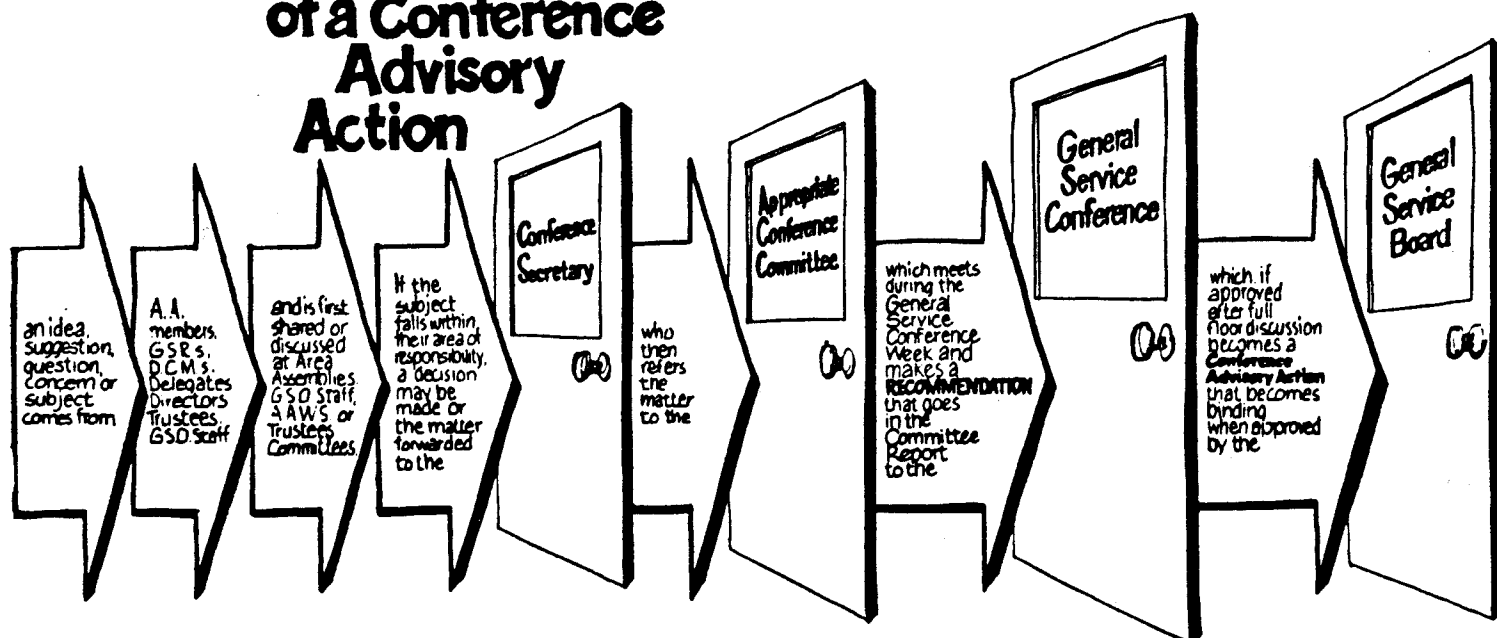
William Flynn, M.D., *chairperson*
James Ahern
Kenneth Dunphy
Hugh Freyer
Joan Jackson, Ph.D.
Don Pritts
Joseph Rhoads
James Shannon
Kenneth Williams, M.D.,
Maureen Costello, *secretary*

General Sharing Session

Natalie Schwanke, *chairperson*
Lois Fisher, *secretary*
All members of the General Service Board, A.A.W.S., and GV Boards, G.S.O. and GV staffs, and trustees' committees participate in this "town meeting."

Gordon Patrick and John Bragg are ex officio members of all committees. Committee secretaries and consultants do not vote.

Flow Chart of a Conference Advisory Action



"Were it not for Committees, it is doubtful that any Conference could get over a fraction of the ground it now covers. As the Conference has grown in size and influence the Committees' importance has grown even more."
...from the A.A. Service Manual, p 72

Nonalcoholic (Class A) trustees

Gordon M. Patrick (P.O. Box 774, Kingston, ON K7L 4X6, Canada), was elected to the board in 1975 and became its chairperson in 1982. Recently retired, he was a management consultant with a special interest in helping organizations develop programs for employees disabled by alcoholism. Formerly associated with the Addiction Research Foundation of Ontario and the Donwood Institute, he has a continuing interest in employee assistance programs and professional education. A longtime friend of A.A., Gordon considers it "the most useful resource for recovery from alcoholism."

W. J. Estelle Jr. (111 Sunset Lake Dr., Huntsville, TX 77340), former director, Texas Department of Corrections, was named a trustee in April 1977. He began his career in corrections in 1952 in California and then became warden of Montana State Prison. Jim has taught courses in corrections and is a member of seven professional societies on criminal justice, corrections, and services to children and youth. Having retired from corrections, he is now president of the First National Bank*South in Huntsville. Jim chairs the Committee on Correctional Facilities and also serves on the trustees' Finance and Nominating Committees.

William E. Flynn, M.D. (1164 Old Gate Ct., McLean, VA 22101) joined the board in April 1980. A graduate of the Georgetown University School of Medicine, he is currently assistant professor of psychiatry at Georgetown and director of studies in alcohol and drug abuse. He is also a consultant to the National Center for Alcohol Education and the alcohol treatment unit at Arlington Hospital, Virginia. Bill chairs the Treatment Facilities Committee and serves on the Cooperation With the Professional Community and International Committees. He is also a member of the Grapevine Corporate Board.

Joan K. Jackson, Ph.D. (72 Downs Rd., Bethany, CT 06525) was elected to the board in April 1983. A graduate of McGill University, Montreal, and the University of Washington, Seattle, Joan taught sociology and has been a consultant and editorial adviser for many local and national boards and committees on alcoholism and on health and human behavior. At the University of Washington Medical School in Seattle, Joan was involved in research and teaching about alcoholism, A.A., and Al-Anon. She chairs the Literature Committee and is a member of the Archives, Cooperation With the Professional Community, and Treatment Facilities Committees.

John King (423 Hawthorn, Fayetteville, AR 72701) was elected to the board in 1986. A graduate of the St. Mary's College, Kentucky, and Tulane University, Louisiana, John was an ordained priest and has a background in social work. Currently, he is on the faculty of the University of Arkansas in the Social Work Program, where he serves as consultant to many local, state, and regional agencies as well as in a treatment capacity. John has received numerous awards and honors for his professional and civic/community service.

Robert P. Morse (96 Cove Rd., Oyster Bay, NY 11771) was elected to the board in April 1984. A graduate of the University of Pennsylvania, he has over 15 years' experience in the investment business, with an in-depth background in the fixed-income sector and management of equity portfolios. Robert has his own investment counsel firm and is president of the Wall Street Fund. He is chairperson of the Finance & Budgetary Committee.

Amos E. Reed (2840 Holiday Dr. S., Salem, OR 97302) was elected to the board in April 1986. A graduate of McKendree College and Northern Illinois University, he has extensive background in corrections, education, and public welfare. He is past president of the

American Correctional Association, National Association of State Correctional Administrators, and National Association of Training Schools and Juvenile Agencies and has received many awards for his services in corrections and other agencies. Currently Washington Secretary of Corrections, Amos has held leadership positions in North Carolina, Florida, Oregon, and Illinois.

John Hartley Smith, M.D. (828 West 10th Ave., Vancouver, B.C. V5Z 1L8, Canada) was elected to the board in 1986. A graduate of The Queens' University Medical School Belfast, he has specialized in occupational and public health and has served on many professional committees and advisory councils, both local and national. John has been assistant deputy minister in the B.C. Ministry of Health since 1979, but this year he was appointed senior medical consultant in occupational and environmental health to the government. He is also a director of the American Board of Preventive Medicine and part-time clinical associate professor in the Faculty of Medicine at the University of British Columbia.

Kenneth H. Williams, M.D. (12 Hummingbird Rd., Wyomissing, PA 19610) joined the board in 1979. His primary interest is in teaching physicians and other health-care professionals about alcoholism and other drug-abuse problems. Formerly a full-time faculty member of the Yale University School of Medicine and the University of Pittsburgh School of Medicine, he is currently director of a community-oriented alcoholism treatment program. Ken chairs the Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community and serves on the Treatment Facilities, Archives, and Literature Committees.

Alcoholic (Class B) trustees

Dan M. Byrne (2900 19th Avenue, Marion, Iowa 52302), elected West Central U.S. regional trustee in April 1984, has a background of group and area service and was a Panel 29 Conference delegate. He is currently employed by the Quaker Oats Cereal Company in Cedar Rapids, Iowa. Dan chairs the International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums Committee and is a member of the Correctional Facilities and International Committees. He is also a member of the Grapevine Corporate Board.

William H. Croke (165 Perry Ave., Norwalk, CT 06850) was elected general service trustee in April 1986. He has been active in group service since 1970 and has served as A.A.W.S. director since 1983. Bill's background is in advertising/marketing, and he is currently a partner in a small advertising agency in New York City. A member of the Public Information Committee since 1976, Bill also serves on the Literature and International Committees.

Kenneth L. Dunphy (115 Humphrey St., Moncton, N.B. E1C 6P2, Canada), elected Eastern Canada regional trustee in 1982, has been active in district and area service and was a Panel 26 Conference delegate. Ken's background is in the electromechanical drafting field. He is currently employed by the Canadian Federal Government, as a drafting supervisor. At his present office, he is an A.A. contact for the employee assistance program. Ken serves on the International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums, Nominating, Correctional, and Treatment Facilities Committees.

John R. (Jack) Ford (3092 West King Edward, Vancouver, B.C. V6L 1V5) was elected Western Canada regional trustee in April 1984. Jack has been active in group, intergroup, and area service. As a Panel 29 Conference delegate, he chaired the Finance Committee. He is owner of an auto sales and service center. Jack currently is a member of the A.A.W.S. board of directors and chairperson of the Conference

1986 Conference Members

Committee. He also serves on the Cooperation with the Professional Community and Nominating Committees.

Helen A. Harmon (Box 850, Melita, MB, Canada R0M 1L0), elected trustee-at-large/Canada in April 1983, served her area as G.S.R., D.C.M., and as a Panel 28 Conference delegate. She remains active in group and area service. Helen is owner and operator of a franchise for income-tax preparation and a salesperson for mutual funds and investments. She served on the board of directors of the Alcoholism Foundation of Manitoba. Helen chairs the International Committee and is a member of the Literature and Nominating Committees. She also serves on the Grapevine Corporate Board.

Tom Hills (48 McGregor Road, Scarborough, ON M1P 1C8, Canada) was elected Eastern Canada regional trustee in April 1986. Tom has been active in group, intergroup, and area service and was a Panel 33 Conference delegate. A former director of Ontario's Employees Benefits Branch, in 1985 he was chairperson of the Canadian Public Service Pension Advisors. Currently Tom is senior advisor to Ontario's Management Board of Cabinet on Public Service Pensions.

Ruth C. Jagodzinski (2934 S. Lindell, Las Vegas, NV 89102), elected Pacific U.S. regional trustee in April 1986, has been active in group, intergroup, and area service and was a Panel 29 Conference delegate. Ruth's background is in the home-health-care and nursing fields; she co-owns and administers a home-health-care program. She is a member of the governor's Advisory Board for Alcohol and Drug Abuse and president of the State Certified Board for Substance Abuse, Counselors, and Program Administrators.

Wayne Parks (1120 West Cypress, Rogers, AR 72756), elected Southwest U.S. regional trustee in April 1983, has a background in area service and was a Panel 29 Conference delegate. He has worked in the oil sales, freight, and furniture fields and serves on the Arkansas Alcohol and Drug Abuse Authority and on the Alcohol and Drug Abuse Advisory Council. Wayne serves on the A.A.W.S. Board and chairs the Nominating Committee. He is a member of the Finance & Budgetary and International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums Committees.

Joe Phelan (272 The South Chace, Atlanta, GA 30328), elected Southeast U.S. regional trustee in April 1985, has been active in group and area service. As a Panel 30 Conference delegate, he chaired the Conference Finance Committee. Joe has served on the Georgia Task Force on Alcohol, Marijuana, and Other Drugs and was president of the Metro Atlanta Council on Alcoholism. Now retired, his background is in the finance, marketing, and investment banking fields. Joe is a member of the Archives, Conference, Finance & Budgetary, and Nominating Committees.

Don I. Pritts (1009 S. Lewiston Way, Aurora, CO 80017) was elected trustee-at-large, U.S./Canada, in April 1985. He has been active in group and area service and was a Panel 31 Conference delegate. Don has been an employment counselor and is a volunteer for adolescent treatment units. Currently he is a sales director for the Conklin Company, establishing and training franchise holders. Don serves on the Correctional Facilities, International, Public Information, and Treatment Facilities Committees.

Shepherd Raimi (1040 Park Avenue, New York, N.Y. 10028), elected general service trustee in April 1985, is an active member of his group in Red Hook, N.Y. He is a lawyer in New York City and has had a great deal of experience with the impaired lawyer and other aspects of law and alcoholism. Shep serves on the A.A.W.S. Board and is a member of the Archives, International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums, and Nominating Committees.

Ralph Rosenberg Jr. (410 West 24th St., New York, N.Y. 10011), elected general service trustee in April 1984, remains active in group and intergroup service. He has been a writer for radio and TV and is now employed in the advertising field. Ralph has served on the Grapevine Editorial Board and currently chairs the Grapevine Corporate Board. He also chairs the Public Information Committee and is a member of the Conference and Literature Committees.

Natalie Schwanke (14601 N.E. 35th, Bellevue, WA 98007) was elected Pacific U.S. regional trustee in 1982. She has served both the Seattle Intergroup and her area, which sent her to the Conference as a Panel 25 delegate. She remains active in community affairs and is a manufacturer's representative in women's clothing and accessories. Natalie chairs the General Sharing Session and is a member of the International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums, Literature, and Nominating Committees.

James Shannon (3106 Kingsbridge Ave., Bronx, NY 10463), elected general service trustee in April 1985, has been active in group, intergroup, and area service and was a Panel 27 Conference delegate. Jim worked as a supervisor at a management consulting firm and is now retired. He is a director on the Grapevine Corporate Board and a member of the Archives, Cooperation With the Professional Community, and Treatment Facilities Committees.

Garrett Taylor (50 55th St. S.E., Washington, DC 20019) was elected Northeast U.S. regional trustee in April 1983. He was chairperson of Washington Intergroup and of the area committee. After serving as a Panel 27 delegate, he returned to area activities. A retired postal manager, Garrett remains active in civic affairs. He chairs the trustees' Archives Committee and is a member of the Conference, Public Information, and International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums Committees.

John R. (Jack) Whitehouse (1604 Clover Lane, Midland, MI 48640) was elected East Central U.S. regional trustee in April 1985. He has been active in group and area service and was a Panel 31 Conference delegate. A practicing attorney, he now serves as administrative law judge, Workers' Disability Compensation Bureau, for the State of Michigan's Department of Labor. Jack serves on the Conference, Cooperation With the Professional Community, Finance & Budgetary, and International Committees.

Officers of the General Service Board

Chairperson	Gordon Patrick
First vice-chairperson	W.J. Estelle Jr.
Second vice-chairperson	Kenneth Williams, M.D.
Secretary	Natalie Schwanke
Treasurer	Robert Morse
Assistant secretary	Lois Fisher

The new slate of officers (post-Conference) is given on page 38.

1 Retiring at the close of the 1986 Conference meeting.

2 New trustee, becoming a Conference member immediately after election by the General Service Board, April 26, 1986.

3 Ken died on April 14, 1986.

A.A. World Services directors

Wayne Parks, *chairperson*
John Bragg
William Croke
Lois Fisher

Jack Ford
Harold Greene
Shepherd Raimi
Joseph Rhoads

A.A. Grapevine directors

Ralph Rosenberg Jr., *chairperson*
Norman Adams
Dan Byrne
William Flynn, M.D.
Retha Gresham

Helen Harmon
Jim Shannon
Stanley Silverman
Desmond Towey
Ann Warner

General Service Office staff

John Bragg, *general manager*
Lyla Bonney
Cheryl Ann Burke
Susan Daly
Lois Fisher
Eileen Gatza
Tom Jasper

Betty Liddle
Curtis Monahan
Bob Pearson
Sarah Price
Helen Turnquest
Frank Mauser, *archivist*
Vicente Mejia, *Spanish services*

Grapevine staff

Retha Gresham
Grace Hedderman

Ames Sweet
Ann Warner

Others Assisting at the Conference (*nonvoting*)

G.S.O./Grapevine Personnel

Rosa Blanco, *Steno/Clerical Department*
Ed Brady, *Steno/Clerical Department*
Shirley Brown, *Steno/Clerical Department*
Charles Columbia, *controller*
Maureen Costello, *G.S.O. staff*
Lynda Ernst, *Steno/Clerical Department*
Owen Flanagan, *independent C.P.A.*
Anna Florio, *Steno/Clerical Department*
Elizabeth Garcia, *supervisor, Steno/Clerical Department*
Edward Gordon, *director of finance/business administrator*
Dorothy Graham, *writer/editor, Conference Report*
Al Herr, *artist, Conference Report*
Margie Janicek, *Steno/Clerical Department*
Thomas Jasper, *services director*
John Kirwin Jr., *assistant controller*
Vinnie McCarthy, *publications director*
Dorothy McGinity, *Conference Manual coordinator*
Don Meurer, *Grapevine controller*
John Nayduch, *Grapevine art director*
Tony Osnato, *office manager/events coordinator*
Elsie Oxman, *Steno/Clerical Department*
Ivelisse Rivera, *Steno/Clerical Department*
Frank Segui, *Steno/Clerical Department*
Joan Smith, *Steno/Clerical Department*
Naomi Strassberg, *Grapevine executive secretary*
Cynthia White, *Steno/Clerical Department*
Madeline Whitlock, *secretary, A.A. World Services*
Eleanor Widdoes, *editor, Early Bird Box 4-5-9*
Adeline Wilmot, *assistant to the Conference coordinator*

Trustees emeriti

Milton Maxwell, Ph.D.
John L. Norris, M.D.

All nontrustee, nondirector members of the trustees' committees are encouraged to attend and participate at the joint meetings. They are also encouraged to attend, as observers, the Monday sessions of the Conference and one presentation session related to the committee on which they serve.

Area delegates

What do panel numbers mean? Delegates to each Conference are made up of two "panels." One is even-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an even year. The other is odd-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an odd year. The 36th Conference includes Panel 35 (delegates now serving for their second year) and Panel 36 (new delegates).

State	Area no.	Panel	
Alabama/N.W. Florida	1	35	Jack K. McLemore, 820 Giles Dr. N.E., Huntsville, AL 35801
Alaska	2	36	Francis D. Bratager, 1195 Bratager Rd., North Pole, AK 99705
Arizona	3	36	Edward P. Cavin, 1560 San Carla, Green Valley, AZ 85614
Arkansas	4	35	Harlan Petter, 5 Kings Highway, Eureka Springs, AR 72632
California	5	35	Southern—Ann Garrity, 1418 Los Osos Rd., Los Osos, CA 93402
	6	35	Northern Coastal—Diane M. Olsen, 14630 Springer Ct., Saratoga, CA 95070
	7	36	Northern Interior—Will Noble, P.O. Box 162607, Sacramento, CA 95816
	8	36	San Diego—Tom Beebe, 3752 Catamarca, San Diego, CA 92124
	9	36	Mid-Southern—William Schmidt, 8123 Magnolia Ave., #60, Riverside, CA 92504
Colorado	10	35	Ed Price, P.O. Box 377, Franktown, CO 80116
Connecticut	11	35	Richard Koseski, 260 Three Mile Rd., Glastonbury, CT 06033
Delaware	12	36	Wes Jones, 2010 Monroe Pl., Wilmington, DE 19802
District of Columbia	13	35	Eleanor Boyle, 10820 Georgia Ave., #312, Wheaton, MD 20902
Florida	14	35	Northern—Robert J. Schneck, 1282 The Grove Rd., Orange Park, FL 32073
	15	35	Southern/Bahamas—Josh Hill, 2500 S.W. 75th Ave., Miami, FL 33155
Georgia	16	36	Jerome Waller, 204 Fortune Loop, Swainsboro, GA 30401
Hawaii	17	35	Patrick Walsh, P.O. Box 89200, Honolulu, HI 96830

Rosters

State	Area no.	Panel		State	Area no.	Panel	
Idaho	18	36	Gwen Fields, 1311 Willow St., Caldwell, ID 83605	Mississippi	37	36	Buddy Holder, 805 Daniel St., New Albany, MS 38652
Illinois	19	35	Chicago—William Wilson, 9231 S. Mozart, Evergreen Park, IL 60642	Missouri	38	35	Eastern—Dennis Moore, #12 Trailside Dr., Lake St. Louis, MO 63367
	20	36	Northern—Henry Groat, R.R. 4, Princeton, IL 61356		39	35	Western—Richard D. Bush, P.O. Box 176, Neosho, MO 64850
	21	35	Southern—James R. Hill, 85 Forest View Rd., Morton, IL 61550	Montana	40	36	Walter Thompson, P.O. Box 6788, Great Falls, MT 59406
Indiana	22	35	Northern—Hubert Malone, 50 Elkton Ct., Lafayette, IN 47905	Nebraska	41	36	Sharon L. K. Macomber, H.C. 96, Box 21, Whitman, NE 69366
	23	36	Southern—Arthur D. Cross, 11519 Rolling Springs Dr., Carmel, IN 46032	Nevada	42	35	Fredrick Yourdon, 365 Denslowe Dr., Reno, NV 89512
Iowa	24	35	Evelyn C. Vyverberg, 5638 Quercus Ln., Davenport, IA 52806	New Hampshire	43	36	Peter G. Robinson, 25 McDougall St., Kittery, ME 03904
Kansas	25	36	Mary Baker, 4323 Deerfield, Wichita, KS 67216	New Jersey	44	35	Northern—John Quinn, 66 Brookwood Pkwy., Jackson, NJ 08527
Kentucky	26	36	John Jones, 1127 Griffith Ave., Owensboro, KY 42301		45	36	Southern—Harry J. Fischler, 212 Walt Whitman Blvd., Cherry Hill, NJ 08003
Louisiana	27	35	D.T. Waller Jr., 7344 Sheffield Ct., Baton Rouge, LA 70806	New Mexico	46	36	Henry R. Dolan, 5501 Summer N.E., Albuquerque, NM 87110
Maine	28	36	Bob Dodge, P.O. Box 83, Stonington, ME 04681	New York	47	35	Central—Jim Doss, P.O. Box 68, Harford, NY 13784
Maryland	29	36	Gene Ray, 579 Bell Manor Rd., Conowingo, MD 21918		48	36	Hudson/Mohawk/Berkshire—Bill Miller, Box 73, Warnerville, NY 12187
Massachusetts	30	35	Eastern—Mary E. Reynolds, 18 Rainbow Pond Dr., Walpole, MA 02081		49	35	Southeast—Emily Rayford, c/o Mrs. Darby, Apt. 1D, 151 N. Oxford Walk, Brooklyn, NY 11205
	31	36	Western—Paul O. Davidson, 32 St. Kolbe Dr., Holyoke, MA 01040		50	36	Western—William J. Hay, 68 Ebenezer Dr., West Seneca, NY 14224
Michigan	32	35	¹ Central—Charles Furtaw, 3802 Craig, Flint, MI 48506	North Carolina/Bermuda	51	35	James S. Johnson, P.O. Box 3146, Wilson, NC 27895-3146
	33	35	Southeastern—Adam Tengler, 22447 Oaklane, Warren, MI 48089	North Dakota	52	36	Ole Borgen, 2510 11th Ave. S., Grand Forks, ND 58201
	34	36	Western—Janet Whitney, 9700 Avalon Rd., Greenville, MI 48838	Ohio	53	35	Central & Southeastern—George Mudrich, 3387 Medina Ave., Columbus, OH 43224
Minnesota	35	36	Northern—Louis Hall, 809 19th Ave. S., Fargo, ND 58103		54	35	Northeastern—Lois Fischer, 16340 Heather Lane #102, Middleburg Heights, OH 44130
	36	35	Southern—Richard J. Klaras, R.R. 1, Box 21, Webster, MN 55088		55	36	N.W. Ohio/S.E. Mich.—Jack Reighard, 1208 Cady, Maumee, OH 43537

¹ Unable to attend the Conference; the alternate delegate, Lorraine Burks, was seated.

State	Area no.	Panel	
Ohio	56	36	S.W. Ohio/N. Ky.—Bob Morse, 2352 Magdalena Dr., Cincinnati, OH 45231
Oklahoma	57	35	Day Fezler, 3508 Treadwell Dr., Oklahoma City, OK 73112
Oregon	58	36	Kathy A. Jarchow, P.O. Box 851, Gold Beach, OR 97444
Pennsylvania	59	35	Eastern—Robert G. Neerland, 1235 Wilmington Pike, West Chester, PA 19380
	60	35	Western—Ray Donovan, 415 Duquesne Dr., Pittsburgh, PA 15243
Rhode Island	61	36	Cliff Carlson, 73 Tucker Ave., Cranston, RI 02905
South Carolina	62	36	Cole Zobel, 1505 S. Kilbourne Rd., Columbia, SC 29205
South Dakota	63	36	Elroy Mundhenke, Box 873, Spearfish, SD 57783
Tennessee	64	36	Billy Speight, 114 Jordan Rd., Clarksville, TN 37042
Texas	65	35	Northeast—Pat Rosenstiel, Box 682, Commerce, TX 75428
	66	36	Northwest—Bonnie Taylor, 3700 Merrill, Odessa, TX 79764
	67	35	Southeast—Helen McClure, 4910 Maple St., Bellaire, TX 77401
	68	36	Southwest—Edell Estenson, 95 River Ranch Rd., Bandera, TX 78003
Utah	69	35	Marian Hutchison, 738 North 1100 East, St. George, UT 84770
Vermont	70	36	Richard Haas, Box 276, Townshend, VT 05353
Virginia	71	35	Tom Hearn, P.O. Box 1457, Suffolk, VA 23434
Washington	72	35	Robert Olson, 142 Lake Blvd., Shelton, WA 98584
West Virginia	73	35	John R. Denham, 111 Seneca Dr., Clarksburg, WV 26301
Wisconsin	74	36	N. Wis./Up. Pen. Mich.—David J. Roberts, Box 453 M-35, Negaunee, WI 49866
	75	35	Southern—Mildred Baeseman, 5700 W. Wahner #203, Brown Deer, WI 53223

State	Area no.	Panel	
Wyoming	76	36	John J. Sears, P.O. Box 698, Cody, WY 82414
Puerto Rico	77	36	Eugenio Cotto Jr., G.P.O. Box 211, San Juan, PR 00936
Canada			
Province			
Alberta/ Northwest Territories	78	36	Walter Kronkvist, 402-1941 Mayor Magrath Dr., Lethbridge, AB T1K 2R8
British Columbia/Yukon	79	35	Harold M. Stevens, 1529 Dogwood Ave., Comox, B.C. V9N 5W9
Manitoba	80	36	Leon Morehouse, 3410 Van Horne St., Brandon, MB R7B 3H4
New Brunswick/Prince Edward Island	81	36	Lawrence Adams, Black River Bridge, R.R. #2, Northumberland County, NB E0C 1B0
Nova Scotia/ Newfoundland/Labrador	82	35	David F. O'Leary, 3 Nightingale Rd., St. John's, Nfld. A1E 2G4
Ontario	83	35	Eastern—Robert Easby, 919 River Rd., Ottawa, ON K1K 3V2
	84	35	Northeastern—Noel T. Quesnelle, 701 Prete St., Sudbury, ON P3E 3X4
	85	35	Northwestern—Diane Dixon, 80 Peter St., Thunder Bay, ON P7A 5H3
	86	36	Western—Tom Simpson, 5 Clover Ave., Barrie, ON L4N 3M7
Quebec	87	36	Southwest—Marc Pineau, 185-14e Ave., Iberville, PQ J2X 1B5
	88	35	Southeast—Maurice Rondeau, P.O. Box 16, Norton, VT 05907
	89	35	Northeast—Jean Baptiste Lapointe, 100 Dorval, Charlesbourg, PQ G2N 1J3
	90	36	Northwest—Real Bourgeois, 3 Chemin Ile Morris, Boisbriand, PQ J7G 1S4
Saskatchewan	91	36	Peter Buckler, 110 Forrester Rd., Saskatoon, SK S7M 4G3

